

# HISTORY

## Senior One Student's Book



Experimental Version

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## FOREWORD

Dear Student,

Rwanda Basic Education Board is honoured to present to you History and Citizenship book for Senior One which serves as a guide to competence-based teaching and learning to ensure consistency and coherence in the learning of History and Citizenship subject. The Rwandan educational philosophy is to ensure that you achieve full potential at every level of education, which will prepare you to be well integrated in society and exploit employment opportunities.

The government of Rwanda emphasizes the importance of aligning teaching and learning materials with the syllabus to facilitate your learning process. Many factors influence what you learn, how well you learn and the competence you acquire. Those factors include quality instructional materials available, assessment strategies for the students among others. Special attention was paid to activities that facilitate learning process, develop your ideas and make new discoveries during concrete activities carried out individually or with peers.

In competence-based curriculum, the student considers learning as a process of active building and developing knowledge and meanings where concepts are mainly introduced by an activity, a situation or a scenario that helps the student to construct knowledge, develop skills and acquire positive attitudes and values. For effective use of this textbook, your role is to:

- Work on given activities which lead to the achievement of necessary competences development of skills
- Share relevant information with other students through presentations, discussions, group work and other active learning techniques such as role play, case studies, investigation and research in the library, from the Internet or from your community;
- Participate and take responsibility for your own learning;
- Draw conclusions based on the findings from the learning activities.

To facilitate you in doing activities, the content of this book is self-explanatory so that you can easily use it by yourself, acquire and assess your competences. The book is made of units whereby each unit comprises: the key unit competence, followed by the introductory activity before the development of History and Citizenship concepts that are connected to real world situation.



# FOREWORD

I wish to sincerely extend my appreciation to REB staff who organized the editing process of this textbook. Special gratitude also goes to lecturers, teachers, illustrators and designers who supported the exercise throughout. Any comment or contribution would be welcome to the improvement of this textbook for the next edition.



**Dr. MBARUSHIMANA Nelson**

Director General, REB

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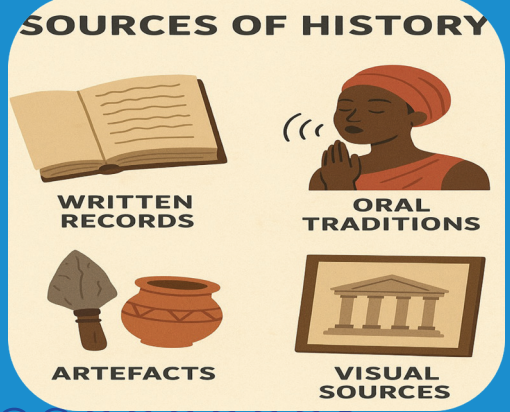
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# UNIT 1: SOURCES OF HISTORY



## Key Unit Competence:

Evaluate the significance and reliability of various sources of history to construct accurate interpretations of past events.

## Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

### Knowledge and understanding

Explain the meaning of history and identify different types of historical sources, showing how each source helps in understanding the past.

Describe methods used to collect historical information in ancient Rwanda and explain the importance of studying history in modern life.

### Skills

Present and interpret a timeline of history, and compare different historical sources based on their reliability and usefulness.

Analyse and evaluate the importance of history and explain how it relates to and differs from other human sciences.

### Attitudes and Values:

Appreciate the role of history in human and national development and recognize the value of historical sources as part of their cultural heritage.

Demonstrate curiosity and commitment in collecting and preserving historical information and advocate for the study of history among their peers.





### Introductory activity

Mutesi is a history teacher in Senior one at Groupe Scolaire Cyahinda. At the beginning of the new school year 2025-2026. While she was introducing a new lesson, she invited her students to tell her different ways through which they can be informed about the past of their ancestors. If you had been one of her students, what answers would you have given to her. Add what you think can be the importance of studying History.

## Introduction

This unit helps you learn about the past and why it is important. History tells us stories about people who lived long ago and how they lived. By learning history, we understand where we come from and who we are today.

You will learn to use timelines to see events in order. You will also learn about different sources of history. You will learn how people in ancient Rwanda shared their history through stories and traditions. This unit will help you to respect your culture and become a good and responsible citizen.

### 1.1. Meaning of history, timeline and some historical terms



#### Learning activity 1.1

**Read the following story and answer the questions below:**

The school garden has several plants and trees that were planted at different times in the past five years. The head teacher has forgotten exactly when each plant was planted and asks the class to help reconstruct the history of the garden.

#### Questions

1. What does this activity teach us about the meaning of history?
2. How does the timeline help us to understand the sequence of events?

### Meaning of history

History is the study of past events involving human beings and societies, and civilisation. It helps us understand how people lived, what they did, how societies changed over time, and how past events influence the present and future. History is not just about memorizing dates, facts and events; it is about interpreting evidence from various sources of the History of a society to understand the causes, effects and significance of events. History is also sharpening critical thinking, skills linked between the past, present and the future and cultivating a sense of self-reliance.

### 1.1.1. Concept of history

History has different concept. The following are some of them:

- **Decade:** is a period of ten years (10 years)
- **Century:** is a period of 100 years (100 years)
- **Millennium:** is a period of 1000 years (1000 years)
- **Time:** is the duration in which events and actions succeed each other (days of the past, present and future)
- **Generation:** all the people born in the same epoch. It is a period which, on average varies from 25-30 years in which children grow and become adults and have their own offspring (their own children)
- **Period** is a long duration characterized by events that have taken place. For example, the Stone Age period, the Iron Age period.
- **Epoch:** is the beginning of a period of time, which in History, is marked by particular events.
- **Event:** a past event which has marked man's past
- **Civilisation:** A whole range of social, religious, intellectual, artistic, scientific, technical values of people and transmitted through education. Civilisation develops in relation to the evolution of the conditions of human life.
- **Past:** time that precedes the present
- **Timeline:** it is a gradual and oriented line on which dated events are placed.

### 1.1.2. Periods of history

The study of the past is divided into two broad parts: Pre-history and History. Pre-history refers to the long period of human existence before the invention of writing, when information was learned through archaeology, fossils, and facts. History begins after writing was developed, allowing people to record events, ideas, and daily life.

#### a) Pre-history

Prehistory is a period which precedes history, a period when man did not know how to read and write. Prehistory comprises a wide range of periods: Pre- History is divided into three major periods.

- Early Stone Age (1.500.000 - 750.000 BC)
- Middle Stone Age (750.000 - 300.000 BC)
- Late Stone Age (300.000 - 50.000 BC)

Archaeologists and Historians have referred to this period as Stone Age because major tools used were made from stones.

#### b) Historic period

This is a period when man started recording his past deeds in form of writing, reading and drawing. This period is divided into four parts:

## Antiquity

It began with the invention of writing (3000 B.C) and ended in the 5<sup>th</sup> century with the invasion of Barbarians and the collapse of Western Roman Empire (476 A.D). It was characterized by Classical civilizations which had been developed around Mediterranean Sea e.g. Greek civilization, Roman civilization.

### Middle Age (5<sup>th</sup> C AD-15<sup>th</sup> C AD)

It was characterized by:

- The decline of west roman civilizations.
- The rise, reign and decline of feudalism.
- Dominance of Christianity which led to crusades.
- It ended with decline of eastern Roman Empire in 1453 A.D and the discovery of America by Christopher Columbus in 1492.

### Modern times (1453/1492-1789)

This period was characterized by:

- The struggle for dominance between countries/kingdoms in Europe.
- Existence of monarchy system of governance in Europe.
- Voyages of explorers(discoveries).
- Catholic reformation.
- Era of enlightenment.
- Ended with the outbreak of French Revolution in 1789.

### Contemporary period (1789-to date)

This period was/is characterized by:

- Rise of nationalism and formation of nations in Europe.
- The spread of democratic ideas.

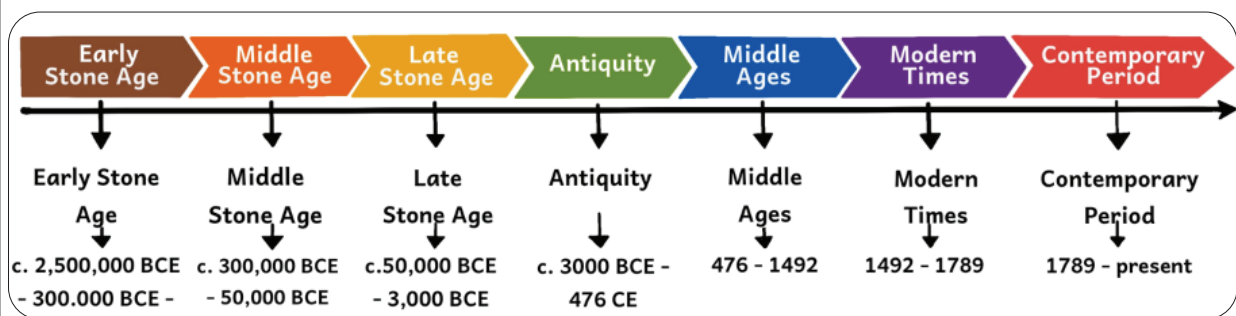
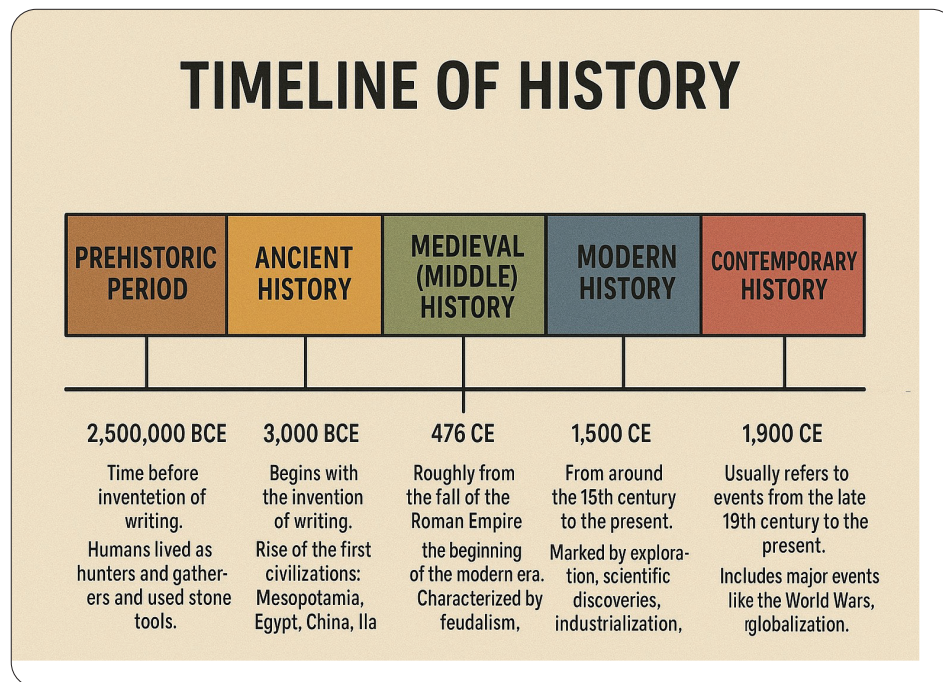
## Timeline of history

A timeline of history is a line or chart that shows events in the order in which they happened, from the earliest to the most recent. It helps us see when events occur and how they are connected over time.

A timeline usually includes:

- Dates or years
- Important events
- Periods or eras (e.g., pre-colonial, colonial, post-colonial)
- Sequence: events arranged from past → present

## Example of history timeline



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 1.1

- Write True or False for each statement from A to D.
  - Pre-history refers to the time after human beings learned how to write.
  - A century is a period of 100 years.
  - The fall of the Western Roman Empire marked the end of Ancient History.
  - The Contemporary period began in 1492.
- Define *history* in your own words.
- What is the difference between Pre-history and History?
- Why is the invention of writing considering an important turning point in human development?
- Why do historians divide time into periods such as Ancient, Medieval, and Modern? Give two reasons.
- Draw a simple timeline showing the following periods in chronological order:

- Early Stone Age
- Middle Stone Age
- Late Stone Age
- Antiquity
- Middle Ages
- Modern Times
- Contemporary Period

## 1.2. Types of historical sources



### Learning activity 1.2

Read the following scenario and answer the questions asked on it.

#### Scenario

A team of history students is helping their local museum prepare an exhibition on "Life in Rwanda in the Early 20th Century."

During their research, they collect a variety of materials from different places.

Here are the items they gathered: A 1912 handwritten letter written by a Rwandan chief to a German administrator, A photograph taken in 1920 showing people cultivating land, A clay pot discovered during an archaeological excavation in Southern Rwanda, A recorded interview with a 98-year-old elder who explains how life was during the colonial period, An old government tax record from 1935.

#### Questions

1. Identify which of the items above is a written primary source?
2. Show which item represents an oral source?
3. Identify item is a visual source?
4. Which source do you think is most reliable for understanding economic activities of the time? Explain.

Historical sources are materials that provide information about the past. They are used by historians to study, interpret, and reconstruct historical events. The main types of historical sources are:

#### i) **Oral tradition**

The process of telling information by word of mouth is called oral tradition. It is one method of collecting historical information.

Oral tradition is defined as any information passed by word of mouth (verbally) from one generation to another. This is done through socialisation especially between the young and the old.

Oral traditions may be in form of songs, stories, legends, poems, folktales and proverbs of people's past. It is based on eyewitness accounts about an event.

### Examples:

- Oral traditions (stories, myths, legends, stories, folktales and proverbs of people's past)
- Testimonies of elders
- Recorded interviews
- Songs or poems describing historical events

Oral traditions are transmitted mostly by traditionalists old men and old women. These people have a wide knowledge in history of their societies in different areas of life including politics, economics, medicine, administration, technology, culture, etc.



Fig. 1.1: Oral tradition as a source of History

### ii) Written Sources

Written sources are the information related to the past recorded by writing in form of letters, words or other written symbols found in books, diaries, newspapers, magazines, journals, letters, magazines, journals, non-published documents inscriptions on coins and newspapers among others. These written documents are often found in libraries, archives, on internet, bookshops, etc. In few words, written resources are sources that record events, ideas, laws or agreements in written form.

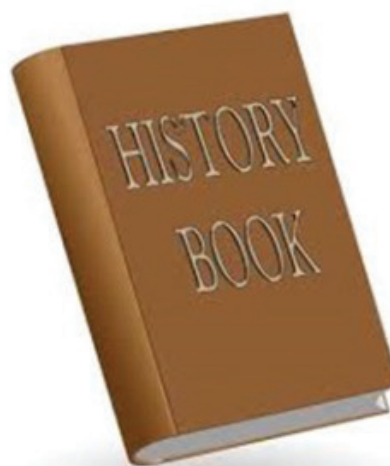


Fig. 1.2: Written sources of History

### iii) Electronic sources (Audio-visual sources)

An electronic source generally refers to any device or component that produces or utilizes electrical signals. This can include electronic devices such as computers, smartphones, sensors, and other gadgets. It may also refer to electronic sources of information, such as digital databases, online publications, or any other content that is stored or transmitted electronically. Sources that combine sound and visual elements to provide historical information.



*Fig. 1.3: A television set*

### **Getting information through seeing and hearing**

Getting information through seeing and hearing is what we call audio-visual. It is one of the ways through which historical information is collected.

It also deals with obtaining information by listening to or watching other devices. It is one of the modern sources of information.

#### **iv) Archaeology**

It refers to the study of dug up materials or material remains of people's past. Physical objects left behind by past generations reveal information about their daily life, culture, and technology.

#### **Examples:**

- Pottery
- Tools and weapons
- Coins and ornaments
- Buildings, ruins, and monuments

#### **Important!**

As a way of conserving the environment, places of historical importance need to be protected. Such places can be used to generate income to the locals and to the government. This can be achieved through tourism.

#### **v) Linguistics**

Linguistics deals with the study and analysis of languages, their sound, evolution structure and formation. It also deals with the relationship between various languages. From these studies, one can conclude that people of the same language may have been in contact. For example, Bantu language (Kinyarwanda, Luganda, Kiswahili, Kirundi...) has common words linked to 'NTU' that indicates that they may share a common historical origin.

### **Important!**

Even when all of you have a common local language, the pronunciations of words may differ. This is because of where each of you was born. Despite of all this, the meaning remains the same. Language is a unifying factor among people. This is because they can understand each other, relate well and solve any issues that may arise amongst them. This promotes peace in the long run.

#### **vi) Anthropology**

This is the study of the existing social institutions and relationships of people's cultures, traditions, norms, values and attitudes. It deals with the study of how societies were established. It also deals with how they were socially, economically and politically organized. All these acts are the basis of transformation of society to the present status.

By studying people's past, we appreciate their culture. This helps us to pick and promote acceptable behaviour. We also avoid what has been proved negative to the general wellbeing of society.

In Rwanda, the Institute of National Museum is a good source of information. It has information on the history of the country and the region.



*Fig. 1.4: The Institute of National Museum of Rwanda in Huye District*

Rwanda is known worldwide as a country of a thousand hills. It is also one of the world's richest nations in terms of diversified cultural heritage. The Rwandan cultural heritage contains both tangible and intangible components.

These include sites that offer an incomparable view of the beauty of our country. They also give our visitors a platform to learn about Rwandan History, mythology and culture. Travelling through the country provides an interesting insight into some of those sites. Most of these sites are often located in beautiful countryside.

The Institute of National Museums of Rwanda (INMR) research on these sites. It is a way of identifying, protecting and promoting them for cultural heritage. Cultural heritage promotes tourism.

### **vii) Genetics**

Genetics is the study of genes, heredity and genetic variations in living organisms. Genetic studies enable historians to categorise different races and ethnic groups. The study of Genetics enables historians to understand human identity and origins of different communities. Since this occurs over time, a historian can capture relevant periods in the development of people.

Through comparative studies of DNA (Deoxyribonucleic Acid) which is inherited from parents, it is widely believed that modern humans, *Homo sapiens*, originated in Africa.



### **APPLICATION ACTIVITY 1.2**

Read the scenario and questions carefully. Answer all questions using examples and explanations based on the types of historical sources you have learned.

Scenario: Exploring the -past of -your -community

Shami, Shema and Isaro are a group of young historians exploring the history of your local community. You want to gather as much information as possible about how people lived in the past. You have access to elders, libraries, museums, old buildings, archaeological sites, and even DNA studies conducted by researchers.

You plan to collect information using different types of historical sources: oral traditions, written records, archaeology, linguistics, anthropology, genetics, and electronic sources.

#### **Questions**

1. From the scenario above, identify one example of oral sources you could use.
2. Identify one written source you might consult.
3. Name one archaeological sources that could help you study the past.
4. Which source would you use if you want to listen to historical events told by people who lived through them?
5. How can museums, like the Institute of National Museum of Rwanda help preserve historical sources?
6. Visit a local site of historical or cultural significance. Identify one tangible and one intangible source you find and explain what it can tell you about the past.

### **1.3. Methods and techniques of collecting historical information in ancient Rwanda**



### Learning activity 1.3

Read the scenario carefully and answer the questions. Use examples from Rwanda wherever possible.

**New Scenario:** Exploring Rwanda's past through different sources

Kalisa, Kamali and Kamikazi are members of a Inyange history club visiting different places in Rwanda to learn about the country's past. You want to find out how people lived long ago, how they were governed, and how their culture developed over time.

During your research, you visit villages to talk to elders, read old documents in libraries, visit museums and historical sites, attend cultural events, study local languages, and learn about scientific studies done by researchers. Your aim is to collect true and reliable information about Rwanda's history using different sources.

#### Questions

1. Name two examples of oral methods you could use to gather information about Rwandan kings and their courts.
2. Identify two written sources that could give information about social life in 19th-century Rwanda.
3. Give two archaeological sources that could help you understand how Rwandans built their houses and tools.
4. Mention one example each of how linguistics, anthropology and genetics provide historical information.
5. Why is oral tradition important for understanding Rwanda's history even though it is not written?

Oral sources are the most important in the study of the History of ancient Rwanda, we can distinguish four different oral sources:

- Historical stories;
- Genealogies;
- Poetry and songs;
- "Ubwiru" or esoteric code.

#### 1. Historical stories

Historical stories (ibitekerezo) narrate ancient events. These are divided into three major categories:

##### Official stories

These are narrated by people who learnt them systematically from their parents or their neighbours. Their origin was usually an official edition of chosen events and these stories were usually passed through the royal court.

## Popular stories

They are more or less presented in the same way as the official stories but these ones enjoyed more freedom in their transmission. These stories have to a large extent interesting marvellous legends, tales/imigani miremire, proverbs/imigani migufi, and riddles/ibisakuzo

## Familiar stories

These are of great importance to the history of Rwanda because they were private and therefore were not manipulated.

They cover the period of the reign of King RWABUGIRI up to today. For example, it is said that in these popular stories, it was King Kigeli IV Rwabugiri who brought maize.

## 2. Genealogies

Genealogy is the study of families, family history and the tracing of lineages. Genealogies are divided into:

### Dynastic genealogy (ubucurabwenge)

This is an original text which was orally transmitted by genealogists called "Abacurabwenge". "Ubucurabwenge" can cite proper names of all the Kings of Rwanda and their royal titles. This genealogy was and is still the most important source for the History of Rwanda

### Family genealogy

These are useful because they complete the chronology given by dynastic genealogists. In precolonial Rwanda, declamation of genealogy used to help people or families to identify themselves in the community.

## 3. Poems and Songs

Poetry in Rwanda is transmitted in an imaginary form. Commentators can give interpretation and sense to these poems. These commentaries are often lacking in many aspects. In ancient Rwanda, there were various types of poetry: dynastic poetry, pastoral poetry (amahamba/ amazina y'inka) warrior poetry (ibyivugo). Dynastic poetry (Ibisigo): showed praises of merit and bravery and heroism to the reigning and departed kings. Traditional songs and dance are big parts of life in Rwanda. They are mixed in festivals, social events, weddings, naming a child, giving a cow etc. As an example, Intore dance is a traditional performance that talks about bravery activities of Rwandans in ancient period. It is performed by drums. Both men and women are participated in this traditional performance. Another traditional music and dance are amahigi, which is dedicated to hunting activities. Some other type of folk songs which can be mentioned and accompanied with dance too are ibihozo (choral songs), indirimbo z'ingabo (warriors' songs), amasare (wrestling songs), ...

## 4. Esoteric code (Ubwiru)

This text was exclusively for the abiru who were special advisers to the King. They were charged with the responsibility of knowing all the rules and application of these rules relating to the royal institution. They also supervised the symbolic representations and behaviors of the Kings. Ubwiru texts were rituals, which were learnt by heart by the abiru.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 1.3

Read the following scenario and answer the related questions.

**Scenario: Investigating the History of our Village**

Shami, Shema and Sheja are members of a youth history club in your village. Kalisa, the history teacher, has assigned you to research the history of your community from precolonial times to the early colonial period. Your goal is to learn about local leaders, family lineages, traditional ceremonies, daily life and cultural practices.

You have access to: Elders and traditional storytellers in the village, local music, poetry, and dance performances, Family genealogies and historical documents. You are expected to use different methods and techniques to collect accurate historical information.

#### Questions

1. List four types of oral sources you could use and give one example for each.
2. Explain why oral sources are still very important for understanding the history of your village.
3. How can genealogies help establish the lineage of local leaders or notable families?
4. Visit a historical site or cultural centre in your village. Identify one tangible source (like a tool, hut, or artifact) and one intangible source (like a song, dance, or story) and explain what each reveal about the past.

## 1.4. Importance of studying History



### Learning activity 1.4

Read the following scenario and the related questions.

Gahizi, Keza, and Gatsinzi were high school friends who studied History.

- Gahizi became a judge.
- Keza became a road construction administrator.
- Gatsinzi became a university History lecturer.

From their careers, we learn that History is not only a subject it prepares people for many professions. History also helps us understand the past, present, and future, promotes patriotism, critical thinking, moral principles, tolerance, international understanding, and helps prevent injustices like the 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi.

#### Questions

1. How did studying History help each of the three friends in their careers?
2. Discuss and identify at least two benefits of studying History shown in the scenario.

The following are reasons why History is more than a career subject:

History prepares us for the future, after we have known the present and past. For example, Rwanda's pre-colonial, colonial and post-colonial eras helps us plan for our country.

The study of History inspires us and instils in us a patriotic and nationalistic spirit. This spirit develops as we learn about our heroes such as Ruganzu II Ndoli, Kigeli IV Rwabugiri and others.

We study History as a career subject. Through it, we can become teachers, lawyers, administrators, curators and politicians.

It also sharpens our critical sense as it widens our knowledge and competencies. Through History, we can read, write, interpret information, debate and draw logical conclusions and judgments.

It promotes moral principles through the study of personalities with high moral standards. It helps us to avoid any form of injustice.

It helps to promote international understanding among nations and people. This is through the study of other countries' systems of governance. It can be achieved through actions of international organizations such as the United Nations (UN), African Union (AU) and the East African Community (EAC).

It helps us to be tolerant. Through the study of History, we learn about culture and values of different ethnic groups, tribes and races. This is important in the promotion of mutual understanding, tolerance and peaceful co-existence.

It helps us to understand the nature of social, economic and political problems of a given society.

It helps us to make a thorough analysis of the past events such as the 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi. This will help us prevent them from occurring again.



#### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 1.4

Match each real-life situation with the correct importance of studying History.

| Real-life situation                                                                | Importance of History                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| a) A leader uses knowledge of Rwanda's past to create better development policies. | 1. Promotes tolerance and peaceful coexistence |
| b) Students admire heroic deeds of Ruganzu II Ndoli.                               | 2. Promotes moral principles                   |
| c) A judge avoids injustice by following moral principles.                         | 3. Promotes patriotism and nationalism         |
| d) A teacher encourages multicultural understanding in class.                      | 4. Promotes international understanding        |
| e) Rwanda works with the African Union (AU) to maintain peace.                     | 5. Prepares us for the future                  |

Match each real-life situation with the correct importance of studying History.

f) A historian analyses cause of the 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi to prevent similar events.

6. Helps us prevent past mistakes



## 1.5. END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and understanding

1. Define history and explain why it is important in understanding human societies.
2. Mention three types of historical sources and give an example of each.
3. Explain what is oral tradition, and why was it important in ancient Rwanda?
4. Complete the following statements with the correct historical term.
  - a) The study of past events involving human beings, societies, and civilizations is called \_\_\_\_\_.
  - b) The period before the invention of writing is known as \_\_\_\_\_.
  - c) Physical objects left behind by past generations, such as tools, pottery, and buildings, are studied through \_\_\_\_\_.
  - d) The process of passing information verbally from one generation to another is called \_\_\_\_\_.
  - e) A gradual line showing events in the order they occurred from earliest to latest is called a \_\_\_\_\_.
  - f) The period that began after the invention of writing and includes recorded events is called \_\_\_\_\_.

### Skills

1. Analyse a short oral story from an elder and identify at least two pieces of information that could be verified through other sources.
2. Match each type of historical source in Column A with the most appropriate example in Column B.

| Type of historical source in Column A | Example in Column B.                           |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Oral tradition                     | a) Family genealogies of Rwandan kings         |
| 2. Written source                     | b) A clay pot discovered at an excavation site |
| 3. Archaeology                        | c) DNA analysis of ancient human remains       |

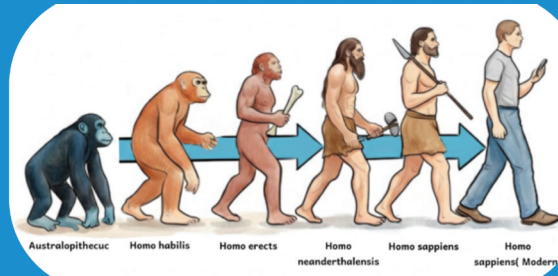
|                  |                                                            |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4. Visual source | d) Recorded interview with an elder about colonial life    |
| 5. Genetics      | e) A photograph of people farming in 1920                  |
| 6. Anthropology  | f) Study of Rwandan cultural norms and social institutions |

### **Attitudes and values**

1. Why should we respect elders when collecting oral history?
2. Why should we value written sources like letters, diaries, and government records?
3. How does learning about the history of Rwanda help you be proud of your country?

# UNIT 2:

## EVOLUTION OF HUMANKIND



### Key unit competence

**Analyse** the evolution of humankind, including physical, social, and cultural development, to understand human adaptation and diversity.

### Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

#### Knowledge and understanding

Explain the different theories of the origin of humankind.

Describe the process of human evolution from early primates to modern humans.

Identify the major discoveries and technological made evolution during the Stone Age.

#### Skills

Evaluate and compare different theories of the origin of humankind.

Analyse the stages of human evolution and their characteristics.

#### Attitudes and Values:

Appreciate the importance of human evolution in understanding human identity and progress.

Exhibit curiosity and openness toward scientific and historical explanations of human origins.

Demonstrate open-mindedness when comparing different theories of evolution.

## Introduction

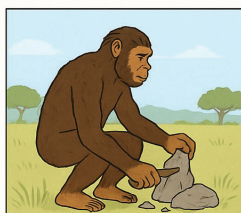
This unit explores the journey of human beings from their earliest origins to modern times. Its purpose is to help learners understand how humans have evolved physically, mentally, and socially. The unit also aims to show how these changes have shaped human identity and society. The scope includes human evolution, early human species, and the development of tools and culture. Learners will study major milestones in humankind's progress, as well as different theories of evolution and supporting scientific evidence. Key concepts include evolution, hominids, adaptation, natural selection, fossils, culture, civilization, human origins, and innovation.



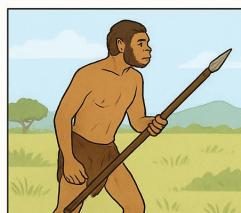
### Introductory activity 2

Observe the following pictures and answer questions asked on each.

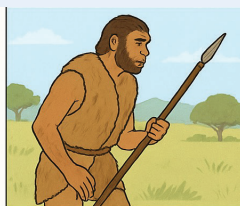
#### EVOLUTION OF HUMANKIND



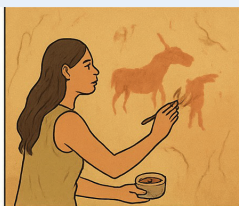
What do you notice about the physical features of the humans in each im?



How do you think these humans lived and survived?



What tools or objects are they using, and why?



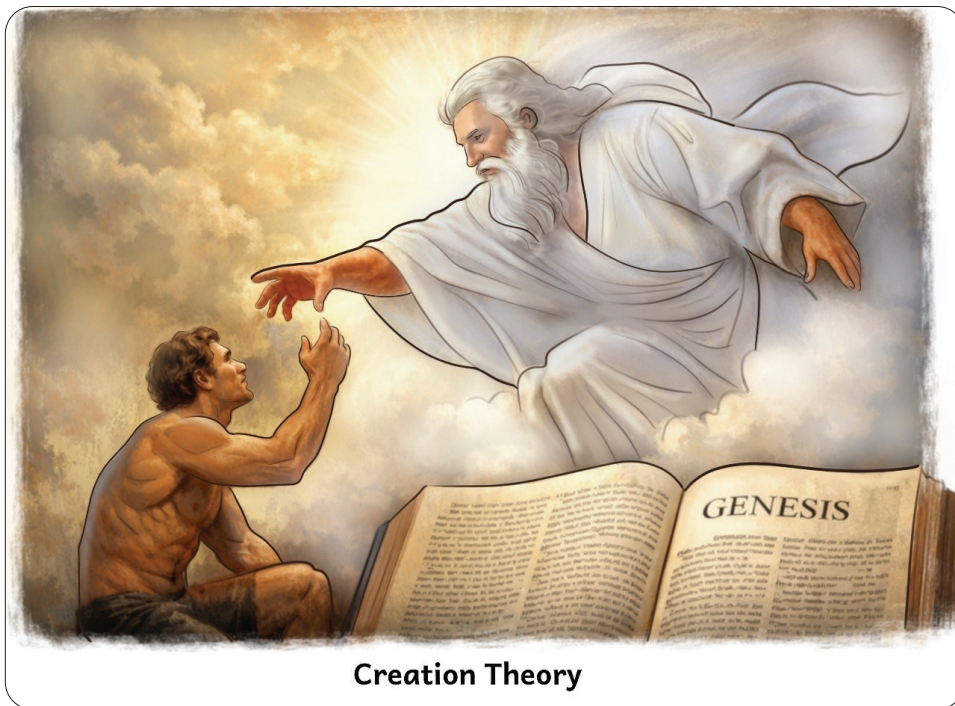
How do the activities shown in the images reflect culture or social life?

## 2.1. Origin of Humankind



### Learning activity 2.1

The earth planet was inhabited for the first time by humankind a few million years ago. The scientific theory stipulates that the first forms of human beings were assimilated to apes and the latter underwent evolution so as to lead to the present forms of hominids. Explain the evolution theory propounded by Charles Darwin.



**Creation Theory**

There are two theories explaining human origin and evolution:

### **The creation theory/Biblical theory**

This theory explains that humankind was created by God, according to Genesis 1 and 2. God created man from soil and later a woman from man's rib (Adam and Eve). The two were given responsibility to reproduce and fill the earth.

### **The scientific theory**

The modern theory concerning the evolution of humankind has a different view. It proposes that humans and apes derived from an ape-like ancestor who is said to have undergone five distinctive stages that are discussed below in the next lesson, that is, evolution of humans.

The ape-like ancestor lived on earth a few million years ago. The theory states that humankind emerged through a combination of environmental and genetic factors.

Perhaps the most famous proponent of evolution theory was Charles Darwin (1809-82). He authored **The Origin of Species (1859)** to describe his theory of evolution. Since then, humankind's origin has generally been explained from an evolutionary perspective. Moreover, the theory of man's evolution has been and continues to be modified. New findings are discovered and revisions to the theory are adopted.



### **APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.1**

1. If a learner says that humans were created by God while another says humans evolved from ape-like ancestors, how would you explain that both views come from different theories about human origin?
2. Imagine a new fossil is discovered that shows both human and ape features. Which theory would this discovery support more, and why?

## 2.2. Evolution of humans



### Learning activity 2.2

Imagine your classroom has been turned into a time-travel lab. Your mission is to travel back in time to different stages of human history to investigate how humans evolved physically, socially, and culturally. You are a team of young anthropologists tasked with observing humans in the past and reporting back to your class.

Investigate the time period and fill out a table summarizing your findings. Include drawings or sketches if possible and present findings to the class.

| <b>Periods of human evolution</b> | <b>Physical Features:</b> Height, brain size, posture. | <b>Social Life:</b> Group size, hunting, cooperation, communication. | <b>Cultural/ Technological Development:</b> Tools, art, rituals, shelter. |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Australopithecus                  |                                                        |                                                                      |                                                                           |
| Homo habilis                      |                                                        |                                                                      |                                                                           |
| Homo erectus                      |                                                        |                                                                      |                                                                           |
| Homo sapiens                      |                                                        |                                                                      |                                                                           |

The evolution of man refers to the stages through which human beings went through in order to become the present-day human beings.

Humankind's evolution passed through the following five stages:

- Australopithecus
- Homo habilis
- Homo erectus
- Homo sapiens
- Homo sapiens sapiens

#### i) **Australopithecus**

Lived between 3.9 and 3.0 million years ago. He retained the apelike face with a sloping forehead. He had a ridge over the eyes. He had flat nose, etc. The remains of Australopithecus were found in Kenya.

#### ii) **Homo habilis**

He was also called The Handy Man because tools were found with his fossil remains. He existed between 2.4 and 1.5 million years ago. The brain shape shows evidence that some speech had developed. He was 5' tall and weighed about 100 pounds.

### iii) **Homo erectus**

Lived between 1.8 million and 300,000 years ago. Towards the end, his brain size was like that of modern human beings. He definitely could speak, developed tools, weapons and fire. He also learned to cook his own food. He developed clothing for northern climates. He turned to hunting for his food. Only his head and face differed from those of modern human beings.

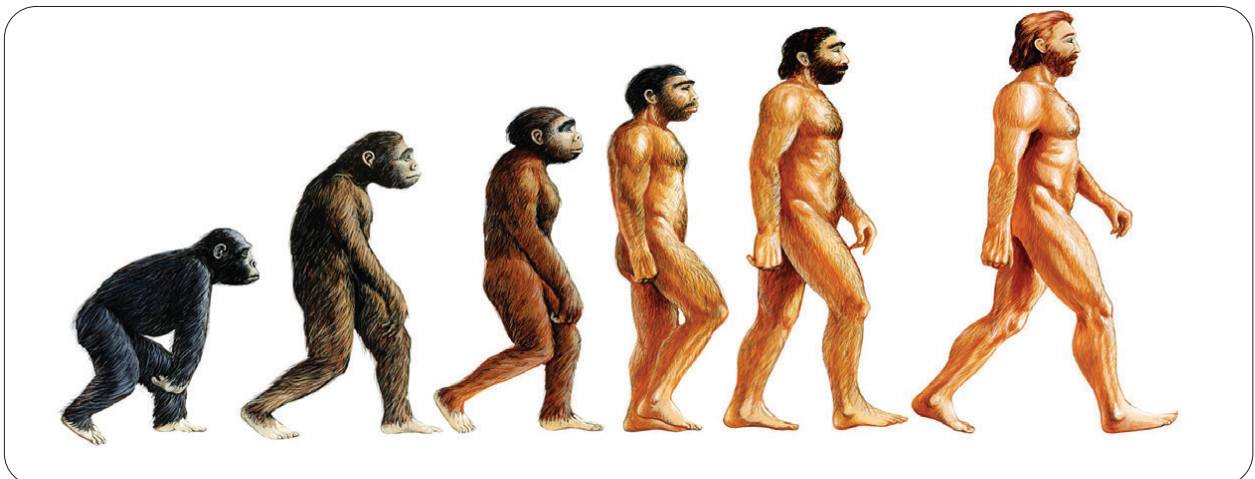
### iv) **Homo sapiens**

Lived in Europe and in the Middle East between 150,000 and 35,000 years ago. His brain size averaged larger than modern human being. His head was shaped differently, longer and lower. His nose was large and extremely different from that of modern human beings in structure.

He was a massive man, about 5' 6" tall. He had a heavy skeleton, etc

### v) **Homo sapiens sapiens (or modern man)**

He evolved in Africa and migrated widely in the world. This species is estimated to have come into existence about 200,000 years ago. Fossils of this species have been found in Omo River Valley, north of Lake Turkana, Singa in Sudan and Ngaloba in Tanzania. The brain of Homo sapiens sapiens resembled that of modern man. He was more advanced in speech and technology.



*Fig 2.1: Illustration showing scientific theory of evolution*

Several sites excavated by popular archaeologists of the 20th Century points to this. Dr Leakey worked in the 1960s and 1970s at a site called Olduvai Gorge in Tanzania.

Archaeological evidence tells the fact that people in this era lived on scavenged meat. They also ate wild plants. In short, they practiced hunting and gathering.

Dr Leakey's works discovered other sites around Lake Turkana in northern Kenya. The discoveries were largely similar to those of Olduvai Gorge.

Donald Johansson worked separately from Dr Leakey, a decade later in northern Ethiopia. He found fossils that confirmed great human presence in the region several thousand years before.

## The life and survival of early man

The evolution and culture of early man are often studied according to stone ages. These were periods when tools were almost completely made from stone. This grouping applies to Africa, south of the Sahara. In North Africa, the Nile Valley, Europe and Asia, the applicable term is Paleolithic, a Greek word meaning Old Stone. Production of tools marked significant stages in mankind's progress. The brain hand eye coordination and control resulted in tools whose refinement has never ended. Various species of early man manufactured them for different purposes.

Over time, man spread beyond the few identified spots of originality. He spread to other places on the continent and beyond to other continents. This was influenced by climatic conditions as well as his search for food. Also, man spread while escaping from dangerous animals that could eat him.

It also happened as a result of purposeless wandering. Man kept on moving in any direction without any specific point to return to. This is because man was wild, without any element of domestication.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.2

1. Based on the characteristics of Australopithecus, explain how scientists can distinguish him from modern humans.
2. Why is Homo habilis called "The Handy Man"? Explain with reference to his lifestyle.
3. Explain why Homo sapiens sapiens is considered more advanced than previous human species.
4. How did archaeological discoveries by Dr. Leakey and Donald Johansson help scientists understand human evolution?
5. Discuss three reasons why early humans moved from one place to another.

## 2.3. Discoveries made in stone Age Period



### Learning activity 2.3

Read the following scenario and answer questions below

Scenario: "A Trip to Ancient Times"

Your class travels back in time and lands in the Stone Age. You walk around and observe early humans using different tools and skills to survive.

You see three groups:

1. Group 1 – Paleolithic People

They are making simple stone tools and using fire to cook meat.

## 2. Group 2 – Mesolithic People

They are hunting using bows and arrows and catching fish using hooks.

## 3. Group 3 – Neolithic People

They are farming, keeping domestic animals, and using polished stone tools.

Write one discovery from each Stone Age period:

- Paleolithic: \_\_\_\_\_
- Mesolithic: \_\_\_\_\_
- Neolithic: \_\_\_\_\_

Choose one discovery and explain how it helped people in that time.

Stone Age is a period that precedes History. It was the period when human beings did not know how to read and write. Pre-history is made up of three periods:

- Early Stone Age (1,500,000-750,000 BC)
- Middle Stone Age (750,000-300,000 BC)
- Late Stone Age (300,000-50,000 BC)

Archaeologists and historians have referred to this period as Stone Age Period. This is because major tools used at that time were made out of stones.

### Early Stone Age period (Paleolithic period)

During this period, man's activities were hunting and gathering food from forests.

Man was living a wandering life and lived on trees.

Man was shaping stones into double edged hand axe that was used in hunting.



Fig. 2.2: Middle Stone Age

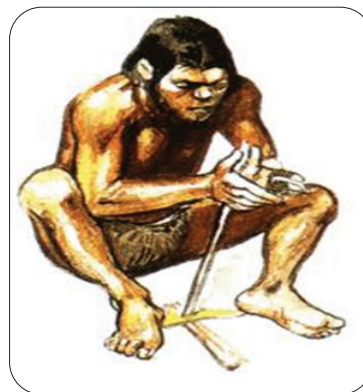
**Spear made from a stone**



fig 2.3. The Middle Stone Age period (Mesolithic)

During this period, there was improved method of making shaped flakes from bigger stones. The flakes became tools for cutting meat, scraping skins and sharpening of weapons.

- Man learnt to bind together stones into wooden handles which was called hafting. They were able to make improved tools such as ropes and poisoned arrows for hunting.
- Man, invented fire and used it for roasting meat, warming himself and scaring away wild animals.



*Fug.2.4: Early man making fire*

- Man continued with food gathering, that is, collecting fruits, leaves, stems and roots.
- Man started keeping domestic animals such as dogs, cats and goats.
- Man started living in caves and forming small families.
- Man, invented fishhooks and canoes.



**Dog**



**Goat**



**Cat**

### **Remember!**

We need to preserve and conserve 'the country of a thousand hills' because it is our heritage.

### **Late Stone Age/Neolithic period**



This is the period when human beings started making great changes. They improved their ways of life. It is characterized by the following:

- They started constructing small huts using grass, trees and skins
- They settled in a permanent place and stopped wandering.
- They started putting on skins and woven clothes.
- They began farming in order to produce their own food. This constitutes a revolution known as a **Neolithic revolution**.
- They used fertilizers and storage facilities.
- They started living in villages and forming communities.
- They increased domestication of several domestic animals such as horses, cows, sheep and pigs.
- They started iron working and began using iron tools such as machetes, hoes and knives. They used fewer stone tools.
- They started using better tools for hunting such as spears, arrows and bows.
- They made rules and regulations to have law and order in the societies.
- They began to bury the dead in graves instead of leaving them to rot on the ground.
- They started exchanging items with other communities (trade).



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.3

1. Why do you think archaeologists named this period the “Stone Age”? Use an example of tools to support your answer.
2. Explain how the invention of fire changed the way people in the Middle Stone Age lived.
3. During the Middle Stone Age, people began domesticating animals. How would keeping dogs, goats, or cats help early humans survive?
4. Compare the tools of the Early Stone Age and Late Stone Age. How would the iron tools of the Late Stone Age make life easier than the stone hand axe of the Early Stone Age?
5. Why was settling in permanent homes an important step in the Late Stone Age? Give one social benefit and one economic benefit.

## 2.4. Characteristics of hunter gatherer societies



### Learning activity 2.4

**Read the following scenario and answer the questions asked on it**

#### **Scenario: "A Day in the Life of Early Humans"**

Your class travels back in time and arrives 50,000 years ago in a hunter-gatherer community. You meet a small group of early humans who survive by hunting wild animals and gathering fruits, leaves, roots, and honey.

They move from place to place in search of food.

They live in temporary shelters made from grass, branches, and animal skins.

You notice that everyone—children, women, and men—has a role: some hunt, some gather, some protect the group, and others prepare food.

They share everything they collect because cooperation is necessary for survival.

The group is small, usually made up of a few families.

#### **Questions**

1. From the scenario, list three characteristics of hunter-gatherer society.
  - a) \_\_\_\_\_
  - b) \_\_\_\_\_
  - c) \_\_\_\_\_
2. Choose one characteristic you listed and explain why it was important for survival.

.....  
.....

3. How is the lifestyle of hunter-gatherers different from your lifestyle today? Mention any two differences.

- a) .....
- b) .....

3. Imagine you are part of this hunter-gatherer group. Describe what your role would be and why.

### **Characteristics of hunter gatherer societies**

**Draw a hunter gatherer society: It should have different people in the society, having the below characteristics. (Photo not provided )**

- i) People lived by wandering from place to place. They moved from one place to another.

- ii) People lived in groups or communities based on their lineages and clans.
- iii) The major economic activities were hunting wild animals and gathering wild fruits for food.
- iv) Informal education was administered from parents to children.
- v) Stone tools were mainly used for cutting meat and for protection.
- vi) The societies had no laws to govern them because they lived a semi-permanent life.
- vii) In these societies, land was owned communally, not individually. Everyone had a right to settle where they wanted.
- viii) Herbal medicine was used to treat wounds, coughs and diseases such as malaria.
- ix) Intermarriages were common among people, but on consent of parents from both parties.
- x) The societies had no hierarchical social structure of administration.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.4

1. Why did people in hunter-gatherer societies move from one place to another?
2. Name the two main economic activities of the hunter gatherer society.
  - a) \_\_\_\_\_
  - b) \_\_\_\_\_
3. Explain how informal education was passed from parents to children.
4. Why were stone tools important in hunter-gatherer societies?



### 1.5. END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

#### Knowledge & understanding

1. Explain the difference between the creation theory and the scientific theory of human origin.
2. List the five major stages of human evolution in their correct order.
3. Identify two major discoveries made during the Middle Stone Age.
4. Give three characteristics of hunter-gatherer societies.

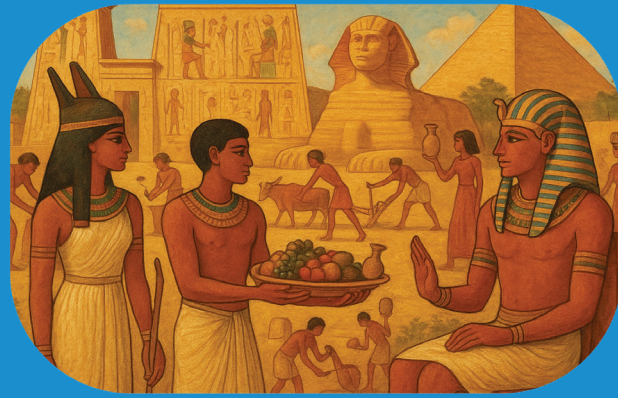
#### Skills

1. Compare the tools used in the Early Stone Age and the Late Stone Age and explain how these differences affected daily life.
2. Examine the table of human evolution stages and identify which group made the most technological progress. Give reasons.

### **Attitudes & values**

1. Explain why it is important to respect scientific and cultural explanations of human origin without discrimination.
2. Describe one positive value we can learn from cooperation in hunter-gatherer societies.
3. What lesson does the wandering lifestyle of early humans teach us about adapting to challenges in today's world?

# UNIT 3: EGYPTIAN CIVILISATION



## Key unit competence

**Evaluate** the origin, development, and contribution of Egyptian civilisation to determine its significance to the modern world.

## Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

### Knowledge and understanding

Describe the origin and major periods of Egyptian civilisation.

Identify and explain the key contributions of Egyptian civilisation to modern society.

### Skills

Analyse the characteristics of Egyptian civilisation.

Evaluate the importance and lasting influence of Egyptian civilisation on the modern world.

### Attitudes and Values:

Show appreciation and respect for ancient civilisations and their contributions to humanity.

Value the preservation of cultural and historical heritage as part of human identity.

## Introduction

Various discoveries have shown that ancient Egyptian civilisation was one of the oldest and most influential cultures in human history. Like other societies organised in ancient times, the Egyptians had a highly developed civilisation that was important and remains important in the ancient world. Egyptian civilisation originated around the River Nile and flourished because of the Nile, which fostered life, growth and progress in all areas at that time. This is why it was said that the "Nile was the gift of Egypt".

Egypt developed the construction of pyramids, as well as the religious beliefs and discoveries that made this civilisation unique. The ideas and inventions from ancient Egypt continue to influence the modern world.

**Key words:** Nile River, Pharaoh, Pyramids, Hieroglyphics, Religion, Culture, Inventions.



### Introductory activity 3

#### Problem Scenario

Imagine your community discovers an old object buried near a river. The object has strange symbols on it, similar to pictures used long ago by ancient peoples. Local leaders ask you and your classmates to investigate where this object might have come from, who might have used such symbols, and what they could mean.

To solve this mystery, you must think about early human civilisations and how people lived in the past.

#### Questions:

1. Why do you think many early civilisations settled near rivers?
2. Have you ever seen symbols or drawings that represent ideas? Where?
3. What do you already know about ancient Egypt or pyramids?
4. Why do you think ancient civilisations are still studied today?

### 3.1. Meaning and components of civilisation



#### Learning activity 3.1

Observe carefully the following three images and think about what makes a group of people a "civilisation."



#### Questions

1. What do you think the word civilisation means based on what you observed?
2. Which features or components seem important for a civilisation to exist?
3. How are these components similar or different from the community where you live today?

**Civilisation** refers to the process through which people settling on a territory improve their ways of living during a given period of time. This concept is also defined as a set of characters, distinct signs, pertaining to intellectual, artistic, moral and material life of a country or a given society.

Civilisation also refers to the great advance in highly developed culture and way of life when people began to farm, form governments, use metals, develop cities and use writing. To civilise, is said, is to pass from a social status to a more advanced one in terms of moral or intellectual order.

#### Components of civilisation

Civilisation is comprised of different components or indicators. The following are the main indicators that every civilisation might be made up of:

**Art and architecture:** This was seen in the various types of art work and construction of houses. The art work and type of houses expressed the talents, beliefs and values of people in a society.

**Society:** This implies a set of relations that binds together people or groups of people;

**Cultural:** This is how people express themselves through the creation of objects experiences and feelings in painting sculpture, music, dance, theatre and literature;

**Religious belief:** This is how people belonged to a given society explain what they believe in or accept based on faith;

**Intellectual:** This is how people form ideas, theories, create mental patterns and designs through experiences and makes sense out of them;

**Political:** This is how people are governed involving matters of authority and obedience, including who makes the laws, decides on foreign relations such as war and peace, collects taxes, dispenses justice and provides services needed by the general public;

**Territory:** This means geographical space on which civilisation must develop.  
**Language:** The system of communication involved symbols that stood for sounds and ideas to record information. A well-developed language network in a society was an important factor in civilisation because it promoted easy communication.

**Economy:** The way people used resources to meet their needs was so much important in the society. It was understood that when resources were used sparingly, the society could stand a chance for achieving civilisation quickly. This is because of the growth of the economy.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 3.1

1. Imagine your community wants to develop a new settlement into a more advanced and organised society. Based on what you learned, which three components of civilisation would you prioritise first, and how would each one improve people's living conditions?
2. Choose any two components of civilisation (e.g., economy, political system, art and architecture, territory). Explain how these two components depend on each other for a civilisation to grow and become stable. Use real or imagined examples to support your answer.
3. Design a simple plan for a "model civilisation" by describing how your society would organise its government, economy, and cultural life. Explain why your choices would help the society move from a basic level of living to a more advanced stage.
4. Think about your own community today. Identify one aspect that shows progress toward becoming more "civilised" (e.g., better roads, schools, hospitals, communication, leadership, cultural activities). Explain how this aspect reflects one or more components of civilisation and why it is important for development.

### 3.2. Origin and periods of Egyptian history



#### Learning activity 3.2

Observe the following images of ancient Egyptian pyramids, mummies, hieroglyphs, and artifacts and answer the probing questions asked on it.



#### Questions

1. Who do you think built these structures?
2. Why do you think ancient Egyptians created these writings and monuments?
3. When do you think these events happened?

River Nile is the longest river in the world. It flows all the way from Lake Victoria in Uganda to Mediterranean Sea in Egypt. The history of the Egyptian civilisation is as long and old as that of River Nile.

The roots of Egyptian civilisation go back more than 6,000 years. The roots start from the beginning of settled life along the banks of River Nile. The country has an unusual geographical and cultural unity. That has given the Egyptian people a strong sense of identity. It has also given them pride in their heritage as descendants of humankind's earliest civilized community.

Certain events have been crucial to the development of Egyptian society and culture. One of these was the unification of the Upper Egypt and Lower Egypt. This happened sometimes in the third millennium BC.

The unification of the Upper Egypt and lower Egypt was an important event in Egyptian history. It was compared to the 'first time', or the creation of the universe. With the unification of the 'two lands' by the legendary King Menes, the glorious Pharaonic age began. Power was centralised in the hands of a god-king, and thus, Egypt became the first organized society.

#### The main historical periods of the Ancient Egyptian civilisation

The History Egyptian civilisation happened in a series of stable periods known as:

- The Old Kingdom (2780-223 BC)
- The Middle Kingdom (2130- 1600 BC)
- The New Kingdom (1500- 1200 BC)
- The Old Kingdom (2780-223 BC)

The civilisation was separated by periods of relative instability known as intermediate periods.

## The Old Kingdom (2780-223 B.C)

Egypt had two states, Upper Egypt and Lower Egypt. These states had different rulers. King Menes united the two states with the capital at Memphis.

During the time of Old Kingdom, civilisation of Egypt took a step ahead. The three great pyramids were built as the tombs of Great Kings. The pyramids were built at places such as Giza and Khufu. It took more than 20 years to build them.



Fig. 3.1: A map of Egypt, Old Kingdom.

## The Middle Kingdom (2130-1600 BC)

During this period, there was a lot of confusion, hate and jealous. All this was because of the power of the pharaoh over the control of Egypt administration.

This was experienced by a new line of pharaohs that took over the administration. They brought calm and unity. In this period, the pharaoh had less power, and was never buried in pyramids. The pharaoh lived a unique life than in the past.

The Middle Kingdom is notably known when Egypt was attacked and invaded. It was attacked and invaded by Hyksos from western Asia. They governed, ruled and controlled Egypt for more than 150 years. Prince Ahmose staged an uprising against the Hyksos, which consequently led to their defeat. They were pushed out of Egypt.



Fig.3.2: A map of Egypt, Middle Kingdom

## The New Kingdom (1500-1200 BC)

Just like other pharaohs, Ahmose continued with the line of duty that made Egypt expand. Egypt became richer too. It was during this reign that the Egyptian empire was established. Egypt expanded and brought Syria and Palestine under its control. This brought glory and a good image to Egyptians and beyond.

Egypt's economy improved drastically through trade. Its cities grew larger and borders extended in conquest wars.



Fig. 3.3: A map of Egypt, New Kingdom



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 3.2

1. Use a blank map of Ancient Egypt and mark the locations of the Old, Middle, and New Kingdoms, including important sites such as Memphis, Giza, and areas conquered during the New Kingdom. Then, explain how the geographical location of the River Nile helped the Egyptians build a strong and unified civilization.
2. Imagine you are an advisor to Pharaoh Menes during the unification of

and Lower Egypt. What strategies would you propose to ensure that

Upper the two lands remain united politically and culturally? Justify your

strategies by referring to the challenges faced by early Egyptian society.

3. Design a timeline showing the Old, Middle, and New Kingdoms, including



major events such as the building of the pyramids, the Hyksos invasion,

and Egyptian expansion. Then, analyse how each period contributed to

the development of Egyptian civilisation and its global reputation.

### 3.3. Contribution of Egyptian civilisation to the modern world



#### Learning activity 3.3

##### Read the following scenario and answer the related questions

Imagine you are a young historian who has discovered a mysterious time machine. You travel back to ancient Egypt. While exploring, you notice amazing inventions, impressive buildings, and clever ways people solved problems. Your task is to learn about these contributions and show how they are still relevant in today's world.

##### Questions

1. What inventions, buildings, or tools do you notice in ancient Egypt?
2. Why do you think these contributions were important for the daily life of ancient Egyptians?
3. Can you think of examples in today's world that are influenced by these ancient Egyptian inventions or ideas? (For example: calendars, medicine, architecture, writing systems)
4. Which contribution do you think had the greatest impact on the modern world and why?

The contributions of Egyptian civilisation to the modern world are the following:

##### *i) Hieroglyphics*

This was the earliest Egyptians type of writing where pictures, symbols and signs were used to represent ideas. It was later copied by other countries to come up with modern writing. This Egyptian style of writing that later became the mother of today's writing was deciphered by a Frenchman Jean François Champollion.

##### *ii) Mummification*

This was the conservation of the dead bodies. It consisted of embalming the dead body by removing all moisture from the body, leaving only a dried form that would not easily decay. The Egyptians believed in life after death, and took great care to bury their dead. The pharaohs and some nobles had their bodies preserved. This has prevailed to date.

##### *iii) Medicine*

Egyptians contributed so much in field of medicine. They were the first specialist eye doctors, dentists, veterinary doctors and surgeon doctors.

##### *iv) Paper*

Egyptians invented paper and books from papyrus. This led to introduction of paper and books for record keeping.

##### *v) Calendar*

Egyptians were the first people to devise the means of counting days in a week, month and year. It is this that led to the introduction of modern calendar.

#### **vi) Irrigation**

Egyptians had the system of irrigation called Shadoofs and Sakias. They also had the system of digging canals. The canals were for the distribution of water in fields hence giving rise to modern irrigation.

#### **vii) Mathematics**

Egyptians were people remembered to be so good in Mathematics. They developed modern mathematical concepts such as fractions, addition, multiplication, division and subtraction. These concepts are still being used.

#### **viii) Architecture**

Egyptians were excellent builders using stones. They built the great pyramids, temples and tombs. These styles are still applied in modern society.

#### **ix) Science**

Egyptians made an important contribution to the science of astronomy. This practice was copied and is used in modern societies.

#### **x) Art**

Egyptians were specialists in arts. They had coloured paintings to adorn the sides of monuments, walls of temples, palaces and tombs. This gave rise to modern art and craft.

#### **xi) Technology**

Egyptians had developed a glassy material known as faience. Faience is believed to have contributed to modern technology of making glasses.

#### **Note!**

We can comfortably conclude that Egyptian civilisation is still felt in the current world.



*Egyptian architecture*



*Art works in Egypt*

*Fig. 3.4: Egyptian architecture and art works*



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 3.3

1. Pretend you are an architect. Using paper or drawings, make a building that shows one idea from ancient Egypt, like pyramids, columns, or temples. Write a few sentences to explain how your building is like Egyptian buildings and why it could be useful today.
2. Choose one Egyptian invention, like papyrus, medicine, math, or the calendar. Show how people use it today. You can write a few sentences.
3. Ancient Egyptians had problems with farming, building, or health. Imagine you are a scientist today. How would you solve the same problem using ideas from ancient Egypt? Draw or write your solution and explain why it works.



### END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

#### Knowledge and Understanding

1. List the main historical periods of ancient Egypt and identify one major event or achievement for each period
2. Explain how the River Nile helped the Egyptians build a strong and unified civilisation. Give at least two specific examples.
3. The Egyptians were skilled in mathematics and astronomy. Choose one example of how they used math or astronomy in daily. Explain how this knowledge contributed to their civilisation.

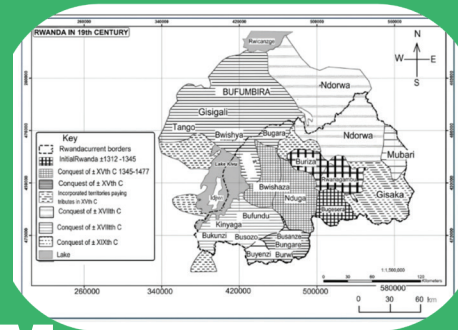
#### Skills

4. Imagine you are a farmer along the Nile during the Old Kingdom. How would you use the Egyptian irrigation systems, like shadoofs, to improve your crops? Draw your plan and explain why it would work.

#### Attitudes and Values

5. Why is it important for us today to study and appreciate the achievements of ancient Egyptian civilisation? Discuss two lessons about creativity, problem-solving, or innovation that we can learn from them.

# UNIT 4: ORIGIN AND EXPANSION OF RWANDA KINGDOM



## Key unit competence

Analyse the origin, growth, and expansion of the Rwanda Kingdom to understand its political, social, and cultural significance in Rwandan history.

## Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

### Knowledge and understanding

Explain the origin of the Rwanda Kingdom, including its founders and early leadership.

Describe the territorial expansion and political organisation of the Kingdom of Rwanda.

Identify the key social, political, and economic factors that influenced the growth of the Kingdom of Rwanda.

### Skills

Analyse the origin and formation of the Rwanda Kingdom.

Map the territorial growth of the Rwanda Kingdom over time

### Attitudes and Values:

Appreciate the cultural heritage and historical identity of Rwanda.

Value leadership, unity, and social cohesion as reflected in the Rwanda Kingdom

## Introduction

The Kingdom of Rwanda started a long time ago in the Great Lakes region of Africa. It began as a small kingdom led by a King called Umwami.

Rwandan kings expanded the kingdom through different conquests. Rwanda Kingdom expanded, focusing on major rulers, dynasties, and systems of administration that supported unity and growth. The social, political, and economic factors strengthened the kingdom. The king was helped by chiefs who managed army, land and cattle and all Rwandans were united under one king and shared culture and traditions. This unity made the kingdom strong and stable. In 19th century, Rwanda was a powerful and well organised kingdom.



### Introductory activity 4

1. Complete the sentences from the card with its related sentence from another card and rebuild the Kingdom Puzzle
  - "Gihanga....."
  - "..... considered as the founder of the Rwanda kingdom."
  - "Expansion happened because of....."
  - "..... strong military organization."
  - "The kingdom started in....."
  - ".....the central region near Gasabo."
  - "Clans such as....."
  - ".....Abanyiginya played a big role."
2. Rearrange the cards to form complete ideas or historical statements.
3. Probing questions after puzzle game:
  - a) What did you discover about where the Rwanda Kingdom started?
  - b) Which factors do you think helped the kingdom to grow and expand?
  - c) Why do you think strong leadership or unity was important in early Rwandan society?

## 4.1. Origin of the Rwanda Kingdom



### Learning activity 4.1

#### Exploring the Origins of the Rwanda Kingdom

Imagine you are young researcher exploring the hills of Gasabo, where the Rwanda Kingdom began. Your mission is to understand how small families and clans came together to form a Kingdom.

#### Questions

1. Have you heard stories about Gihanga or early Rwanda?
2. Why do people sometimes come together to form communities?
3. In your own words, explain how the Rwanda Kingdom began.

The Kingdom of Rwanda existed around 11<sup>th</sup> Century according to some historians. The word 'Rwanda' derives its name from Ikinyarwanda language verb 'Kwaanda' that means to 'expand'. It also means to 'enlarge' or 'increase in size'.

Rwanda Kingdom started as a small Nyiginya political entity (clanic state). The state was known as Rwanda rugari rwa Gasabo, meaning the vast Rwanda of Gasabo. It was located on the shores of Lake Muhazi, in today's one part of Gasabo District. It is believed that the founder of the Nyiginya dynasty was Gihanga Ngomijana.

Rwanda Kingdom was in the interlacustrine region. The monarchy of Rwanda was similar to earlier kingdoms in the region for instance Burundi, Buganda, Ankole, Karagwe, Bunyoro, Bushi among others. Through combination, conquering and annexing of smaller states, the united Rwanda spread all over in so many years.

According to a legend or myth of origin, the first ruling dynasty of Rwanda was the Nyiginya reign and the first ancestor of the Banyiginya was the mythical character known as Kigwa Sabizeze, the son of Shyerezo or Nkuba and Gasani. He is said to have fallen from heaven and landed in Mubari, in Eastern Rwanda near Akagera River.

This region was occupied by the Abazigaba under the reign of King Kabeja. According to official Nyiginya tradition, other Ibimanuka are Muntu, Kimanuka, Kijuru, Kobo, Merano, Randa, Gisa, Kizira, Kazi and Gihanga. Gihanga is believed to be the founder of the Nyiginya dynasty. He had, in fact, divided up his empire between his sons who then founded their kingdoms as follows:

Kanyandorwa received Ndorwa; Kagesera received Bugesera; Kanyabungo received Bunyabungo; Kanyabuha received Buha; Gashubi received Bushubi; Kanyarwanda, the successor of Gihanga received Rwanda.

According to the same tradition, these kings were known as Ibimanuka or Ibirari (traces). But they are followed by other two categories such as Abami b'Umushumi (Belt Kings) and Abami b' Ibitekerezo (Historical kings). It is said that Abami b'Umushumi were the kings whom they had not any known activities (deeds) while Abami b' Ibitekerezo were the kings who had contributed to the expansion of the kingdom of Rwanda.

**List of the Kings and their Queen- mother according to the chronology of Mgr Alex Kagame in Inganji Karinga,1943**

| <b>Royal name</b>                                    | <b>Traditional name</b> | <b>Queen -mother</b> | <b>Clan</b> | <b>Period of Reign</b> |
|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|-------------|------------------------|
| 1. Gihanga                                           | Ngomijana               | Nyirarukangaga       | Abazigaba   | 1091- 1124             |
| 2. Kanyarwanda I                                     | Gahima I                | Nyamasusa            | Abasinga    | 1124-1157              |
| 3. Yuhi I                                            | Musindi                 | Nyamata              | Abasinga    | 1157-1180              |
| 4 .                                                  | Rumeza                  | Kirezi               | Abasinga    |                        |
| 5.                                                   | Nyarume                 | Nyirashyoza          | Abasinga    |                        |
| 6.                                                   | Rukuge                  | Nyirankindi          | Abasinga    |                        |
| 7.                                                   | Rubanda                 | Nkundwa              | Abasinga    |                        |
| 8. Ndahiro I                                         | Ruyange                 | Nyamata              | Abasinga    | 1180 - 1213            |
| 9.                                                   | Ndoba                   | Monde                | Abega       | 1213 - 1246            |
| 10.                                                  | Samembe                 | Magondo              | Abaha       | 1246- 1279             |
| 11. Nsoro I                                          | Samukondo               | Nyakanga             | Abasinga    | 1279 - 1312            |
| 12. Ruganzu I                                        | Bwimba                  | Nyakanga             | Abasinga    | 1312 - 1345            |
| 13. Cyirima I                                        | Rugwe                   | Nyakiyaga            | Abega       | 1345- 1378             |
| 14. Kigeli I                                         | Mukobanya               | Nyanguge             | Abakono     | 1378 - 1411            |
| 15. Mibambwe I<br>Sekarongoro I                      | Mutabazi I              | Nyabadaha            | Abega       | 1411 - 1444            |
| 16. Yuhi II                                          | Gahima II               | Matama               | Abaha       | 1444- 1477             |
| 17. Ndahiro II                                       | Cyamatare               | Nyirangabo           | Abega       | 1477 - 1510            |
| 18. Ruganzu II                                       | Ndoli                   | Nyabacuzi            | Abakono     | 1510 - 1543            |
| 19.Mutara I Nsoro II                                 | Semugeshe               | Nyirakabogo          | Abega       | 1543- 1576             |
| 20. Kigeli II                                        | Nyamuheshera            | Ncendeli             | Abega       | 1576- 1609             |
| 21.Mibambwell<br>Sekarongoro II                      | Gisanura                | Nyabuhoro            | Abaha       | 1609- 1642             |
| 22. Yuhi III                                         | Mazimpaka               | Nyiramarembo         | Abakono     | 1642 - 1675            |
| 23. Cyirima II                                       | Rujugira                | Kirongoro            | Abega       | 1675 - 1708            |
| 24. Kigeli III                                       | Ndabarasa               | Rwesero              | Abagesera   | 1708- 1741             |
| 25.Mibambwe III<br>Mutabazi III                      | Sentabyo                | Nyiratamba           | Abega       | 1741- 1746             |
| 26. Yuhi IV                                          | Gahindiro               | Nyiratunga           | Abega       | 1746 -?                |
| 27. Mutara II                                        | Rwogera                 | Nyiramongi           | Abega       | ? – 1853               |
| 28. Kigeli IV                                        | Rwabugiri               | Murorunkwere         | Abakono     | 1853 - 1895            |
| 29. Mibambwe IV                                      | Rutarindwa              | Kanjogera            | Abega       | Co-regnant             |
| 30. Yuhi V                                           | Musinga                 | Kanjogera            | Abega       | 1895 - 1931            |
| 31. Mutara III<br>Rudahigwa (Charles<br>Léon Pierre) | Rudahigwa               | Kankazi              | Abega       | 1931 - 1959            |
| 32.Kigeli V (Jean<br>Baptiste)                       | Ndahindurwa             |                      |             | 1959 – 1961            |

## 4.2. Reasons for the expansion and decline of the Rwanda kingdom



### Learning activity 4.2

**Read the following context and answer the questions asked on it.**

Imagine you are young historian tasked with explaining why the Rwanda Kingdom grew to cover large areas and why it eventually declined. Your job is to explore the factors that helped it expand and those that led to its decline.

**Questions:**

1. How did the leadership of Gihanga and other kings contribute to the growth and expansion of the Rwanda kingdom?
2. In what ways did alliances between clans and the geography of Rwanda help strengthen and expand the kingdom?
3. How could disputes between kings or clans have weakened the Rwanda Kingdom over time?
4. Explain the ways which external attacks or social and economic challenges have contributed to the decline of the Rwanda Kingdom?
5. What lessons can we learn from the rise and fall of the Rwanda kingdom?

### 4.2.1. Reasons for expansion of the Rwanda kingdom

**i) The army (Ingabo) and the military ability of Rwandan people**

The Kingdom of Rwanda had a capable army of defending the kingdom. Young people were recruited into the army.

This was a sign of cooperation. The army was well trained, permanent and had enough traditional weapons for use during wars. In addition, they were physically fit and had a willing heart to serve the kingdom. It should be noted that every Rwandan was part of the army in one way or another.

**ii) Weak neighbouring kingdoms**

Rwanda Kingdom was militarily stronger than her neighbouring kingdoms. The kingdom was at first so small and centrally well organized. This made the administration of the kingdom easier. It took a short period of time to monitor and evaluate kingdom's projects. Expansion of the kingdom continued even after the kingdom had expanded.

**iii) Cultural unity**

All people in the Rwanda Kingdom spoke one language "Ikinyarwanda", throughout the kingdom. This acted as a unifying factor for growth and expansion. People in the Rwanda Kingdom had their traditional religion. They believed in "Imana (God)" whom they consulted in times of trouble. They praised Him in times of peace and offered sacrifices. This bound them together, hence favoured expansion and growth of the Rwandan kingdom.

#### **iv) Efficient leadership**

The kingdom of Rwanda had experienced, able and courageous leaders. The leaders fought so hard to maintain or even expand their kingdom.

#### **v) Patriotism and nationalism**

Patriotism and nationalism of Rwanda leaders made Rwandans regard expansion as a source of national glory and prestige. Besides, the people of Rwanda had a strong will of fighting for their kingdom. They also loved and served it whether in good or bad times. They were so dedicated and courageous to serve and defend wherever need arose. This contributed to its rise and expansion.

#### **vi) Motivation and rewards to the fighters**

In the kingdom of Rwanda, the fighters who had made great achievements in killing warriors from the enemy countries were given rewards according to the number of enemies killed as follows:

"Umudende" was rewarded a fighter who had managed to kill 7 enemies, Impotore a fighter who had killed 14 enemies while "Gucana uruti" was a ceremony organized in favour of a fighter that had killed 21 enemies in one war of conquest or defence of the country. By receiving these rewards, Rwandan warriors were encouraged to participate in expansion of their kingdom.

#### **Remember!**

Kigali City has steadily grown in the recent past due to reasons such as able leaders, political stability, unity and trade. These, among others, are the reasons that contributed to the growth of the Rwanda Kingdom.

### **4.2.2. Reasons for the downfall of Rwanda Kingdom**

#### **i) The coming of Europeans and consequent colonization of Rwanda**

The first contact the Rwanda Kingdom had with Europeans was in September 1892. Dr Oscar Baumann and Graf von Götzen who came in 1894 wrote a comprehensive report about the Kingdom. Rwanda officially became a protectorate in 1897. This was the beginning of the downfall of Rwanda Kingdom.

The coming of the Belgians in 1916 also weakened the kingdom. They introduced reforms that reduced the kings' powers. For instance, they abolished traditional institutions such as ubwiru and umuganura in 1925 which helped the king to govern.

#### **ii) Succession disputes**

The Kingdom of Rwanda lost one of its famous and prosperous kings, Kigeli IV Rwabugiri, in 1895. This was followed by succession wrangles. The prince heir Rutarindwa (Mibambwe IV) became the king. However, his stepmother (Queen mother) Kanjogera helped by her brothers like Kabare and Ruhinankiko, organised the Rucuncu Coup, because she wanted Musinga to become the king. Musinga was her son. This brought power conflicts in the kingdom which ended with European intervention.

### iii) Revolts and rejection of Musinga as king

There were numerous revolts in the Rwandan Kingdom during King Musinga's rule. These revolts weakened the kingdom. For instance, the consequences of Rucunshu Coup, the Basebya, Ndungutse and Rukara revolts in the North of the kingdom. Other revolts were those of Nyiragahumuza. The revolts destabilised the

kingdom.

### iv) Death of able leaders

The death of leaders such as mysterious circumstances death of Mutara III Rudahigwa in Bujumbura followed by the 1959 political and ethnic violence led to the end of the kingdom. This latter caused many Tutsi to be massacred, and many others fleeing to neighbouring states. Together with the complicity of the Belgian power, the kingdom experienced a Coup d'Etat of Gitarama. This led to the abolition of the monarchy on 28th January 1961 and subsequent declaration of the republic confirmed by the referendum on September 25th, 1961.



## APPLICATION ACTIVITY 4.2

1. How did the Rwandan army, cultural unity, and leadership contribute to the growth and expansion of the Rwanda kingdom?
2. Kigali City has grown in recent years due to the leadership, political stability, and unity. Compare these modern factors with the reasons for the expansion of the Rwanda Kingdom.
3. Examine the impact of European colonization, succession disputes, and revolts on the weakening of the Rwanda kingdom.
4. Imagine you are advising a country today on how to avoid decline like the Rwanda Kingdom. Based on the historical factors you studied, what lessons would you give to leaders?

## 4.3. The important monarchs



### Learning activity 4.3

**Read the following scenario and answer the questions related to it.**

You are a young historian exploring Rwanda's royal heritage, visiting historical sites, palaces, and monuments. Elders share stories about notable kings and queens, including Gihanga, founder of the Nyiginya dynasty, and Kigeli IV Rwabugiri, who expanded the kingdom. You reflect on their achievements, leadership qualities, and how they helped unify and strengthen the kingdom.

#### Questions

1. Who were the most important monarchs in Rwanda and why?
2. What achievements made these kings or queens memorable?
3. How did the leadership styles of these monarchs contribute to the stability and growth of their kingdoms?

The Kingdom of Rwanda too had its leaders. The most important kings of Rwanda and their achievements are described below.

### **King Ruganzu I Bwimba (1312-1345)**

His father was called Nsoro I and his mother was Nyiraruganzu Nyakanga. He succeeded his father Nsoro I Samukondo around 1312 according to A. Kagame Chronology. His younger sister was called Robwa. King Ruganzu I Bwimba and her sister Robwa are regarded as liberators of the kingdom. Under the reign of Ruganzu I Bwimba, the capital of Rwanda was Gasabo and was delimited by the Nyabarongo River in the West, Lake Muhazi at the East and Base River in the North. At this time, Rwanda occupied the following territories: Buganza, Buriza, Bumbogo, Busigi, Busarasi and Bwanacyambwe. Ruganzu died in the war at Gisaka in 1345. He died while trying to expand the borders of Rwanda Kingdom.

### **Kigeli I Mukobanya (1378-1411)**

He was the son of Cyilima I Rugwe. He succeeded his father in 1378. During his reign, he carried out numerous conquests to the west of River Nyabarongo. Kigeli I Mukobanya is much known as someone who had abolished the authority of the kings whose territories were conquered. However, under his reign, the Kingdom of Rwanda was attacked, invaded and occupied by the Banyoro for a short time. King Mukobanya escaped through Nyabarongo River in the kingdom of Nduga under the reign of Nkuba from Ababanda dynasty.

### **Ruganzu II Ndoli (1510-1543)**

Ruganzu came from exile in Karagwe in Tanzania where he had lived with King Karemera I Ndagara who had married his paternal aunt Nyabunyana and returned to Rwanda.

Being informed about the death of Nsibura I Nyebunga, Ruganzu was enthroned at Gatsibo in Ndorwa on the royal names of Ruganzu II Ndoli. He took over the territories which had been conquered by Byinshi of Ndorwa. After he enthroned a new royal emblem-drum called Karinga to replace Rwoga. Karinga was assisted by other two emblem-drums: Karihejuru and Bariba.

After organizing his powerful army, Ibisumizi and Ingangurarugo, Ruganzu II Ndori began wars of conquest to expand Rwanda. He annexed the island of Ijwi and Bunyabungo in revenge for his father Ndahiro II Cyamatatare. He conquered Bugoyi, Byahi, Bwishya, Burera and Bufumbira.

In the south, Ruganzu II Ndori annexed Bunyambiriri after killing its leader Gisurere and Burwi and killed its king Nyaruzi. He helped King Rwagitare of Bugesera to conquer Burundi. He annexed Bwanamukari after killing its leader Mpandahandi.

In an effort to annex Bungwe, Ruganzu II Ndoli fell in an ambush of the inhabitants of Rusenyi at Bwishaza today in Karongi district. They shot him with an arrow in the eye and died of wounds at Butansinda of Kigoma in the current District of Ruhango in 1543 and he was buried in Butangampundu; in today Rulindo District.

## Mutara I Nsoro II Semugeshi (1543 – 1576)

The king Mutara I Nsoro II Semugeshi was enthroned on the name of Bicuba, but this name was quickly abandoned and replaced by Mutara from the area of Mutara which was rich with the cows.

He had defeated Benengwe or a confederation of Bufundu, Busanza and Bungwe from Benginzage nickname Nyagakecuru who had the residence at Huye mountain. From that time the frontier of Rwanda reached at Burundi. Mutara I signed a non-aggression pact with Mutaga II Nyamubi of Burundi in Utwicarabami twa Nyaruteja in today Gisagara district. Mutara I Nsoro II Semugeshi is also known by his royal reforms he had made as follows:

1. *The king must introduce, during his living days, to three confidants the name of his successor;*
2. He suppressed the following dynastic names:
  - Nsoro because it was known to Bugesera;
  - Ndahiro because the last Ndahiro had lost the emblem-drum (Rwoga);
  - Ruganzu because the two holders of this name have been killed by enemies.
3. He determined the succession order for the five dynastic name and those names should follow each other in cycle of four generations as shown below:

| First generation | Second generation | Third generation | Fourth generation |
|------------------|-------------------|------------------|-------------------|
| Mutara           | Cyilima           | Mutara           | Cyilima           |
| Kigeli           | Kigeli            | Kigeli           | Kigeli            |
| Mibambwe         | Mibambwe          | Mibambwe         | Mibambwe          |
| Yuhi             | Yuhi              | Yuhi             | Yuhi              |

- The kings who's the dynastic names of Mutara and Cyilima were reputed to be the Kings of cows;
- The kings who's the dynastic names of Kigeli and Mibambwe were reputed to be the warriors Kings or the fighters;
- The kings who's the dynastic names of Yuhi were reputed to be the lineage, fire or ritual Kings.

## Cyilima II Rujugira (1675-1708)

He acceded to power when the country was experiencing the succession disputes between him and Karemera Rwaka. His father was Yuhi III Mazimpaka and his mother was Nyiracyilima Kirongoro.

He was faced to imminent invasions from all sides (Bugesera, Burundi, Gisaka and Ndorwa). He attacked them and defeated them. He also fought and defeated Buyenzi, Buganza, Rutare, Muhura, Giti. He then annexed them to the Kingdom of Rwanda. During his reign, a popular saying developed. It said "Urwanda ruratera nti ruterwa" (Rwanda invades but is not invaded).

Cyirima II Rujugira had defeated Burundi over the territory of Buyenzi after killing its king Mutaga Senyamwiza, Ndorwa over Umutara and Gisaka over Buganza. He died at a very old age at a place called Ntora (current Ntora Cell, Gisozi Sector in Gasabo

District today). From that time, the place took a name of Gisozi meaning a hill from where king died. His body is still kept at National Museum of Rwanda.

He also created militias whose names ended up being adapted as names of some regions, for example Nyakare (from Inyakare), Imvejuru (from Mvejuru), Nyaruguru (from Inyaruguru) and Buhanga-Ndara (from Indara). This was because of his innovation of creating Ingerero, which were armies to protect the borders. He later died in 1708.

### **KIGELI III Ndabarasa (1708-1741)**

Kigeli III Ndabarasa was the son of Cyilima Rujugira and Nyirakigeli Rwesero who came to power in about 1708. Ndabarasa did not rule together with his mother Rwesero as she had passed away earlier. He adopted a queen-mother, Nyiratunga who was a cousin to his late mother. His royal palace was at Rutare in Byumba, today's Gicumbi district.

Among his achievements in expansion of the kingdom include the following:

- He conquered Ndorwa and established there his leadership style.
- He attacked and killed the king of Mubari called Biyoro and his mother Nyirabiyoro who lived on Shango Island of lake Ihema.
- He put to an end the Zigaba dynasty in Mubari and incorporated the region in parts of Rwanda kingdom
- He attacked and defeated Bugesera Kingdom.

Ndabarasa died on a battle-field, at a place called Joma in Gaseke in about 1741 and was buried at Munanira where kings of the royal name of Kigeli and Cyilima were supposed to be buried.

### **Yuhi IV Gahindiro (1746-1802)**

His father was called Mibambwe III Sentabyo and his mother was Nyirayuhi Nyiratunga. He occupied the throne when he was an infant of one year. He had two regents; his mother and an uncle named Rugagi. He had an outstanding army. He fought, defeated and annexed south Ndorwa and Buhunde. However, during his reign, Rwanda experienced great famine and drought called Rukungugu.

### **Mutara II Rwogera (1802-1853)**

His father was Yuhi Gahindiro and his mother was Nyiramavugo Nyiramongi. He was commonly known as a man who was humble, kind and welcoming. During his reign, he fought, defeated and annexed Gisaka but failed to capture their royal town.

Also, during his reign, the island of Ijwi declared itself independent from Rwanda. This was a shame to Rwanda Kingdom. He died of tuberculosis in 1853.

### **Kigeli IV Rwabugiri (1853-1895)**

By the death of Mutara II Rwogera his son succeeded him to the throne with the name of Kigeli IV Sezisoni. But this name of Sezisoni will be abandoned and replaced by Rwabugiri from his little brother Rwabugiri the son of Gaceyeye and the latter took the name of Rwakageyo. Definitely the new king was known on the royal names of Kigeli IV Rwabugiri.



*Fig.4.1: Kigeli IV Rwabugiri*

The mother of Kigeli IV Rwabugiri was called Nyirakigeri Murorunkwere. Kigeli IV Rwabugiri was one of the most prosperous and famous kings of Rwanda. He was a renown warrior. He re-organised the army to consolidate his rule. He is also known to have centralised the power and strengthened structures.

He succeeded in consolidation and organization of Gisaka conquered by his father Mutara II Rwogera. He also controlled other regions which had been annexed before his reign. He was a great administrator with many residences: Nyanza, Rubengera (today Karongi District), Giseke (in current Nyaruguru district), Kigali, Gasabo, Kabuye (in Gasabo district today) Gatsibo etc. He was also a great conqueror and he exercised his authority over the following areas:

- The regions of Masisi (Tongo, Gishari and Gisigari), Bwishya, Jomba and Ruchuru (today in Democratic Republic of Congo);
- The regions of Bufumbira and Ndorwa (today in Uganda).

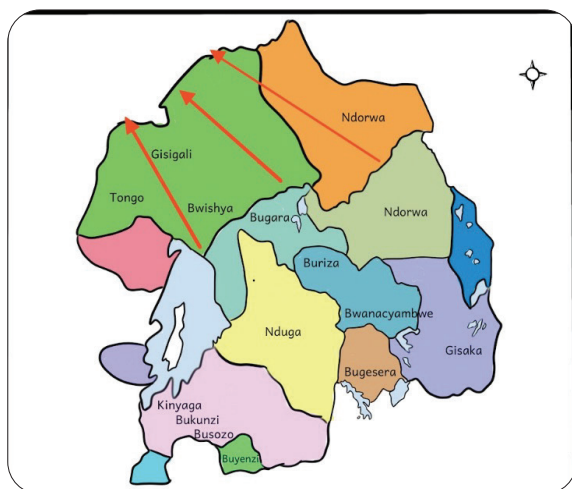
Nevertheless, some states remained as Satellites (controlled and depended to Central administration of Rwanda kingdom) and they should pay the tributes: Gisaka ( Rukurura royal emblem)(Ngoma district today ), Ndorwa (Murorwa royal emblem) (today South Uganda), Bungwe (Nyamibande royal emblem), Bugesera (Rukombamazi royal emblem), Nduga (Nyabahinda royal emblem)(current Kamonyi, Muhanga, Ruhango and part of Nyanza), Bushiru (Nkundabashiru royal emblem) (today Nyabihu district), Bugara (Rugara royal emblem), Bungwe ( current in Nyamagabe and Nyaruguru districts), Mubari ( today in Gatsibo district). Others were autonomous with different roles:

- Busigi, Busozo and Bukunzi (in current Rusizi District): great rainmakers;
- Bumbogo (Gasabo district today): preparation of Umuganura;
- Bugoyi (Mpatsibihugu)( Rubavu district) : Tobacco;
- Bufundu and Bunyambiriri (current in Nyamagabe district): Umutsama of beer from honey.

The end of the reign of Kigeli IV Rwabugiri has been marked by the following events:

- The coming to the throne of Rutarindwa as co-regnant of Rwabugiri on December 22, 1889 with Konjogera as his adoptive Queen-mother, because his mother had died;
- The introduction of manufactured goods from Europe and Asia in big quantities;
- The foundation of the army with fire arms;
- The coming of the Europeans as Doctor Oscar Baumann in 1892 and Comte Von Göetzen in 1894;
- The stabilization of the frontiers of Rwanda;
- The failure to defeat Bunyabungo (today Bukavu in DRC) and Burundi;
- The killing of his mother Nyirakigeli IV Murorunkwere;
- The killing of many royal members in revenge of his mother;
- The introduction of the new food crops in order to develop the agriculture;
- Migration of some Rwandans to Maniema the mining region in Democratic Republic of Congo.

King Rwabugiri died in 1895 and was buried at Rutare in northern Rwanda Kingdom.



### Remember!

As a student, you should always have a patriotic spirit, do good things like helping the needy. You are an important citizen like the great kings.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 4.3

1. Choose two kings from the list (e.g., Ruganzu I Bwimba, Kigeli IV Rwabugiri) and create a profile table showing: Name of the king, period of reign, major achievements, territories expanded or controlled
2. Using a blank map of Rwanda, mark the territories conquered or annexed by Ruganzu II Ndoli, Kigeli I Mukobanya, and Cyirima II Rujugira.
3. Discuss how the leadership styles of Mutara II Rwogera and Kigeli IV Rwabugiri (e.g., army re-organization, administration, centralization of power, use of diplomacy) helped stabilize and strengthen the kingdom.



## END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and Understanding

1. Who was the founder of the Nyiginya dynasty, and what territories did he divide among his sons?
2. List three major achievements of Kigeli IV Rwabugiri during his reign.
3. Explain the significance of the royal succession reforms introduced by Mutara I Nsoro II Semugeshi.

### Skills

1. Create a timeline of Ruganzu I Bwimba, Kigeli I Mukobanya, Ruganzu II Ndoli, Mutara I Nsoro II Semugeshi, and Kigeli IV Rwabugiri, highlighting their main achievements.
2. Compare the leadership of **Ruganzu II Ndoli** and **Kigeli IV Rwabugiri**. In a short paragraph, explain whose strategies were more effective in expanding and consolidating the Rwandan kingdom.

### Attitudes and Values

1. Explain how the patriotism and commitment of Rwandan kings and their warriors can inspire citizens today.
2. Explain why unity and cooperation are important in leadership when facing succession conflicts and foreign invasions.
3. What can today's leaders learn from the courage, vision, and leadership skills of Rwanda's kings to promote peace and development?

# UNIT 5:

## ORGANIZATION OF PRE-COLONIAL RWANDA

### ORGANISATION OF PRE-COLONIAL RWANDA



#### Key Unit Competence:

Analyse the political, social, and economic organization of pre-colonial Rwanda to understand its influence on contemporary Rwandan society.

#### Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

#### Knowledge and understanding

Analyse the political and social organization of pre-colonial Rwanda by examining the roles of the Mwami, chiefs, clans, and families.

Describe the structure and functions of *Itorero* and explain how it contributed to unity, discipline, and patriotism in ancient Rwanda.

Identify and assess key economic activities and cultural practices that supported the kingdom and strengthened social cohesion in pre-colonial Rwanda.

#### Skills

Compare the political and administrative structures of pre-colonial Rwanda with those of modern Rwanda, highlighting key similarities and differences.

Analyse the functions, organization, and societal contribution of *Itorero* as a system of moral, cultural, and social education.

Examine and compare the social and political roles that existed within pre-colonial Rwanda, including their influence **on governance and community life**.

#### Attitudes and Values:

Demonstrate appreciation for Rwanda's cultural heritage and historical identity through positive attitudes and responsible behaviour.

Apply the values of unity, respect, discipline, and patriotism learned from the traditional *Itorero* system in daily interactions and decision-making.

Show respect for traditional Rwandan institutions and cultural practices by acknowledging their importance in maintaining social harmony and identity.

## Introduction

This unit helps learners explore how Rwandan society was structured and governed before colonial rule by examining the key institutions, leadership systems, and community arrangements that shaped life in the Rwanda Kingdom. It covers the political structure led by the Mwami, the roles of chiefs and local leaders, the social organization of clans and families, the cultural and moral training provided through *Itorero*, and the economic activities that sustained the kingdom. Learners will also discover how traditional practices, cultural values, and territorial administration contributed to unity, discipline, and social cohesion, helping them better understand Rwanda's cultural heritage and historical identity.

**Key concepts include:** Mwami, chiefs and local leaders, clans and families, *Itorero*, social organization, political structure, economic activities, cultural practices, and territorial administration.



### Introductory activity 5

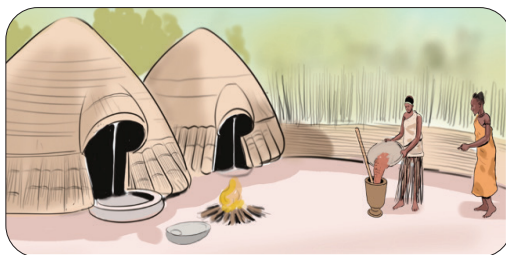
1. Describe the different leadership roles that existed in Pre-Colonial Rwanda and explain their responsibilities.
2. Explain how the political and administrative organization of Pre-Colonial Rwanda helped maintain unity and order.
3. Analyse the importance of farming, cattle keeping, trade, and craftsmanship in the economy of Pre-Colonial Rwanda.
4. Discuss the role of cultural institutions such as *Itorero* in promoting values, skills, and national identity.
5. Compare the organisation of Pre-colonial Rwanda with modern Rwanda, highlighting both similarities

## 5.1. Social organization of the Rwandan traditional society



### Learning activity 5.1

Observe quietly the following images and answer the questions below:



1. Explain who were the main members and groups that made up traditional Rwandan society?
2. How do you think people in traditional Rwanda were grouped or organized?
3. Identify the roles and responsibilities did families, clans, and elders have in community life?
4. Why do you think cooperation and respect were important in traditional society?
5. In what ways are families and communities organized today, and how does this compare with traditional Rwandan society?

### 5.1.1. Family, lineage and clan

The social organization of Pre-colonial Rwanda was based on three main elements including nuclear family, lineage and clan.

#### Nuclear Family

In ancient Rwanda, the nuclear family consisted mainly of a father, mother, and their children. It was an important basic unit of society, although it was closely connected to the extended family and clan. The father was generally responsible for protecting and providing for the family, while the mother cared for the children and participated in farming and other household activities. Children helped with family work and learned important skills, values, traditions, and responsibilities from their parents and other relatives. The family was also an economic unit involved mainly in agriculture and livestock keeping. Marriage was important in establishing a new household, but the nuclear family continued to maintain strong relationships with relatives, lineage, and clan members. Therefore, the nuclear family in ancient Rwanda played important roles in child upbringing, economic production, protection, socialization, and transmission of culture and traditions. For polygamy, a man had many wives. Every wife had her own homestead and their husband used to visit them one after one.



#### Naming a child

In ancient Rwanda, child naming (Kwita izina) was an important cultural and social ceremony held traditionally on the eighth day after birth. Before the ceremony, the mother and baby remained in seclusion for about seven days. On the eighth day, the baby was brought outside for the first time (gusohora umwana) and presented to family, relatives, friends, and neighbours. Children also participated in a ritual called kurya ubunnyano, where they cultivated a small piece of land, received food and milk, and proposed names for the baby. The mother could also suggest names, but the father traditionally had the final choice and could name the child after a grandfather, great-grandfather, respected person, hero, or according to circumstances surrounding the child's birth. The ceremony strengthened family relationships, community unity, cultural identity, and the child's integration into society.

According to the Rwandan mentality, an increased number of children brought happiness and strength to the family. Marriage of a daughter made it possible to extend alliances with other lineage groups.

A daughter was considered as a linking factor between families. The lineage and eventually the army were responsible for the socialization of children.

## Lineage

The lineage is a set of several families descending from one common and real ancestor and recognizable because of the genealogical tree traces. People who claim the same lineage take on the name of the common ancestors. Apart carrying a proper genealogic remembrance, the members of the same lineage have kept a minimum residential unity.

In the traditional Rwanda, two types of lineages were distinguished: the minor lineage **"inzu"** and major lineage **"umuryango"**. A minor lineage was created when members of the same family could be named after a common and real ancestor thanks to his fame yielded from his great achievements while, on the other side, the birth of a major lineage was done when within a minor lineage there was the emergence of another strong leader whose descendants could be recognized under his name but who went on also being named after their former eponym ancestor.

### **The following are examples of names of some lineages:**

1. Abarashi of Nyakarashi
2. Abananura of Kananura
3. Abahindiro of Gahindiro

## Clan

The term "clan" corresponds to the term **"ubwoko"** in Kinyarwanda language and its institution neither has a chief or a particular internal organization". The term "clan" means a group of people who claim to be descendants from one common mythical ancestor. It is a legendary group or a fabulous ascendancy to which a group of people are attached.

However, it is not always possible to establish all the genealogic ties between the common ancestor and the entire group. Besides, the clan implies a social category and not a corporate group and it has no procedures that manage business of common benefits.

The clan is different from a small lineage **"inzu"** and from a big lineage **"umuryango"**. The clan is not even a residential grouping; its members are located all over the country.

The clan is a set of several lineages claiming a same mythic common ancestor, but rather far off and fictitious. It is not easy to trace it using a genealogical tree. The members of same clan share the same culture, same taboos and same totem.

The clan is a group, which is characterized by a biological relationship shared by members who show mutual solidarity. The clan's totem symbolizes unity among its members.

In reality, the clan is not a descendant group, but clan members have common ties which are instead social identities of individual identification in relationship with

others, a way to find friend almost from anywhere and benefit from their hospitality or their support. These entities also play a role in marriage because in principle the exogamy of clans prevails in the choice of the partner.

Clans also have animal totems and when possible, animal taboos. The main clans had totems as their recognition sign, in this situation they were from animal species: an animal, a bird, a mammal, batrachians and a reptile.

The following are totems that have been identified and their animal totems:

| No | Clan                     | Totem                    |
|----|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. | Abanyiginya              | Crested crane (Umusambi) |
| 2. | Abazigaba                | Leopard (Ingwe)          |
| 3. | Abagesera                | Wagtail (Inyamanza)      |
| 4. | Abasinga                 | Kate (Sakabaka)          |
| 5. | Abacyaba                 | Hyena (Impyisi)          |
| 6. | Ababanda                 | Crow (Igikona)           |
| 7. | Abega, Abakono and Abaha | Frog/Toad (Igikeri)      |

Certain clans have taboo. Banyiginya have "impwi" as their taboo. Impwi is a variety of antelope living in high altitude forests, with short horns and rounded cheeks. Bega have as taboo "frog (igikeri)". Bagesera have a monkey as taboo. Basinga have as a taboo "Inka y'Inyombya" which is a cow with small black and brown parts on the skin.

### 5.1.2. Alliance and solidarity in traditional society.

The alliance between families and individuals was reinforced and maintained through marriage and solidarity.

#### Traditional marriage.



Fig. 5.1: People transporting a bride

**Source:** Republic of Rwanda, Ministry of Education, National Curriculum Development Centre, (2010), *The History of Rwanda Secondary Schools Teacher's Guide, Module I & II*, Kigali, Page 41.

The dowry generally consisted of a cow, but it could also consist of goats and hoes depending on the region. As for people of lower social standing, dowry consisted of services rendered by the future husband in the home of his future father-in-law. In fact, this last category was tantamount to free marriage.

In ancient Rwanda, betrothal was a community and family affair rather than an individual one (boy and girl), structured around the Gusaba (formal request) and

the Gukwa (dowry, often cows). It was an alliance between families aimed at strengthening social ties, involving careful negotiations between elders to validate the union.

**The Gusaba (Proposal):** The groom's family initiated the process by formally asking the girl's family for her hand in marriage. It was a formal ceremony where words and rhetoric played a major role.

### 5.1.3. Solidarity

Solidarity is a result of an alliance between individuals and families and the feeling which pushes people towards mutual assistance. This manifests itself through various actions and attitudes:

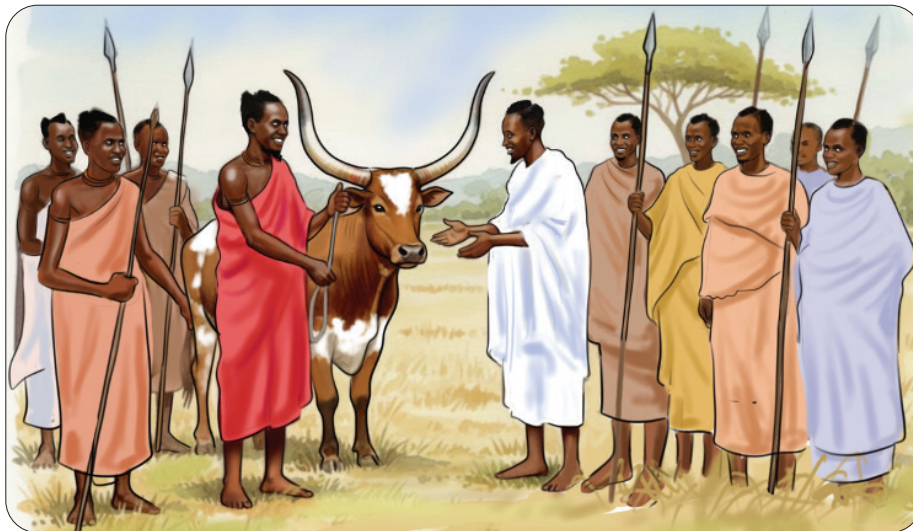
#### **Blood pact (Kunywana / Guca ku nda)**

Blood pact was more serious and permanent because it involved a ritual of blood. The individuals who wanted to make this blood pact would suck a little of each other's blood and drink it to signify eternal or unending friendship.

#### **Rescuing (Gutabarana)**

Rescuing was physical mutual help. It also meant being very close to the family friend in order to help and support each other. For instance, this could be the case in time of emergency like when a friend or a neighbour had lost a member of his or her family.

#### **Giving a cow (Guhana inka)**



#### **Giving a cow**

Giving cow each other also strengthened friendship between families and individuals. The cow was a very strong social bond and was a great importance in society because it is considered the foundation of the social fabric. This practice was considered so serious that the person who received the cow would at times swear by the name of

donors: "Yampaye inka ...! (He has given me a cow!)"

#### 5.1.4. Division of labour

In the Rwandan society, it is worth noting that every able member even young child had to be active. But all members of the society were not equally strong. Therefore, there were activities reserved for certain categories of people: men, women and children.

**For men:** to build houses, to herd cows or goats and to serve in the army, to fish, to hunt, to dig the fields,

**For women:** to look after babies, to maintain the house, to manage the family economy, to prepare the food, to weave, to fetch water and to collect firewood;

**For children:** to collect firewood, to fetch water, to herd cows or goats, to sweep or clean house.

As the children grew up, parents began initiating them in the work of adults according to their sex. Boys educated by their father and in Itorero while girls educated by their mother (mu rubohero). "They were taught Rwandan cultural values of a good woman, such as managing family resources, being a good wife and mother, and raising children who honour Rwanda."

#### Education

Rwandans had informal education which was general and Intore education.

Education went with sex and age brackets. Young girls were taught by their mothers and paternal aunts. Boys were taught by their fathers on hunting and agriculture. Young boys from rich families went to the king's palace to be trained. They were trained on warrior drills and were commonly known as Intore.



#### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 5.1

1. Which elements of the nuclear family, lineage, or clan from pre-colonial Rwanda can still be observed in families or communities today? Explain your answer with one example.
2. Create a simple diagram showing the three levels of social organisation in traditional Rwanda (family → lineage → clan). Include one example of a lineage and its clan totem.
3. Traditional Rwandans showed solidarity through practices. Identify one example of solidarity in your community today and explain how it is similar or different from traditional practices.
4. Compare three traditional tasks performed by men, women, or children in pre-colonial Rwanda with roles in families today. Which traditional role has changed the most, and why?
5. Design a today's version of *Itorero* for young people. Describe the values it teaches, what activities would include and how and how would it promote, strengthen unity and discipline in society.

## 5.2. Political and military organization of pre-colonial Rwanda.



### Learning activity 5.2

#### Story: The Kingdom on the Hills

##### Read the following story and answer the question asked on it

Long ago, in the hills of Gasabo, there was a growing kingdom called Rwanda. The Mwami, or king, ruled wisely with the help of his chiefs, who managed different regions. Each chief had a group of warriors who protected the people and enforced the laws of the kingdom.

One day, the Mwami noticed that neighbouring clans were planning to raid the villages. He called a council with his chiefs and military leaders. Together, they planned a strategy to defend their people. The warriors well trained and organized patrols, while the chiefs ensured the villages were ready to support them.

During the raid, the warriors successfully defended the kingdom, protecting the farmers and traders. The Mwami praised the chiefs and soldiers, reminding everyone that unity, discipline, and cooperation were the keys to a strong kingdom.

After the battle, the Mwami visited the conquered areas to listen to the people's concerns. He rewarded bravery but also taught that leaders must care for their people's wellbeing.

The Kingdom of Rwanda also had its administrative system. The Kingdom of Rwanda is known to have started in a small area of Gasabo. It enlarged to a bigger size and was named Rwanda Rugari rwa Gasabo, meaning the big size of Rwanda.

The kingdom of Rwanda was headed by a king with a title of Umwami. This gave him dignity and respect among others.

The political and administrative structure of Pre-colonial Rwanda mainly that of the 19th Century under the rule of King Kigeri IV Rwabugiri was built on four pillars, namely a monarchy conceived in terms of a theocracy, a two-headed monarchy (King and Queen Mother), and a policy of territorial aggrandizement, conquest and patriotism.

### 5.2.1. Political organisation

The Pre-colonial Rwanda had several institutions reinforced by the king and his representatives. These institutions include Ubwiru (court secrets), Ubuhake (gifts of cows), Ubusizi (dynastic poetry was important in legitimizing the ruling king), Ubucurabwenge (knowledge on the dynastic genealogy), Ibitekerezo by'Imiryango (family historic narratives), etc. In effect, the structure of King Rwabugiri's political organisation was complex. But all in all, the entire system of government rotated around the king and the court. The Ancient kingdom of Rwanda was divided into Ibiti or Districts which were large constituencies covering several hills and villages. Ibiti were divided into Ibikingi which were a collection of different hills where administrative authority was exercised. Igikingi consisted of division (a hill or a sub-

hill) rich in pastures which was part of the provincial division. The king gave land to cattle keepers who became his direct clients and who were only indebted to him. The Ibikingi were similar to subchieftaincy divisions of the colonial era. There were two types of Ibikingi: the 'administrative Igikingi' and 'pastoral Igikingi'. It should be noted that some administrative Ibikingi could coincide with pastoral Ibikingi.

- Some Ibikingi depended on royal authority ruled by the king's representative called "Igisinga";
- Others belonged to the chiefs of the traditional militias;
- The last category of Ibikingi was known as "Ingarigari" belonged to the Queen-Mother.

Administration in Pre-colonial Rwanda was centralized; all powers were in the hands of the Umwami (King) and he was assisted in his functions by Umugabekazi (Queen-mother), Custodians of the esoteric code (Abiru) and chiefs.

### **King (Umwami )**

The army and patriotism were the main instruments used to achieve the monarchy's goals and objectives but the court was the cornerstone and workshop where the Nyiginya State was shaped.

He occupied the topmost position in the political, administrative and military hierarchy to the extent that these functions were closely linked. Following his nomination, the king identified himself as a separate entity from the nobility. The kingdom of Rwanda was sacred and the king was therefore supposed to have the divine origin. The term Imana (God) refers to the Creator but also to the essence of life and the fertility of the land and humans. The king and dynastic drums were the very centre of unity in the kingdom.

The king was the sole proprietor of everything and had every right to life and death over his subjects. He was also in charge of the armies, lawmaker and supreme judge. His sentences had no appeal.

The king, as the head of the kingdom, had daily life that was rather unique. He lived alongside Abiru who performed various rituals as kingdom ritualists. Some words were specifically used on the life style of the king.

#### **For example:**

- Carrying him on a stretcher (Kuremererwa)
- His speech (Irivuze umwami)
- His palace (Ingoro)
- Travelling (Kurambagira)
- His death (Gutanga)



*Fig. 5.2: Royal drums (Kalinga)*

The king usually came from Abanyiginya clan. The king's authority had a symbol of a sacred royal drum called Kalinga. There were other small drums such as

Kiragutse, Mpatsibihugu and Rucabagome.

### **Queen-mother (Umugabekazi)**

She was usually the mother/ rarely step mother of the king. She could perform some ceremonies defined by the tradition. She was the confident and chief advisor to the king. She could orient the king's actions and act as regent in case the king came to the throne when he was still young.

### **Custodians of the esoteric code (Abiru)**

They were the guardians of the tradition and royal secrets. They were high dignitaries and they came second as advisors of the king. They mastered the rites and symbolic procedures and processes of the kingdom and their accomplishment. Their chief was supposed to be selected from Abatsobe clan. The king confided to them the name of his successor and he passed recommendations to the successor through them.

Abiru were responsible for the continuity of traditional and were under the authority of the king. Their function was hereditary. They were also responsible for knowing:

- The order in which queens were chosen and the matri-dynastic clan (Ibibanda) of the next queen-mother (Abega, Abasinga, Abaha, Abazigaba, Abagesera and Abakono);
- Rules of enthronement of the new king (Inzira y'ubwimike);
- Rules regarding decoration of royal drums.

Ubwiru was an institution with a text of eighteen Inzira (but only seventeen are available). In Pre-colonial Rwanda, Ubwiru was a very important legal reference and can be compared to a constitution in modern Rwanda. The content of Ubwiru is presented as follows:

- Irage ry'abami (permanent last wills of the kings);
- Umurage w'ingoma (will of succession to the throne);
- Inzira z'ubwiru (fixed official text of the ritual);
- Intekerezo z'ubwiru (history and comment of the three preceding titles).

The examples of some rituals or inzira z'ubwiru:

- Inzira ya Gicurasi (procedures for mourning or more specifically, the procedures of closing the National mourning)
- Inzira y'umuriro (fire procedures)
- Inzira y' umuganura (procedures of handling the feast of the first rains)

### **Important!**

Abiru were in different categories such as Abiru b'Imihango (Ritual Specialists), Abiru b'Amategako n'Ubwiru (Guardians of Laws and Secrets), and among others. However, all of these departments were finally brought under two main categories namely Abanyesubyo and Abanyamusumba.

*Abanyesubyo* were responsible of recruiting a new secret keeper, practicing kunywesha isubyo ceremony (considered like today's swearing in ceremony) while *Abanyamusumba* organised and performed some royal ceremonies such umuganura and planting a tree called Umusumba at the enthronement of a new king symbolizing prosperity and power of the new king over his subjects.

## Chiefs (Abatware b'intebe)

They were the heads of Ibiti appointed by the king and lived most of their lives in the royal court. They were consulted by the king especially in the time of crises. They had following functions of:

- Controlling farmers and cattle keepers;
- Supervising closely and control the functions of land and cattle sub-chiefs;
- Commanding the army;
- Raising taxes for the king, ikoro and other services;
- Distributing land and to withdraw it from others if it was felt necessary.

The great chiefs (Abatware b'intebe) were largely responsible for the recruitment and mobilization of the mass as far as the protection and maintenance of security of the country were concerned.

At the level of "Igikingi" the administration was insured by three chiefs. These chiefs were appointed by the king depending on their merit or the merit of their families.

### Chief responsible of land (Umutware w' ubutaka)

He was in charge of agricultural production and responsible for collecting royal tribute, "ikoro" from agricultural production. He had the responsibility to settle disputes arising from land issues like land distribution and settling new inhabitants on his land.

### The chief responsible for cattle (Umutware w'umukenke)

He was responsible for pastures in his Igikingi and collected tax dues from cattle keepers. He had to know and supervise pastures reserved for Inyambo or cows for the royal court.

### The army chief (Umutware w'ingabo)

He had the role of commanding the army and participating in the fighting between Rwanda and her enemies. He was also in charge to settle disputes between other chiefs and conflicts between the pastoralists.

## 5.2.2. Military organisation



In traditional Rwanda, the military institution was very strong and powerful. The army in ancient Rwanda had the following roles:

- Expanding country;
- Participating in the different wars;
- Fighting against cattle rustlers and various raids;
- Ensuring territorial security

The army was a vehicle for strengthening certain cultural and social values. At every beginning of a new reign, the king had to start training his own army of young Rwandans. At the royal court, there was a military training camp known as "Itorero" where the young men Intore recruited from among the king's favorite chiefs learnt and practiced such values as generosity, courage, patriotism, the moral responsibility, self-discipline, the quality of being a man, "kuba umugabo".

They received also special military training consisting of physical exercises, shooting with bows and arrows, throwing javelin, composing and memorizing of heroic poems, dancing.

The royal army was organised in militias (Imitwe y' ingabo) under the command of the army chief as well as at royal court's level as at Ibikingi's level.

The Royal army lived in military camps called "Ingerero". The organisation and formation of the militias corresponded to the formation of the "Cattle army" ("Imitwe y' Inka"). This cattle army was reserved to feed the related militias.

### Examples:

| Military (Umutwe w'ingabo) | Cattle-army (Umutwe w'inka) | Reign                |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------|
| Abakaraza                  | Imirishyo                   | Ruganzu I Bwimba     |
| Abashakamba                | Umuhozi                     | Mibambwe II Gisanura |
| INyaruguru                 | Inkondera                   | Cyirima II Rujugira  |
| Imbanzamihigo              | Abazatsinda                 | Cyirima II Rujugira  |
| Abacyemba                  | Imisugi                     | Cyirima II Rujugira  |
| Imvejuru                   | Inkabuzima                  | Kigeli III Ndabarasa |
| Inzirabwoba                | Indirikirwa                 | Mutara II Rwogera    |
| Uruyange                   | Ingeyo                      | Yuhi IV Gahindiro    |
| Abashozamihigo             | A Ingaju z'i Rwamaraba      | Kigeli IV Rwabugiri  |



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 5.1

1. Imagine you are a chief in the kingdom of Rwanda under King Kigeli IV Rwabugiri. Describe how you would manage your Ibikingi to ensure the farmers, cattle keepers, and soldiers work together efficiently.
2. The Mwami had many responsibilities, including being the head of the army, lawmaker, and supreme judge. Choose one of these roles and explain how you would perform it if you were the king. Give reasons for your actions.
3. Compare the role of the Queen-Mother (Umugabekazi) in the kingdom with a today government leader or advisor. What similarities or differences can you identify in their responsibilities?
4. Create a diagram or chart showing the political and military organization of the Kingdom of Rwanda, including the king, queen-mother, chiefs, Abiru, and the army. Then, explain in a short paragraph how this system helped maintain unity and security in the kingdom.

### 5.3. Organisation of Itorero in ancient Rwanda



#### Learning activity 5.3

**Read the following story and answer the questions below:**

#### **Story: Organisation of Itorero**

In ancient Rwanda, the king set up Itorero, a training center for young men called Intore, to learn military skills, leadership, and good behaviour. Itorero was organised like a small community with the army chief at the top, senior Intore as trainers, and trainees grouped into units. They learned exercises, military drills, poetry, dance, and teamwork. This training helped them become brave, disciplined, and ready to serve the kingdom.

#### **Questions**

1. Who was at the top of the Itorero, and what were their main responsibilities?
2. Who helped train and supervise the younger Intore, and how did they support the army chief?
3. How were the Intore trainees grouped, and why was this grouping important?
4. What types of activities and routines were included in the training, and how did the structure help maintain discipline?
5. Can you think of a modern setting (school, sports club, community group) where a similar structured organisation could help people work together effectively?

#### 5.3.1. Purpose of Itorero

Itorero was a traditional Rwandan institution established by the King to train young men, called Intore, for military, leadership, and civic responsibilities. Its objectives included:

- Preparing trainees for defence of the kingdom against enemies and raids.
- Instilling discipline, courage, and patriotism.
- Teaching moral values, loyalty, and social responsibility.
- Passing on cultural knowledge, including poetry, songs, dance, and heroic narratives.

Itorero also served as a platform to strengthen unity and hierarchy within the kingdom.

#### 5.3.2. Hierarchical organisation of Itorero in ancient Rwanda

Itorero was highly structured and hierarchical, ensuring effective supervision and training:

##### **a) Army chief (Umutware w'Ingabo)**

Army chief occupied the highest position within Itorero. He has the following responsibilities:

- Supervised all training activities and ensured smooth functioning of Itorero.
- Reported directly to the King (Umwami) on the readiness and discipline of the trainees.
- Organised training schedules, military exercises, and cultural activities.
- Maintained order and enforced rules within the Itorero.

#### **b) Senior Intore (Abatoza )**

The senior Intore functioned as mentors and trainers for younger trainees. His responsibilities are:

- Assisted the army chief in organising training sessions.
- Supervised specific units or militias of trainees.
- Ensured trainees learned physical, military, and moral skills.
- Served as role models, exemplifying bravery, discipline, and loyalty.
- Reported the progress and behaviour of trainees to the army chief.

### **Intore trainees**

Intore trainees comprised the bulk of Itorero, usually young men recruited based on merit, physical strength. His responsibilities are:

- Participated in military drills, such as bow-and-arrow shooting, javelin throwing, and strategic exercises like jumping over heights (Gusimbuka urukiramende).
- Practiced physical exercises to build endurance and strength.
- Learned poetry, dance, heroic songs, and moral lessons.
- Developed discipline, teamwork, and leadership skills.

### **Grouping and unit Structure**

Trainees were organised into units or militias (imitwe y'ingabo) for easier management and supervision.

#### **Unit leaders:**

- Each unit had a leader responsible for training, discipline and reporting to senior Intore.
- Ensured smooth functioning of daily routines within the unit.

#### **Unit composition (umutwe w'intore):**

- Units often consisted of a manageable number of trainees to ensure effective training and monitoring.
- Some units were specialised (e.g., military drills, cultural activities).

Grouping promoted **teamwork, loyalty, and cohesion**.

### 5.3.3. Training routines and activities

Training in Itorero followed strict and well-organised routines, combining military, physical, and cultural components:

#### a) Military Training

- Physical exercises to improve strength, agility, and endurance.
- Weapons training: bows, arrows, javelins, spears, shields.
- Formation drills and strategic exercises for battlefield readiness.

#### Moral and leadership training

- Lessons on courage, generosity, loyalty, and patriotism.
- Emphasis on discipline and self-control.
- Senior Intore and unit leaders instilled values through mentoring and example.

#### Cultural training

- Learning poetry, songs, heroic stories, and dances to preserve cultural identity.
- Encouraged expression of bravery and patriotism through art and performance.
- Built unity and pride among trainees.

### 5.3.4. Community-like Structure

Itorero functioned like a miniature society:

- Clearly defined roles: army chief → senior Intore → unit leaders → trainees.
- Hierarchy ensured order, accountability, and smooth communication.
- Each level had responsibilities and authority, ensuring proper supervision.

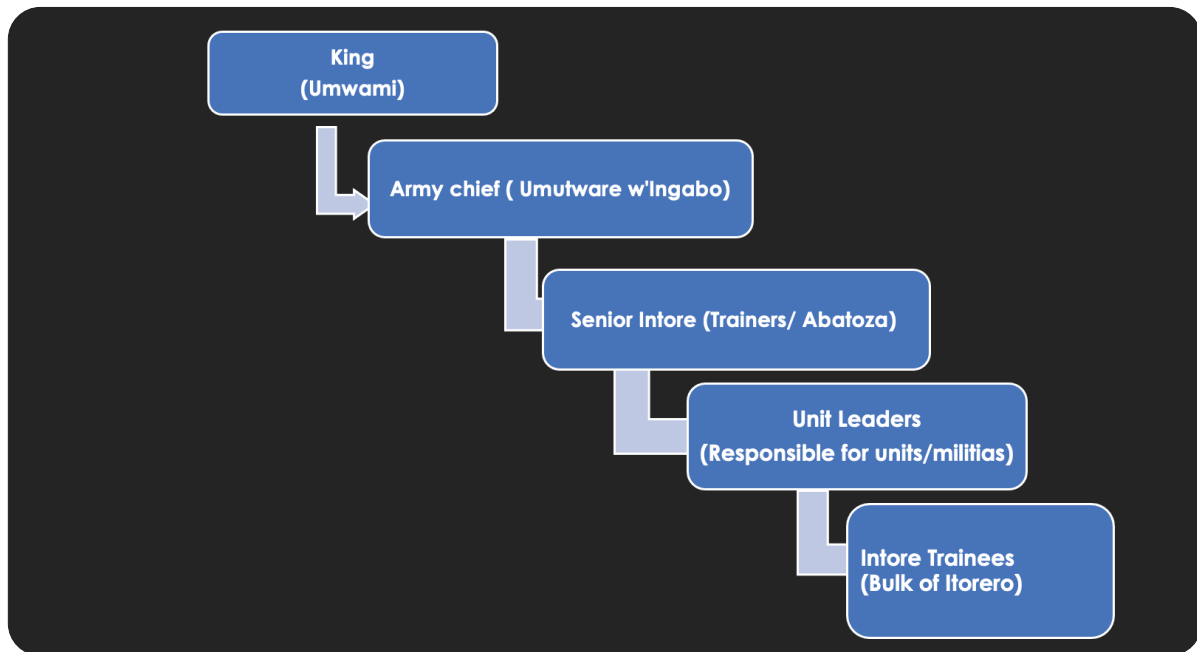
The structure created a strong sense of belonging, discipline, and identity among the trainees.

### 5.3.5. Outcomes of the organisation

The hierarchical and structured organisation of Itorero ensured that:

- Trainees became brave, disciplined, and loyal soldiers and citizens.
- Leadership skills and teamwork were instilled from an early age.
- Knowledge of military, cultural, and moral values was systematically transmitted.
- The kingdom maintained strong, well-prepared human resources for defence and administration.

### 5.3.6. Summary Diagram of Itorero Structure



#### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.2

1. Imagine your school wants to create a leadership club inspired by the ancient *Itorero* system. Based on what you learned, which three roles or structures from *Itorero* would you include in your club, and how would each role help the club function well?
2. In *Itorero*, the hierarchy from Army Chief → Senior Intore → Unit leaders → Trainees was important for order and responsibility. Explain how this hierarchical structure helped achieve the goals of *Itorero*. What might happen if this structure did not exist?
3. Design a simple diagram that represents the structure of *Itorero* (Army Chief, Senior Intore, Unit Leaders, Trainees). Your diagram should show how information flows from the top to the bottom and how trainees learn different skills (military, cultural, moral).

## 5.4. Economic organisation of ancient Rwanda



### Learning activity 5.4

**Read the following story and answer the probing questions asked on it**

In ancient Rwanda, the king owned all the land cattle and collected tribute from farmers and cattle keepers. Chiefs helped manage the land, supervise farmers and herders, and make sure resources were shared properly.

Farmers grew crops like sorghum, beans, and bananas, while cattle keepers raised cows and supplied milk, meat, and hides. This organised system helped the kingdom run smoothly and made sure everyone could work together to support the king and the people.

#### Questions

1. Who controlled the land and cattle in ancient Rwanda, and why?
2. What were the roles of chiefs in the economic system?
3. How did farmers and cattle keepers contribute to the kingdom's economy?
4. How did the organisation of the economy help maintain order and support the king?
5. How could the ancient system of organized tribute and cooperation be useful in modern communities?

Economic organisation in ancient Rwanda was based on the following economic activities: agriculture, animal rearing, handicrafts and trade.

#### Agriculture

Agriculture was the principal activity characterized by archaic production method (tools, crop rotation system, conservation methods...) which gave poor yields. Agriculture was subsistence in nature; this means individual or the family consumption. Cultivation was carried out according to the climate seasons such as Umuhindo (short rainy season), Urugaryi (short dry season), Itumba (long rainy season) and Icyi or Impeshyi (long dry season).

The main crops cultivated were beans, sorghum, peas, maize, yams, bananas, tobacco, sweet potatoes, local green leaves (Isogi), calabashes. The Rwandans used to cultivate one part of land at a time leaving the other in order not to exhaust the fertility (fallowing).

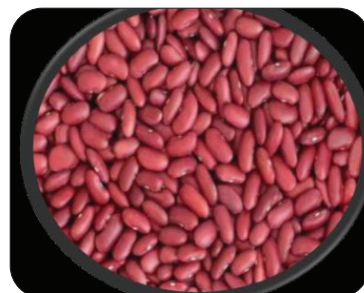
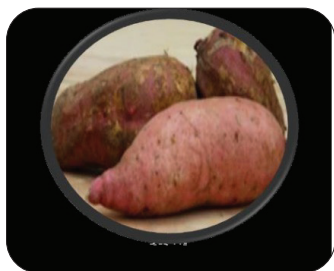


Fig.5.3: Food crops in Rwanda

## Animal rearing

The animal production in ancient Rwanda was mainly based on cattle rearing, goats, sheep and the keeping of the dogs and the bees.

Cattle rearing occupied a very important place in Rwandan life because the cows were the measure of wealth and expressed the social prestige. Products from cows were milk, meat, butter, hides and skins used for clothing.

A cow was also used to cement social relations between the different families when they exchanged it as a sign of love and friendship. Cows were also given as dowry or marriage settlement.

## Handicraft

It was a very important activity in the daily life of Rwandans. It was from handicraft that Rwandans could get most tools to satisfy their daily needs. They made clothes, metal and wooden objects destined for commercial purposes. The clothes made were the following:

- Ishabure for the girls;
- Inkanda for the women;
- Indengera for women
- Uruhu for the men;
- Impuzu made from skin of umuvumu while ishabure, inkanda and uruhu were made from the skins of animals.



*Fig.5.4. traditional clothes*

Metal tools made included spears, arrows, knives and hoes. Three regions of Rwanda had celebrity on making and production of hoes such as:

- Buberuka: Amaberuka
- Buramba: Amaramba
- Rusengesi: Amasengesi

Wooden tools included bowl (Imbehe), mortal (Isekuru), banana wine press (Umuvure), milk pot (Ibyansi)



*Fig. 5.5: Some wooden tools used in traditional Rwanda*

Ceramic products made from clay mixed with Insibo included the pots known as intango, uduherezo, inzabya, ibibindi and inkono.

Weaving was done by women and it was admired for its finesse. Material used in basket making included Urumamfu (wild millet grass), intamyi (papyrus stems), Uruhivu (raphia fibers), ibirere (dead banana leaves). The women produced bee hives, baskets, mats...These products were used in daily life for decoration, carrying things, conservation of harvested crops.

## Trade

Trade system in traditional Rwanda involved exchange of goods for other goods, - known as a barter trade system. The trade was mainly based on agricultural products, animal products and handicrafts.

Many markets or commercial centers through the country especially the northwestern regions were the following: Mushwiza, Ryabizige, Mulinzi, Mubuga, Butare, Kazirabageni, Mururu, Rwanza, Itetero, Buramba, Kaziba, Agasakuza, Miyove and Vunga.

The main imported products from the neighboring countries included the following:

- The salt from Lake Eduard today in DRC;
- The bracelet from Masisi and Buhavu today in DRC;
- The perfume from Ijwi Island today in DRC.

Although ancient Rwandans cultivated and make other economic activities, there were the time for famines.

## Famine and epizooties

The Kingdom of Rwanda suffered several famines during the pre-colonial period. People gave these famines different names depending on the harm made, villages affected and time.

- Famines were primarily caused by prolonged sunshine that resulted to drought. The drought made plants dry out in gardens before the harvest season. It was also because of constant wars of expansion that made so many people busy in fighting. They forgot to practise agriculture as people were still running up and down. They had no time to settle down and cultivate.

Poor timing of agricultural seasons culminated into famine at one time or another. Crops could either be affected by floods or meet sunshine season before reaching harvest season.

Pests and diseases also affected crops. They were eaten up by pests and attacked by various diseases leading to drying out. Common pests included locusts, grasshoppers, rodents and rats.

Different famines that affected Rwanda at different times had far reaching effects. These were:

- A big number of people and animals died due to lack of food and pasture respectively.
- Vegetation dried out leading to destruction of environment and natural beauty. This was felt especially in case where famine was caused by prolonged sunshine.
- Famine also affected the Kingdom of Rwanda negatively in terms of the economy. It led to reduction of royalties and taxes.

People also suffered from poor feeding because of inadequate food supply in various families of Rwanda. Several granaries of families remained empty.

Some of the famines that affected Rwanda in the pre-colonial period include the following:

**Macumu famine (1690):** This was the famine that occurred in Rwanda in the period between 1690 and 1708. It was during the reign of Cyilima II Rujugira. It was caused by warfare that characterised his reign as well as a large number of emigrants into the kingdom from Bunyambiriri to Bugoyi, north east of Lake Kivu.

**Rukungugu famine (1797):** This affected Rwanda during the reign of Yuhi IV Gahindiro. It was caused by drought that hit the country between 1797 and 1830. This famine led to the drying of crops due to lack of sufficient rainfall.

**Muhatigicumuro famine (1890):** This was experienced in some parts of Huye. It was caused by insufficient rains, which affected crop fields in the whole region. This famine led to crop failure, which not only affected people, but animals as well.

**Kijugunya famine (1895):** It happened during the reign of Kigeli IV Rwabugiri. There was massive crop failure caused by drought that affected the Rwanda Kingdom. Many people starved.

**Ruyaga famine (1902-1903):** This famine struck several parts of Rwanda causing widespread scarcity of food. This was because of crop failure and death of cattle. It occurred during the reign of King Yuhi V Musinga.



#### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 5.4

1. If you were a farmer in ancient Rwanda, how would you decide when to plant your crops so they grow well?
2. How could raising cows, goats, or sheep help you and your friends or family? Give an example.
3. If you made tools, baskets, or clothes, how would you organize your work to help your family and neighbours?
4. Imagine you are going to a market. What things would you take to trade, and how would you trade them? How would this help people in your community?
5. If there was no rain and food was running out, what could people do to make sure everyone has enough to eat?
6. How can you use what you learned about farming, animals, making things, and trading to help in your school, home, or community today?

### 5.5. Cultural organisation in pre-colonial Rwanda



#### Learning activity 5.5

**Read the following story and answer the following questions**

##### **A Day at grandmother Nyirakanyana's home**

Aline and her cousin Kanyarwanda visit their grandmother Nyirakanyana, who teaches them about Rwanda's traditional culture as they sit around the igicaniro (fireplace). She explains the importance of respecting ancestors, following customs, and practicing unity and mutual help. She shows them a traditional basket used for sharing food, sings an old song, and performs an traditional dance to demonstrate cultural identity. Through her stories and demonstrations, the children realise that many modern practices helping others, celebrating Umuganura, and dancing come from Rwanda's rich cultural traditions.

##### **Questions**

1. What cultural practices appeared in the story?
2. Why do you think grandmother used the fireplace to teach children?
3. What values did Aline and Kanyarwanda learn?
4. How are traditional singing and dancing important for cultural identity?

### 5.5.1. Traditional religion

#### Conception of Imana (God)

In the Pre-colonial period, Rwandans were monotheists who believed in One Supreme Being. They commonly accepted their God (Imana) as omnipotent, omnipresent and omniscient. However, there were no rites for Imana, no temple to worship Imana but Imana is present in throughout some aspects of the daily living of Rwandans. For instance, in naming their children, Rwandans referred to the idea of the role played by Imana in their day-to-day activities and life. These names are like: Ndayisaba (I implore God), Ndayisenga (I pray God), Niyibizi (It is God who knows), Habyarimana (It is God who procreates), Harerimana (It is God who nurtures), etc.

#### Omnipresence of Abazimu



“Abazimu” the spirit of the departed loved ones was understood. According to the belief of Banyarwanda, a human being is made up a visible part (body) and an invisible part (soul) one called “shadow”. Upon dying, the union of body and soul disappears and in a mysterious way the soul is transformed into a spirit called in Kinyarwanda “Umuzimu”. (From the verb “Kuzima” meaning to cease existing). Rwandans distinguish three categories of Abazimu:

*People of Ancient Rwanda performing the rite of Kuraguza*

- Abazimu b’abakurambere (Spirits of ancestors)
- Abazimu bo mu muryango (Spirits of ancestors from the large family)
- Abazimu b’ibyinjirizi (Spirits of intruders)
- Abazimu babagwagasi (spirits of ancestors died in unknown place)

#### Guterekera or cult for ancestors

This rite concerns to offer some things as food or drinks to Umuzimu. That rite took place in small huts called Indaro. The gestures are accompanied by oral requests formulation according to circumstances. The offertories are symbols because are the smallest. Often these offertories are the things which were liked by Umuzimu during his/her life.

## Kubandwa

The rite of Kubandwa is a ritual ceremony accomplished in two steps and consists of offering the offertories to Ryangombe and other Imandwa.



*Fig. 5.6: People of Ancient Rwanda performing the rite of kubandwa*

Source: [www. Africamuseum.be](http://www.Africamuseum.be)

According to the tradition, Ryangombe was a hunter whose origin area is Nkole in Uganda. But other areas are supposed to be his origin as well as Bugoyi, Ndorwa and Bwanamukari. Ryangombe is the son of Babinga and Nyiraryangombe. He had three wives Nyirakajumba, Gacubya and Karyango. He had also two boys named Binego and Ruhanga and two girls Bukiranzuzi and Nyabirungu.

The first stage of kubandwa is "Kwatura" (initiation ceremony). By accomplishment of this stage, a novice is admitted in the community of Imandwa and he gets a new name and new parents. He is called from now "Uruzingo". The second step, called "Gusubizwaho" or "Gusubira ku ntebe" (confirmation ceremony), the novice is invited to sit once again on the seat of Ryangombe. By this confirmation, he/she takes the definitive name and became Imandwa. This name of Imandwa also refers to the specialist and the medium of the cult.

As far as the 'Ukubandwa' or feast for the initiated members was concerned, this ritual was organized in terms of solemn and public ceremonies. It was accompanied by gestures, speeches and chants in honor of the "king of spirits" who was Ryangombe. Its membership was generally restricted to those who were already initiated, and those who had applied to become candidates for initiation. The non-initiated members were called 'Inzingo'. After death, the 'Inzingo' were taken to Nyiragongo, an active volcano, whereas the 'Imandwa' were compensated after

death. They joined Ryangombe in paradise in a place where a volcano had gone extinct, i.e. in Muhabura and specifically to Karisimbi.

A similar cult was practiced in the north of the country and it was rendered to Nyabingi. Legend traces Nyabingi's origin to Ndorwa or Karagwe. She was a noble woman never married and died very old. After her death, her followers (Abagirwa or Ababyukurutsa) spread her cult. Legend says that she was the daughter of Nyakajumba and Nyabunyana.

Introduction of Nyabingi's cult in Rwanda corresponded to the end of reign of Kigeli IV Rwabugiri and it was known in Umutara, Rukiga, Kibari, Murera, Buhoma, Bugamba, Bugoyi and Kanage.

The rites of uguterekera and ukubabandwa were performed so as to appease the departed spirits. As result, the spirits gave mercy and protection to the all members of the family that has performed these rites.

In most cases, the rite of Guterekera and that of Kubandwa were preceded by another rite of Kuraguza, (divination). For all intents and purposes, the ancient Rwandese always consulted diviners. The diviner knew how to interpret the signs of the visible world and God's willingness.

**Note:** The Banyarwanda did not offer sacrifices to *Imana* because they believed that *Imana* was kind and *Rugaba* (meaning self-sufficient and lacking nothing). They believed that *Imana* did not need material offerings from human beings but only required repentance and good conduct.

### 5.5.2. Rites and Taboos

The Rites (Imigenzo/Imihango) and taboos (Imiziho) can be considered to have been in the framework of religion in traditional Rwanda. They are part of beliefs which influenced behavior of ancient Rwandans.

#### Rites

Rwandan society had various rites. These were activities that were performed in a particular way or occasion during ceremonies such as the naming a child (Kwita umwana izina or Gusohora umwana), marriage, funerals...

**Child naming:** This ceremony was done on the evening of the eighth day after a new baby was born. It began with bringing the baby out to the public for the first time. This was called gusohora umwana. All village children from three to ten years would come and cultivate a piece of land using sticks that were shaped in the form of a hoe. Thereafter, a male adult would stop them, and throw water at them. The kids would then run home to be given food in front of adults. The kids would be requested to put forward names, and the father would give the name he had selected.

**Death ceremony:** Whenever a person died, family members would take part in certain rituals for sendoff. There was always a period of mourning (kwirabura) announced by head of the family. During that period, sexual relations and working in fields were forbidden. At the end of it, they performed kwera ceremony, to mark the end of mourning.

## Taboos and forbidden things

Taboos in Rwanda were commonly known as Kirazira, meaning forbidden. These were activities that were not allowed to be done because they could bring curses. The following taboos existed in Rwandan society:

- Children were forbidden to sit on their father's stool.
- Whistling at night was prohibited.
- Sitting on a mortar was forbidden.
- One could not marry from his or her own clan.
- A wife was not supposed to mention the name of her father -in-law.
- Premarital pregnancy was prohibited.
- Girls were forbidden to climb trees.
- Killing a wagtail (Kwica inyamanza).

### 5.5.3. Oral literature

Rwandans practiced oral literature. Their oral literature included folk tales (imigani), proverbs, riddles and poems. The poems were of many categories. These included pastoral poems, dynastic poems, warrior or epic poems and esoteric code. Other forms of literature were life histories, plays and historical recitations. It was passed down to future generations by word of mouth, typically through memorization and recitation. It was considered as a verbal form of art.



#### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 5.5

1. Rwandans believed in Imana, respected abazimu, and practiced rites such as guterekera and kubandwa.
  - a) Identify one belief or value from traditional religion that you think still influences Rwandan culture or families today. Explain *how* it is still visible in modern life.
  - b) Compare one traditional religious practice with a modern cultural or spiritual practice. What is similar and what is different?
2. Choose one traditional rite (naming ceremony, death ceremony, marriage customs...) and one taboo (kirazira) in Rwandan culture.
  - a) Explain why this rite or taboo was important in traditional Rwanda.
  - b) Give a real-life example today where a similar practice or value still exists (e.g., respect, discipline, family order).
3. Traditional Rwanda used stories, proverbs, poems, riddles to teach values.
  - a) Pick one proverb, tale, or poem you know (traditional or modern). Explain what value or lesson it teaches.
  - b) Create your own short proverb or 2–3-line poem inspired by traditional oral literature. It should teach a moral lesson relevant today (e.g., unity, hard work, respect, peace).
4. Traditional Rwandans wore clothes made from bark cloth, animal skins, and hides.
  - a) Compare one traditional clothing item (e.g., uruyonga, ishabure, inkanda, leopard skin) with a modern clothing item. Identify: one similarity and one difference
  - b) Explain how clothing traditional or modern can reflect identity or cultural pride.

## 5.6. Socio-political and economic dependence in pre-colonial Rwanda



### Learning activity 5.6

**Read the following story and answer the questions asked to it.**

Habimana lived in pre-colonial Rwanda. His family owned a small piece of land but no cattle. One day, he met a wealthy man, Rukangaga, who offered him a cow in exchange for loyalty and help with herding. His neighbour, Gasigwa, lived in a region where land was controlled by a lineage head. Gasigwa worked on their land so his family could stay there. In another village, Ndayisenga had to give labour to a chief who owned large estates.

Each of these people lived under different dependence systems: ubuhake, ubukonde, and uburetwa.

#### Questions

1. After reading the story, what differences do you notice between Habimana, Gasigwa, and Mukandayisenga's situations?
2. What hints in the story show the type of dependence each lived under?
3. Why do you think ubuhake (cattle clientship) was important for families with little wealth?
4. Which groups gained more advantages in ubuhake?
5. Who had more control in ubukonde relationships the lineage head or the tenant? Why?
6. How might uburetwa have affected the daily life of ordinary people?
7. What values do you think Rwanda can learn from the positive sides of these systems (e.g., loyalty, cooperation)?

### 5.6.1. Pastoral clientelism (Ubuahake)

It was a social, political and economic dependence of Pre-colonial Rwanda that was mainly based on the cow. It was a customary contract which was not obligatory between the owner of cattle, a rich man known as Shebuja (Patron) and a person who wished to acquire cow called Umugaragu (Client or Servant). The latter who was often poor, socially weak and isolated asked the wealthier for social protection. Once the demand was accepted, the seeker accepted to perform duties for patron.

The following were the duties of the client:

- Cultivating the fields of the patron
- Looking after the cattle and ensuring that the milk was of good quality
- Repairing homesteads
- Guarding homes at night
- Providing water
- Providing liquor
- Building fences
- Escorting the patron to war
- Acting as a messenger
- Giving cows in the event of epizootics, in the event of bereavement (Inshumbushanyo)
- Taking a part in patron's happy or sad events, etc.

### Patron's duties included:

- Protecting the client against those who were socially stronger than him and others likely to be enemies
- Assisting the client in court (kurengera)
- Redeeming the client (kugura)
- Giving bull- calves and milk
- Contributing to formation of a new her
- Revenging the client (Guhorera),
- Giving a hoe when the client is a cultivator who cannot get one easily. Taking part in client's happy or sad events while it was possible, etc.

A client who refused to fulfill his duties was deprived of all the cows he would have been given by the patron (Kunyagwa).

It should be noted that a patron could have several clients who all depended on his wealth and the need for protection. In such case, the patron distributed different specific duties to different clients according to their capacity and competence.

Ubuhake was officially abolished on April 1st, 1954 by King Mutara III Rudahigwa. This abolition had the following objectives: to establish cattle as personal property, to ensure individual freedom, to establish trade freedom and to allow the emerging of individual initiatives.

### 5.6.2. Dependence based on land (Ubukonde)

It was a right which gave authority to the clan and lineage heads on their respective zones as collective land (Isambu or Ubutaka). This collective land was managed by the clan head that was responsible for allocating land inside his zone of influence to his subjects (Abagererwa). Before one starting to work on the land, he had first to seek the blessing and investiture of the clan chief.

The ceremony of investiture consists of giving a small traditional hoe called Inkonzo to Umugererwa which symbolised suzerainty of the clan and the right to clear the forest and cultivate the land at the same time. The investiture also conferred to the receiver (Umugererwa) and his descendants an inalienable right of ownership on the fields to be cultivated.

Unlike Ubuhake, Abagererwa did not pay homage to the clan heads (Abakonde). They only paid homage to the head of the family after harvest by offering some of the harvest to him including some sorghum, millet, beans and peas.

Ubukonde existed especially in Murera, Rwankeri, Buhoma, Bushiru, Bugoyi and Kanage. It was also known in former prefectures of Kibuye, Cyangugu and Byumba.

### 5.6.3. Uburetwa

Uburetwa consisted of the duty for each man to work two days per week (the traditional week had only five days) for a politico-administrative leader without any compensation. The uburetwa was directly related to land and to land services. Before 1900, it was based on lineages (Umuryango or inzu) and family representatives could carry out the required duties in the name of the whole group.

In 1927, the Belgian administration reduced uburetwa for each male adult to one day

per week (this time a week of 7 days). The chief had the right to benefit from 52 days unpaid working days per year. For the Belgians, that represented a progress, because before the uburetwa was to be performed during 2 days of traditional week.

However, due to the "rationalisation" of uburetwa introduced by the Belgian colonial administration, uburetwa became a burden to be assumed by every adult male and any individual deemed fit for service. Meanwhile, uburetwa started to involve more people than before.

In 1933, another royal declaration reduced the number of days of uburetwa that is to say 13 days per annum for the chief and 10 days per annum for the deputy chief. Even the bagaragu, within the framework of ubuhake, were constrained to provide annual services.

### Remember!



During the Belgian administration in Rwanda, uburetwa was expanded. Each male adult was to work one day per week. This contributed throughout the colonial era because of the following needs:

- Developing infrastructure
- Introducing industrial crops
- Fighting famine through compulsory agriculture



## END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and understanding

1. Describe how families, clans, and lineages formed the social organisation of pre-colonial Rwanda.
2. Explain the main elements of cultural organisation, such as Itorero, rituals, and traditional arts, and how they helped preserve identity.
3. Identify and briefly explain any three economic activities (e.g., agriculture, pastoralism, craftsmanship) that sustained pre-colonial Rwanda.

### Skills

4. Compare the roles of the king (Umwami) and army chiefs in the political and military organisation of ancient Rwanda. How did each contribute to stability?
5. Using the systems of ubuhake, uburetwa, and ubukonde, analyse how socio-political and economic dependence shaped relationships between people in pre-colonial Rwanda.
6. Create a simple diagram or chart showing the structure of ancient Rwanda, including the King, chiefs (abahake, abashingantahe), and local administrators. Show how authority flowed from top to bottom.

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### Attitudes and values

7. From the pre-colonial social organisation, what positive values such as cooperation, unity, or respect can learners apply in their communities today?
8. Cultural traditions like Itorero encouraged discipline, patriotism, and teamwork. Why are these values still important in modern Rwanda?
9. Systems like ubuhake or uburetwa created both support and inequality. What lesson about fairness and responsibility can we learn from these systems when building today's society?

# UNIT 6:

## TRANS SAHARAN TRADE



### Key Unit Competence:

*Evaluate* the development, impact and decline of the Trans-Saharan Trade and its significance in African History.

### Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

### Knowledge and understanding

Describe the origin, and development and the decline of the Trans-Saharan Trade.

Explain the organisation of the Saharan Trade.

Explain the effects of Trans-Saharan Trade on West African empires.

### Skills

Analyse maps to trace trade routes across the Sahara Desert.

Evaluate the reasons for the decline of the Trans-Saharan Trade.

Examine the social, economic, and political effects of the Trans-Saharan Trade.

### Attitudes and Values:

Appreciate the role of trade in shaping African civilisations.

Recognise the importance of cooperation and exchange in societal development.

Appreciate the contributions of African societies to global history.

## Introduction

The Trans-Saharan Trade was a long-distance trade network that connected West Africa and North Africa across the Sahara Desert. In this unit, learners will discover how people, goods, and ideas were transported through the desert using camel caravans and how this trade helped different African societies grow and develop.

Students will study where the trade began, the main routes used, the important goods exchanged and the major cities and empires involved, including Ghana, Mali, and Songhai. They will also learn about the effects of this trade on African communities and the reasons why it eventually declined. Key Words: Trans-Saharan Trade, caravan, trade routes, oasis, gold and salt trade, Ghana, Mali, Songhai, cultural exchange, camel transport.

Trans-Saharan Trade linked North Africa and West Africa across the Sahara Desert long before Europeans arrived in Africa. Traders crossed the hot and dangerous desert using camels, which could travel long distances without much water. For safety and support, traders moved together in groups called caravans. West Africa supplied goods such as gold, salt, ivory, and slaves, while North Africa provided cloth, beads, horses, and other manufactured items. Salt was very valuable and was sometimes exchanged for gold.

Trade centers like Timbuktu, Gao, and Djenne became rich and famous because of this trade. The trade helped the rise of powerful kingdoms such as Ghana, Mali, and Songhai, whose kings controlled and protected the trade routes. Trans-Saharan Trade also spread Islam into West Africa, leading to the building of mosques and Islamic schools. Through trade contacts, Arabic language and writing spread in the region. Overall, Trans-Saharan Trade encouraged economic growth, cultural exchange, and played an important role in shaping African history.



### Introductory activity 6

**Observe the two pictures: Sahara caravan and market and ancient oasis market scene and answer the questions asked on them.**



### Questions

1. Describe what do you see in the pictures?
2. Why do you think people used camels to travel across the desert?
3. What kind of items do you think people were buying or selling in the busy market?
4. How do you think these traders survived in the hot desert?
5. Do people in your community trade or travel today? Explain how is it similar or different from what you see in the pictures?

## 6.1. Factors for the rise and development of Trans Saharan Trade

Trans-Saharan Trade was the trade or commercial activity carried out between the north African Berbers and west African negroes across the Sahara desert. Some historians suggested that the trade might have begun in the 2<sup>nd</sup> Century.

The volume of trade remained low until camels were introduced from Asia. After that the volume of trade increased.

Furthermore, the trade gained momentum in the 7th Century when the Arabs conquered North Africa. The conquest forced the Berbers to migrate southwards. Consequently, it gave them a greater advantage to participate in the trade. By the 11th Century, a profitable trade had been developed. During this trade, the Berbers from North Africa acted as middle men.

The following factors show the reasons behind the growth and expansion of Trans-Saharan Trade.

### i) Introduction of Camels

The introduction of camels greatly helped in its improvement, especially in the means of transport. In addition to the above, the camels could also carry large amounts of goods. They could also take long without drinking water.

### ii) Emergence of West African empires

Some of such important empires included Mali, Ghana and Songhai. The leaders of those empires ensured security for the traders which encouraged more people to join the trade.

### iii) The conquest of North Africa by the Arabs

This forced the Berbers to migrate southwards. They finally reached West Africa. That marked the beginning of the trade. Furthermore, they introduced a common language (Arabic). This encouraged the coming of more Arabs who participated in the trade thereby developing it.

### iv) The spread of Islamic religion in West Africa

With the spread of Islam in West Africa, Muslim traders felt secure to carry out trade. Islam acted as a uniting factor. Islam also increased trust among the traders through brotherhood and unity.

### v) Re-production of different commodities by West and North Africa

This led to the need of exchanging goods produced in the two regions. It eventually led to the development of the trade for example gold, slaves and kola nuts from west Africa, camels, clothes and weapons from north Africa. It eventually led to the development of the trade.

### vi) The presence of the Tuaregs and Berbers

The Tuaregs of the desert maintained wells and guided traders and the Berbers initiated and provided capital in the trade.

### vii) High profits

The trade grew because of the high profits that were involved. This attracted many more people to join.

### viii) Absence of natural barriers

There were no natural barriers such as lakes and mountains between North Africa and West Africa. This made movement of goods and people easy.

### Remember!

Trans-Saharan Trade was done the same way trade is done today. The only difference is that there was no standard medium of exchange in form of money.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 6.1

1. Imagine your community wants to start trading with a far village. Based on what you learned, choose one factor (e.g., strong leadership, safe routes, different goods, helpful transport animals) and explain how it would help your community's trade grow, just as it helped the Trans-Saharan Trade.
2. Suppose camels had never been introduced in West Africa. Explain how the development of the Trans-Saharan Trade would have changed, using examples from the factors you studied (e.g., movement, speed, carrying goods, safety).
3. You are a leader of an ancient West African kingdom. Traders fear crossing the desert. Using what you learned about the rise of the Trans-Saharan Trade, design two ways you would encourage more traders to pass through your kingdom, such as providing security, building resting points, or using guides.

## 6.2. Effects of the Trans Saharan Trade



### Learning activity 6.2

**Read the following scenario and answer the questions below:**

#### Scenario

Imagine you are a young trader living in ancient West Africa. You prepare your camel caravan to travel across the Sahara desert to trade salt and gold. Along the way, you meet traders from different kingdoms and people speaking languages you've never heard. You reach bustling cities like Timbuktu and Gao, full of merchants, scholars, and artisans. You see new ideas, goods, and even religions spreading through these cities. You also notice that some traders are very wealthy, while others struggle to survive the long journey.

#### Questions

1. Identify and justify the goods you would carry for trade
2. Describe the challenges you might face on the journey?
3. Explain how your trade could make your city or kingdom richer?

4. Analyse how meeting other traders and people from different regions affect your life?
5. Do you think trade could change the way communities interact? How?
6. Explain the new ideas, beliefs, or technologies you might learn during your travels?
7. Discuss how trade could influence the languages, art, or religion in your city?

**The effects Trans-Saharan Trade were:**

- i) The trade led to the exploitation of African resources such as minerals, ivory and agricultural products. That led to their exhaustion.
- ii) It led to the introduction of new commodities in West Africa such as beads, clothes and guns.
- iii) It led to the development of many trading centres/towns that grew into big cities. Such centres were Tripoli, Fez, and Timbuktu.
- iv) It led to the development of trade routes that have become permanent roads till today.
- v) The trade also provided employment opportunities to many people such as guides, guards and porters. It improved their standards of living.
- vi) Many people who participated in the trade became rich. For instance, kings of West Africa and the Arabs.
- vii) The trade also created a lot of suffering to the Africans. Most of them were taken into slavery.
- viii) It also led to depopulation of many areas due to slavery.
- ix) It led to the introduction of Islam into West Africa. This was due to the participation of many Arabs in the trade.
- x) It led to intermarriages between the Arabs and the Africans. This gave rise to a new race of coloured Africans.
- xi) It led to the spread of Islamic education. For example, Islamic universities were established in Mali and Songhai.
- xii) The trade also brought many Arabs into West Africa. These Arabs settled there permanently.
- xiii) The trade also created a lot of insecurity as guns were brought in big numbers.
- xiv) It also brought Islamic architecture into West Africa. Most of the buildings resembled those of the Islamic world.



## APPLICATION ACTIVITY 6.2

1. What new goods were introduced into West Africa through the Trans-Saharan trade?
2. What was one negative effect of the trade on the African population?
3. Look at a map of the Trans-Saharan trade routes. Can you trace the path from North Africa to West Africa and name at least three trading cities along the way?
4. Using the information about goods traded (gold, salt, beads, clothes, guns), create a simple chart showing which goods came from West Africa and which came from North Africa.
5. The Trans-Saharan trade spread knowledge and education, like Islamic schools. Why is valuing education important in our lives today?

## 6.3. Decline of Trans Saharan Trade



### Learning activity 1.4

#### Read the following story and answer questions below

Long ago, the Sahara was full of life with traders traveling from West Africa to North Africa. Caravans carried gold, salt, and other goods. Cities like Timbuktu and Gao were rich and busy, full of merchants and scholars. But over time, things began to change. Some trade routes became dangerous because of attacks by raiders. Some traders stopped coming because new sea routes were discovered along the coast. Also, the kings of some cities increased taxes on traders, making trade more expensive. Slowly, the once-busy trade caravans became fewer, and some cities that were once thriving started to lose their importance. People who depended on trade for jobs and wealth faced hardships.

#### Questions

1. Identify the goods were traded along the Trans-Saharan Trade routes in the story?
2. According to the story, what are some reasons trade started to decline?
3. What lessons can we learn from the decline of the Trans-Saharan trade about planning for the future?

#### Trans-Saharan Trade declined due to the following factors:

- i) Slave trade was abolished and thus Trans-Saharan Trade could not continue. Slaves were an important item of the trade.
- ii) The introduction of cheap European goods made the African goods to lose market. This led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade.
- iii) Increasing insecurity along the trade routes also discouraged the traders leading to its decline.

- iv) The trade declined because of the discovery of gold in other parts of the world. For example, the discovery of gold in America.
- v) It also declined due to the constant shortage of water. Most oases dried up.
- vi) The death of important kings led to the decline of the trade. Such kings included Mansa Musa of Mali Empire and Askia Mohammed of Songhai Empire.
- vii) The trade declined because of the downfall of some West African empires. Such empires included Mali, Songhai, and Ghana.
- viii) The rise and development of Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade. Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade was more profitable than Trans-Saharan Trade.
- ix) The trade also declined because of high taxation imposed on the traders in West Africa. High taxation reduced their profits.
- x) The discovery of the sea route through the Mediterranean Sea to West Africa also led to its decline. This provided an alternative means of transport for the traders that was cheap, safe and quick.
- xi) There was a shortage of raw materials such as gold and ivory. This led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade.
- xii) The colonisation of Africa by the European powers made these Europeans to become controllers of Africa. This led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade.

### Remember!

Trade is conducted for purposes of profits. When profit is well managed through savings and investments, it creates positive socio-economic changes on society. It changes people's standards of living, increasing savings and reducing dependency ratios.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 6.3

1. Discuss two important items or goods whose loss contributed to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade.
2. Identify and explain two challenges traders faced that led to the decline of trade?
3. Create a simple table showing three factors that caused the decline and their effects on the traders and towns.
4. What lessons can we learn today about planning and adapting when important economic activities face challenges?



## END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and understanding

1. Explain the Trans-Saharan Trade and who were the main participants?
2. List three goods that were traded from West Africa to North Africa.
3. Identify two reasons why the Trans-Saharan Trade declined.

### Skills

4. Imagine you are a trader during the decline of the Trans-Saharan Trade. Suggest two ways you could adapt to continue trading safely and profitably.
5. Using the story "The Decline of a Busy Trade Route," explain how factors like insecurity and high taxes affected the traders and the towns.

### Attitude and Values

6. Explain why it is important for leaders to protect trade routes and provide security for traders?
7. The Trans-Saharan Trade helped spread education, religion, and culture. Why is respecting and learning from other cultures important in our lives today?

# UNIT 7:

## TRANS-ATLANTIC SLAVE TRADE (TRIANGULAR TRADE)

### Key Unit Competence:

**Evaluate** the causes, development, and consequences of the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade to determine its impact on Africa, Europe, and the America.

### Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

### Knowledge and understanding

Explain the factors that led to the rise and growth of the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade,

Describe the roles played by Africa, Europe, and the Americas in the triangular trade system,

Analyse major consequences on all the involved continents.

### Skills

Interpret historical maps, charts, and sources related to the triangular trade;

Compare the social, economic, and political effects of the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade across different regions.

### Attitudes and Values:

Develop empathy for the victims of the slave trade

Appreciate the importance of human dignity, and condemn slavery and all forms of human exploitation while promoting respect for human rights.

## Introduction

The Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade was a major trade system that involved the forced movement of Africans to the Americas. It began in the 15th century and lasted for over 300 years. European traders played a leading role in organizing this trade. Millions of Africans were captured from their homes in West, Central, and East Africa. They were sold to European traders by force or through local conflicts. The Africans were then transported across the Atlantic Ocean in ships.

The journey across the ocean was called the Middle Passage and was very harsh and inhumane. Many enslaved Africans died due to sickness, hunger, and cruel treatment. Those who survived were sold as slaves in the Americas. They were forced to work on plantations, mines, and farms. The main products produced by slave labor included sugar, cotton, tobacco, and coffee. These products made European countries very rich. However, Africa lost many of its young and strong people. The slave trade caused suffering, fear, and destruction in African societies. Overall, the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade had long-lasting negative effects on Africa and the world.

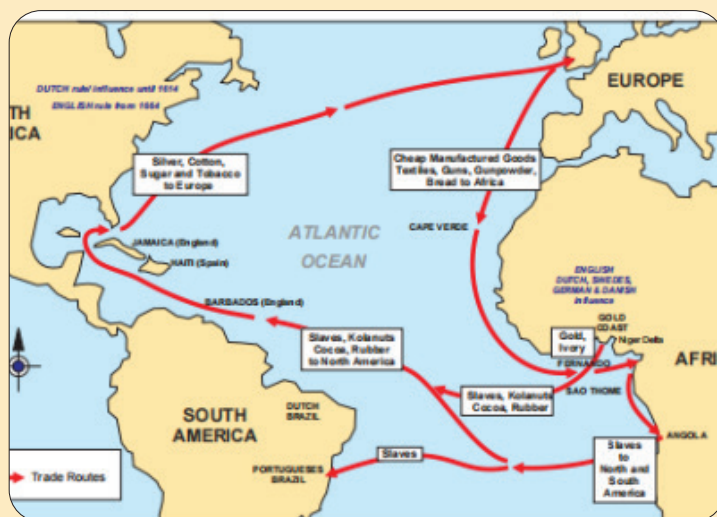
This unit helps learners understand the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade, a trade system that linked Africa, Europe, and the Americas from the 15th to the 19th century. Learners will explore how the triangular trade started, what each region contributed, and how the movement of goods and enslaved people shaped the world.

The unit also examines the effects of this trade on different continents and teaches learners about human dignity and human rights. Students will learn why slavery was wrong, and why all forms of exploitation must be rejected.



### Introductory activity 7

Observe the below map and say what you see on it. Identify the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade that was carried out between three continents and explain all the process.



Map showing Trans-Atlantic slave trade route

## 7.1. Factors for the rise, growth and development of Trans-Atlantic Slave trade.



### Learning activity 6.2

#### Read the following scenario and answer the following questions

In the 1600s, a European ship arrives on the West African coast loaded with guns, cloth, beads, and alcohol. Local African traders bring captured people from inland to the coast. The Europeans exchange their goods for these captives.

After loading the enslaved Africans, the ship sails across the Atlantic Ocean to the Americas, where plantation owners urgently need workers to produce sugar, cotton, and tobacco for European markets.

The ship then returns to Europe carrying these valuable products, making the traders very rich.

#### Questions

1. Identify goods did Europeans bring to Africa in exchange for enslaved people?
2. Explain why plantation owners in the America need many workers?
3. Identify the products that were shipped from the Americas to Europe?
4. From the scenario, analyse and identify three factors that led to the rise and development of the triangular trade.
5. Evaluate the practice of exchanged human being for goods like beads or guns and justify your opinion?

The Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade was the trade which involved Europe, West Africa and the West Indies (America) across the Atlantic Ocean. It was also called the Triangular Trade. This was because the ships used to make three stages during their journey. That is, from Europe to West Africa, America and back to Europe. This made the shape of a triangle.

Let us now look at the factors that led to the rise and growth of Triangular Trade.

#### i) The Industrial Revolution in Europe

Industrialists needed raw materials and market for their manufactured goods. The Europeans resorted to Africans for market. In return, they obtained slaves who were sold to European plantation owners in exchange for raw materials.

#### ii) The discovery of America and West Indies by Spain in 1492

The discovery of America and West Indies in 1492 led to the establishment of cotton, tobacco and sugarcane plantation which all required the labour; therefore, it was suggested that West Africa would supply the required labour. It was labour from Africa to the American plantations that led to the development of the trade.

### iii) The decline of Trans-Saharan Trade

This led to the rise of Trans- Atlantic Slave Trade. There was a constant demand for slaves and commodities thereafter.

### iv) The introduction of armed conflicts in African politics

High demand for firearms by African rulers to defend and expand their states made them to exchange the slaves for firearms leading to the rise and growth of the Trans-Atlantic slave trade.

#### Other factors were:

- i) The trade was profitable to the Europeans and Africans who were involved in it. African chiefs and other participants got European goods which were of high value.
- ii) There was a desire by African chiefs to get wealth and political power. This could be obtained through the acquisition of arms and maintaining friendship with Europeans.
- iii) There was the growth of new merchants in Europe as feudalism was declining. The new merchants of Europe wanted to accumulate a lot of wealth. This became a justification to participate in the Triangular Trade.
- iv) There was development of consumer culture among the African chiefs. There was also the need for the European goods. These two needs encouraged the Africans to sell their fellow Africans into slavery.
- v) There was increased demand for certain luxurious goods such as sugar, alcohol, clothes and mirrors. This demand led to rise and growth of Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade.
- vi) The winds and ocean currents helped to steer the European ships to America and Africa. These were the north-east trade winds and the north equatorial currents.
- vii) Africans were considerably physically fit. They could withstand harsh climatic conditions in America compared to Europeans or Asians.
- viii) The supply of firearms became a factor for the development of Triangular Trade. Africans wanted to acquire firearms to defend themselves against enemies and calm down internal wars.



#### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 7.1

1. Identify and explain the factors for the rise and development of Trans-Atlantic Slave trade.
2. Imagine you are a European merchant during the Industrial Revolution. Which goods would you take to West Africa, and how would these goods help you obtain what you needed for your factories? Explain how this shows a factor that contributed to the rise of the Triangular Trade.
3. A plantation owner in the West Indies has many sugarcane fields but very few workers. Using the factors you learned, explain why this situation increased the demand for enslaved Africans and how it helped the Triangular Trade to grow.

## 7.2. Effects of Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade



### Learning activity 6.2

#### Read the following scenario and answer the following questions

In 1700, a ship returns to Europe after months of travelling between Africa and the America. It carries large amounts of sugar, cotton, and tobacco grown by enslaved Africans on plantations.

Back in West Africa, many communities have lost young men and women who were captured and sold into slavery. Families are separated, farmlands are abandoned, and frequent wars break out as leaders fight to gain firearms from Europeans.

Meanwhile, in Europe, factory owners grow richer, new industries expand, and cities become busy trading centres.

#### Questions

1. Explain what happened to African communities when many people were taken away?
2. From the scenario, identify two effects of the Triangular Trade on Africa and one effect on Europe or the America.
3. How would you feel if your family or community was affected the way African communities were? What important value do you think people should learn from this history?

The effects of the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade have been discussed below.

#### Social effects

- i) It led to depopulation of many areas through constant wars and raids. Approximately 15.4 million people were exported.
- ii) It led to dehumanisation of human beings. That is, human beings lost value and were reduced to minor items.
- iii) Raids and wars displaced many people from their homes while others ran away into hiding.
- iv) There was general moral decay in Africa. The punishments which used to be given to the offenders in the society were ignored. Instead, they were sold into slavery.
- v) Africans were disposed to different parts of the world to form new races. Some were sent to America, Portugal, France and Spain.
- vi) It greatly accelerated the spread of Christianity in predominantly Islamic states of West Africa.

#### Political effects

- i) It led to the growth of trading states such as Calabar and Bonny along the coast.
- ii) It led to the growth and expansion of some empires in West Africa. Most of those empires such as Dahomey, Oyo and Asante participated in the trade.
- iii) It led to the destruction of strong states and empires due to frequent wars and raids.
- iv) It delayed the European penetration in the interior of West Africa. This was because

the middlemen wanted to maintain their positions. This hindered the development in the interior compared to the coastal towns.

### Economic effects

- i) It led to the decline of Trans-Saharan Trade.
- ii) It reversed Africa trade from North Africa towards the coast of West Africa.
- iii) Centres of wealth and power moved. They moved from the Sudanese states to forest states and to the coastal trading communities.
- iv) It hindered economic development of West Africa because people paid attention on slave trade. People neglected agriculture, industry and legitimate trade.
- v) African local industry art and craft such as pottery and weaving declined. This was because the products made were replaced with European finished goods.
- vi) Insecurity that prevailed stopped people from carrying out agriculture. Crops and livestock were destroyed leading to famine.
- vii) Europeans made a lot of profits from slave trade; these profits from slave trade contributed to the Industrial Revolution and urbanization in Europe
- viii) It encouraged the development of coastal towns and ports such as Accra and Lagos.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 7.2

1. Analyse the economic impact of Trans - Atlantic slave trade.
2. Imagine you live in a village where many young people have been taken away because of wars and raids. How would this affect the work done in the village, like farming or caring for animals? Explain why.
3. Suppose your community begins receiving many foreign goods like clothes, mirrors, and sugar from traders. How might this change the way people use local products such as pottery or weaving? Give an example.



### END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

#### Knowledge and understanding

1. Explain the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade, and why was it called the Triangular Trade?
2. Analyse the effects of Triangular Trade on West Africa, Europe and America.

#### Skills

3. Using the content above, identify three factors that made the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade grow quickly.

#### Attitudes and Values

4. Many African chiefs joined the trade to gain wealth and power. What lesson can we learn about making choices that harm others in the pursuit of money or power?

# UNIT 8:

## FORMS AND PRINCIPLES OF DEMOCRACY

### Key unit competence

Analyse the forms and principles of democracy to appreciate its importance in promoting participation, equality, and good governance.

### Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

#### Knowledge and understanding

Describe the main features and key principles of democracy and explain how they guide democratic governance.

Compare different forms of democracy and explain how each one works in real-life situations.

#### Skills

Describe the main features of democracy and compare different forms of democracy to show how each one functions.

Use real-life or historical case studies to explain how effectively democratic principles are applied in different contexts.

#### Attitudes and Values:

Appreciate the key features, principles, and forms of democracy and recognise their importance in promoting good governance.

## Introduction

This unit introduces learners to the main ideas that guide democratic societies. It helps learners understand how democracy works, the different ways it can be practiced, and the principles that make a government fair. Learners will explore how citizens take part in decision-making and why respecting rights, freedoms, and responsibilities is important for good governance.

The unit also covers the meaning and features of democracy, including forms like direct and representative democracy. It explains core principles such as rule of law, equality, justice, and accountability. By studying these, learners will understand how democracy shapes communities, encourages participation, and promotes peace.

Democracy is a system of government in which power belongs to the people. It allows citizens to take part in making decisions that affect their lives, either directly or through elected representatives. The idea of democracy is based on the belief that all people are equal and should have a voice in how they are governed.

The principles of democracy include respect for human rights, rule of law, equality before the law, freedom of expression, and regular free and fair elections. These principles guide leaders in governing responsibly and ensure that citizens are protected from abuse of power. Democracy also encourages accountability, transparency, and participation in public affairs.

There are different forms of democracy, such as direct democracy, representative democracy, and constitutional democracy. Each form shows how democratic principles are put into practice in different societies. Understanding the forms and principles of democracy helps learners appreciate good governance, civic responsibility, and the importance of active citizenship in building peaceful and just societies.



### Introductory activity 8

Observe the cartoon concept of the following two panels and answer the questions asked on them

Panel one should have the following



### Questions

1. Explain what is happening in each panel?
2. Which form of democracy do the students use in the cartoon?
3. Identify the principles of democracy are shown (e.g., fairness, equality, citizen participation)?
4. Can you give an example from your school or community where everyone had a say in making a decision?

Panel 2



## 8.1. Meaning and features of democracy



### Learning activity 8.1

**Match each term with its correct definition or example and connect the activity to real-life examples.**

**Activity Title:** "Democracy Feature Match Game"

**Term Cards:**

1. Democracy
2. Citizen Participation
3. Equality

4. Rule of Law
5. Rights
6. Responsibilities
7. Accountability
8. Fairness

**Definition/Example Cards:**

1. A system of government where people have the power to make decisions or choose their leaders.
2. Everyone can share opinions, vote, and take part in decision-making.
3. All people are treated equally and have the same opportunities, regardless of differences.
4. Laws apply to everyone, including leaders, and no one is above the law.

5. Freedoms that every person is entitled to, like freedom of speech and right to vote.
6. Duties that each citizen must perform, such as obeying laws and respecting others' rights.
7. Leaders and citizens are responsible for their actions and decisions and must answer to others.
8. Decisions and actions are made in a just and impartial way, without favouritism

### 8.1.1. Meaning of democracy

It is a form of government where power is in the hands of the people to exercise it directly or indirectly through freely elected representatives. Democracy as "A government of the people, for the people and by the people"

### 8.1.2. Features of democracy

#### 1. Popular Participation

In a democracy, the people are the ultimate source of political power. Citizens have the right to participate in decision-making by voting, running for office, joining political parties, or engaging in public debates. This ensures that the government reflects the will of the people.

#### 2. Free and Fair Elections

Democracies hold regular elections where every eligible citizen can vote freely without coercion or discrimination. Elections are transparent, competitive, and inclusive, allowing the people to choose their leaders and hold them accountable.

#### 3. Rule of Law

Everyone in a democracy, including leaders, is subject to the law. Laws are applied equally to protect citizens' rights and prevent abuse of power, ensuring fairness and justice in society.

#### 4. Separation of Powers

The functions of government are divided into branches legislative, executive, and judiciary. Each branch has specific roles and can check the power of the others, prevent misuse of authority and maintain balance.

#### 5. Fundamental Rights and Freedoms

Democracies guarantee citizens basic rights such as freedom of speech, religion, assembly, and the press. These rights allow people to express opinions, criticize government policies, and participate fully in public life.

## 6. Accountability and Transparency

Leaders and government institutions must explain their actions and decisions to the public. Citizens can hold officials accountable, for example through audits, inquiries, or removal from office if they fail to serve responsibly.

## 7. Political Pluralism and Multi-party System

Democracies allow multiple political parties to exist, giving people choices in governance. This encourages healthy competition, ensures diverse views are represented, and prevents monopoly of power by a single group.

## 8. Majority Rule with Minority Rights

Decisions in a democracy are usually made by majority vote, but the rights of minority groups are protected. This balance prevents oppression while allowing the majority to guide collective decisions.

## 9. Regular Review and Adaptability

Democratic systems allow laws, policies, and leaders to change through legal and constitutional processes. This adaptability ensures the government can respond to social, economic, and political changes over time.

## 10. Citizen Responsibility and Civic Awareness

Citizens in a democracy are expected to stay informed, obey laws, vote, and participate in community life. Responsible civic behaviour strengthens democracy and ensures it works effectively for everyone.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 8.1

1. Define What is democracy, and how do citizens exercise power in a democratic system?
2. Identify any two features of democracy and briefly state what they mean.
3. Examine a given situation and determine which feature of democracy is being demonstrated (e.g., free and fair elections, rule of law, popular participation).
4. Using the features of democracy, explain how leaders can be held accountable in a democratic system.
5. Why is it important to respect the rights and freedoms of others, including minority groups, in a democracy?
6. How can you show responsible citizenship in your school or community to support democratic values?

## 8.2. Principles of democracy



### Learning activity 8.2

**Read the following story, “The Village of Umurava” and answer the questions below:**

In the village of **Umurava**, people made important decisions together, and everyone had the right to express their views during community meetings. When it was time to choose a new leader, all villagers voted freely without pressure, and the elected leader, Keza, ensured that rules applied equally to everyone. She encouraged different groups youth, women, and farmers to share ideas and take part in village affairs.

The village also had an independent council that solved disputes fairly. Keza regularly explained how village resources were used, showing honesty and accountability. Because the villagers participated actively, respected laws, protected rights, and held their leaders accountable, Umurava became a strong and fair community built on democratic principles.

#### Questions

1. Explain the importance of people’s participation in community or national decision making as responsible global citizens?
2. What does it mean for an election to be free and fair?
3. Justify why laws should apply to everyone equally, including leaders?
4. Analyse how allowing people to freely express their opinions helps to strengthen democracy.
5. Criticise why leaders should explain their actions and be accountable to the people they serve.
6. Discuss how involvement of different groups or voices (youth, women, people with disability) contributes to more balanced and fair decision-making.
7. evaluate how the story of Umurava village demonstrates the role of active, informed, and responsible citizens in promoting democratic values, Human Rights, and sustainable development at both local and global levels?

### Principles of democracy

There are basic guidelines that are considered during election of prefects in schools. If these guidelines do not exist, the environment for elections may not be conducive. These are what we call principles.

The following principles should guide any democratic process:

- i) **Citizen participation:** All citizens must participate in the leadership of their government. This can be done through elections of leaders and in meetings.
- ii) **Equality:** In a democratic government, everyone is equal before the law. This implies that no one is above the law in a democratic government.

- iii) **Political tolerance:** Democracy allows existence and operations of many political parties (multiparty system).
- iv) **Accountability:** Government resources must be properly allocated and managed in accordance with the law.
- v) **Transparency:** There should be openness in both public and private enterprises so as to avoid mismanagement of resources.
- vi) **Regular free and fair elections:** Elections are supposed to be fair without irregularities. Such irregularities include bribing voters, forcing people to vote and general election malpractices.
- vii) **Economic freedom:** Economic liberalisation is a situation where there are free market system and free investment. This allows whoever with capital to engage him/herself in investment regardless of who he/she is.
- viii) **Control of the abuse of power:** Abuse of power refers to misuse of public offices through corruption and harassment. People who abuse power should be taken to courts of law and prosecuted accordingly.
- viii) **Bill of rights:** These are fundamental rights and freedoms of people usually guaranteed by the government.
- viii) **Accepting the results of elections:** Accepting the results of an election without going to war.
- viii) **Human rights:** These are rights that belong to an individual because they are human beings.
- viii) **Multi-party system:** This is the operation of more than one party in competing for power within a country.
- viii) **Rule of law:** This involves having a functional legislature system and law-abiding citizens. The law also controls the powers of the government.
- viii) **Majority rule:** in a democratic government, there is the respect of the majority rule and rights of the minority are protected.

| Powers of the government | Principles of government                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Legislature</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Citizen participation</li> <li>• Accountability</li> <li>• Transparency</li> <li>• Bill of rights</li> <li>• Human rights</li> </ul>                                               |
| <b>Judiciary</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Equality</li> <li>• Control of the abuse of power</li> <li>• Rule of law</li> </ul>                                                                                                |
| <b>Executive</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Political tolerance</li> <li>• Regular, free and fair elections</li> <li>• Economic freedom</li> <li>• Accepting the results of elections</li> <li>• Multi-party system</li> </ul> |

Democracy is one way of keeping peace and moral values among people. It involves mutual respect, equality and fair treatment of people even in courts of law.

Rwanda practices democracy. Leaders are elected to power. The rights of all Rwandans are respected including those of children and women.

This explains the radical economic and social developments in the country.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 8.2

1. Define the principles of democracy, and explain why they are important during elections?
2. Mention any two principles of democracy and briefly describe what each of them mean (e.g., equality, transparency, accountability).
3. Using the principles listed, analyse a school election scenario and identify which principles are being respected or violated.
4. Explain how the rule of law and preventing of abuse of power promote fairness in a democratic government.
5. Explain why it is important to respect election results even when your preferred candidate loses.
6. Demonstrate how can you personally promote equality, respect, and tolerance in your school or community to support democratic values.

## 8.3. Forms of democracy



### Learning activity 8.3

**Read the following scenario and answer the questions asked below:**

In a village, residents meet to decide where to build a new water tap.

All adults attend the meeting. Everyone is allowed to speak and then they vote by raising hands to choose the location.

#### Questions

1. Identify who attended the village meeting.
2. State whether people express their opinions directly.
3. Explain how the final decision was made?
4. Name the system in which people make decisions directly without representatives.

Democracy is a form of government that is accountable for responding to the needs of its people. If any ruler does not work in these favours of the benefits of its people, then those people have the power to not elect him as their representative in the next election. The following are the forms of democracy.

### **a) Direct democracy**

This places all power in the hands of an individual. When political decisions are to be made, all members of an organized unit gather to vote. In theory, this sounds like the ideal form of government. There are no intermediaries. People are treated as equals. Each person is given a chance to directly influence the policy making process. In practice, however, this system is hard to implement.

Direct democracy is ideal in small towns or within indigenous communities. This is because everyone knows one another. As such, issues under debate directly affect them.

### **b) Representative democracy**

This political arrangement establishes an intermediary political actor between the individual and the policy outputs of the state.

Through the electoral process, one person or a group of people is elected.

They are assigned the task of making decisions on behalf of the citizens they represent.

### **c) Constitutional democracy/liberal democracy**

This is a system of government which places the rights and the power of the majority first in decision making if they are within the limits of the constitution. It makes sure that the rights of the minority are not curtailed.

Minority rights are guaranteed in constitutional democracy.



### **APPLICATION ACTIVITY 8.3**

1. Analyse why direct democracy is difficult to practice in large countries but suitable in small towns or indigenous communities.
2. A country with millions of people wants to make national laws. Which form of democracy would be most appropriate direct, representative, or constitutional democracy? Give one reason for your answer.



## END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and understanding

1. Define what is democracy? Explain how people exercise power in a democratic system.
2. State any two features of democracy and briefly explain each one.

### Skills

3. Study a school election where students vote freely without pressure. Which feature or principle of democracy is being practiced? Give a reason.
4. Using examples, explain how representative democracy helps citizens participate in governance in a large country.

### Attitudes and Values

5. Why should citizens respect the rights of minority groups even when the majority makes decisions in a democracy?
6. How can you, as a student, practice democratic values such as participation, tolerance, and accountability in your school or community?

# UNIT 9:

## STATE AND FORMS GOVERNMENT

### Key unit competence

**Analyse** the nature, roles, and functions of the state and government to understand their importance in promoting order, justice, and development.

### Learning objectives

#### Knowledge and understanding

Explain what a state is and name different forms of government, and show the difference between a state and a government.

Identify the types of states and forms of government, and describe the main organs of the state and government and their functions.

#### Skills

Compare different forms of government and types of states and analyse the functions of the main organs of government.

#### Attitudes and Values:

Appreciate different forms of government and types of states.

Acknowledge and value the organs, functions, and roles of the state and government.

## Introduction

This unit helps learners understand how societies are organized and governed by explaining the meaning of a state, how it differs from a government, and the different forms of government used in various countries. It covers the characteristics and types of states, major forms of government, as well as the organs of government and their roles and functions. Through key concepts like sovereignty, constitution, rule of law, and citizenship, learners gain knowledge that prepares them to become informed, responsible, and active members of society.



### Introductory activity 9

**Read the following problem scenario and answer the questions below:**

Imagine a Primary School which has grown very big, and many problems are happening students complain about unfair rules, some leaders make decisions alone, and others do not listen to students' ideas.

The school administration asks your class to suggest the best way to organise leadership and decision-making so that rules are fair and everyone is respected.

#### Questions

1. Identify who makes decisions in your school, and how are leaders chosen?
2. Why is it important for learners to participate in making decisions that affect them?
3. Explain which problems can occur when one person makes all decisions or when people fail to agree?
4. Discuss the ways in which decisions are made in your school similar to or different from how a country is governed?
5. How can learners at the said Primary School act as responsible global citizens by promoting participation, fairness, respect for others' views, and peaceful decision-making in their school community?

## 9.1. Concepts and difference between state and government



### Learning activity 9.1

Read the following story and answer the questions below before completing the table.

#### Story: The Village of Ubumwe

Once upon a time, there was a village called Ubumwe. Ubumwe had a council that made rules, collected resources for the village, and ensured everyone lived peacefully. The village itself had land, a population, and traditions that everyone followed. The council changed every five years, but the village of Ubumwe remained the same. One day, a new council decided to build a playground and improve the water supply. The villagers appreciated these changes but knew the village would exist even if the council changed tomorrow.

#### Questions

1. Identify and explain who or what you think the "village of Ubumwe" represents in real life?
2. Describe who or what the "council" represent?
3. Analyse what remained the same in Ubumwe village even when the council changed.
4. Explain the change that occurred when a new council took over.
5. How do these ideas relate to a country you know?
6. Complete the following table by using your prior knowledge and the information from the story.

| Feature    | State | Government |
|------------|-------|------------|
| Definition |       |            |
| Permanence |       |            |
| Role       |       |            |
| Leadership |       |            |
| Example    |       |            |

### 9.1.1. Definition of state and government

A **state** can be defined as an organised community of people occupying a definite form of territory free of external control and possessing an organised government to which people show habitual obedience. It may also be described as a compulsory political organisation with a centralised government that maintains a monopoly of legitimate use of force within a certain territory. A state comprises of:

- People
- Population
- Government
- Sovereignty

A **government** is the system by which a state or community is controlled. It also refers to a particular group of people that controls the state apparatus at a given time. That is, government is the means through which state power is employed.

Government can also be defined as the agency through which the will of the state is formulated, expressed and realized.

### 9.1.2. Difference between state and government

- A state has four elements namely population, territory, government and sovereignty. A government is a narrow concept and is an element of the state. It is right to say that government is a part of state.
- The state is permanent while the government is temporary. A government may come and go, but the state continues forever.
- The State is generally composed of all citizens but most of them are not members of the government. The Government consists of only a few selected citizens. The organs of the Government are executive, legislature and judiciary. The few selected persons will run these three organs of the Government. The State is a much broader organisation than the government. Membership of the State is compulsory but not that of the Government.
- The State possesses sovereignty. Its authority is absolute and unlimited. Its power cannot be taken away by any other person. Government does not possess sovereignty. It does not have original authority. It only has derivative powers delegated by the state through its constitution.
- Whether big or small, the characteristics of the state do not undergo changes. Governments are of different types, and they may vary from one State to another. Various political scientists have given different classifications of the government.
- The citizens possess rights to go against Government and not against the State. The state only acts through the government, and the government may commit mistakes and not the state. Thus, the citizens have only rights to go against the Government not the State.



#### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 9.1

1. A new government decides to put a tax on mobile phones to help build schools. Some people say the tax is unfair.
  - a) Identify who is the state in this situation?
  - b) Who is the government in this situation?
  - c) Why can people complain about the government's decision but not about the state itself?
2. Country A has had the same land, population, and laws for many years, but its governments have changed. Country B often changes its land and population because of problems.
  - a) Which part shows that the state is permanent?
  - b) How is the government different from the state in this example?
  - c) Why is it important for citizens to know the difference between state and government?
3. Your teacher asks you to make a poster showing the differences between the state and government for your school.
  - a) Write four differences between the state and government to put on your poster.
  - b) Give one example from real life where the government works on behalf of the state.

## 9.2. Types of state and basic forms of government



### Learning activity 2.3

**Read the following story and answer the questions below**

#### Scenario

As a member of a Youth Civic Education Club, you have been invited to participate in an international conference on governance and citizenship. During the conference, representatives from different countries explain how their states are organized and governed. Some countries have a federal system; others are centralized or decentralized. Some are monarchies, while others are democracies or authoritarian states.

Your team has been asked to prepare a report comparing these political systems and explaining how good governance contributes to peace, unity, and development.

**Based on this scenario, answer the following questions**

#### Questions

1. Describe the types of states and forms of government presented.
2. Distinguish between countries the different types of states and forms of government.
3. Compare the political systems presented and identify their similarities and differences.
4. Evaluate the different forms of government based on citizen participation, decision-making, and accountability.
5. Reflect on the importance of tolerance, respect for laws, and peaceful coexistence in promoting peace and development.

#### Types of states

- **Sovereign states:** These are states that are not dependent or subject to any other power or state. Example: Rwanda, Kenya, Tanzania, etc.
- **Federated states:** They participate in a federal union. This is whereby a territorial and constitutional community form a part of a federation. Such states differ from sovereign states, in that they have transferred a portion of their sovereignty powers to a federal government. Examples: Russia, USA, India, Ethiopia, etc.
- **Heterogeneous states:** These are states which are made up of many smaller states that are interrelated, interacting and interdependent. They usually form a complex whole that is highly coordinated and organised in its operations. They are mainly associated with military control. Example: Mozambique
- **Centralised states:** All powers of government emanate from one location in these states. It has a central authority. Example: Democratic People's Republic of Korea

- **Decentralised/non-centralised states:** These are states in which powers have been redistributed to different people. In a decentralised state, power is dispersed throughout the system. Examples: Brazil, Rwanda, India, Indonesia, South Africa, etc.
- **Monolithic states:** These are large states that were often ruled by one person. They are slow to adapt to change. They do not have complicated systems of operations, always working with the initial, unaltered ways of administration. Authority flows from the central source, implemented as received by those reporting to it. Example: North Korea.

### Basic forms of government

- Monarchy.** This is a form of government in which a single-family rule from generation to generation. The power or sovereignty is personified in a single individual. Absolute monarchy exists when the monarch has no or few legal limitations in political matters. Constitutional monarchies exist when the monarchy retains a distinctive legal and ceremonial role, but exercises limited or no political power.
- Democracy** is a system of government in which the people exercise power directly or through elected representatives who form a governing body such as a parliament. In a democratic government, power belongs to the people. Direct democracy is whereby all eligible citizens have direct participation in the decision making of the government. Representative democracy is whereby citizens exercise their power through elected representatives. Elected representatives propose, develop and enact laws for the citizens to abide by.
- Authoritarianism.** This is whereby a single power holder, a 'dictator' or small group of political leaders monopolises political power. This is a form of government in which the people have no participation. The characteristics of authoritarianism include:
  - Absolute obedience to an authority by the people
  - Strong central power and limited freedoms.
  - Informally defined executive power which changes often



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 9.2

- In a country, all decisions are made by the central government in the capital. Local areas have no power to make laws or collect taxes.
  - Mention the type of state this is?
  - Can you think of one good thing and one problem about this type of state?
- Country A has several smaller States that share some power with a federal government. Country B is fully independent and makes all decisions in its territory.
  - Which country is a federated state? Which is a sovereign state?
  - How is power shared differently in these two countries?
  - Why is it important for citizens to know the type of state they live in?

## 9.3. Organs, role and functions of the state and government



### Learning activity 2.3

Read the following story and answer the questions below

#### Story: "The Village Council of Intashyo"

In Intashyo village people lived under rules made by a council. The council had three main groups: the elders who made the laws, the chief who enforced them, and the judges who solved disputes. Each group had a special role. When each group did its job well, the village was peaceful and fair. If one group failed, problems arose.

#### Questions:

1. Identify who made the rules in the village?
2. Who enforced the rules?
3. Discuss how they solved disputes?
4. How do you think this is similar to how a country is run?

### 9.3.1. Organs of states and government

- **Executive:** The executive is responsible for managing the affairs of a country in accordance with the law. It also collects taxes and takes charge of operation of common services such as roads, water supply, policing and defence.
- **Legislature:** The legislature makes the laws that govern the state. It defines rights and obligations of the people and of various arms of government.
- **Judiciary:** The judiciary is the organ responsible for interpreting the laws passed legislative branch. It settles disputes which involve people and government. It has the authority to give appropriate punishment for violation of law.

### 9.3.2. Role and functions of the state and government.

The following are some of the role and functions of the state:

- a) Foreign diplomacy:** The central government maintains formal diplomatic relations with other sovereign states in the world. It promotes good relations based on respect, mutual interests and complementarity between the state and other states aiming at enhancing peace, security and development. The government also mobilizes and attracts foreign investments.
- b) Security of the people:** The government is responsible for ensuring the security of all citizens and foreigners living in the country. The government maintains armed forces in order to protect the territory and the people from attack and invasion by foreign powers.
- c) Domestic order:** The government exercises control over the people it seeks to govern and protect. It must maintain internal peace of individuals and groups of the society. It must ensure that citizens live in peace and harmony.

- d) Administration of justice:** A government promotes and facilitates the rule of law in the country by emphasizing equality before the law. It ensures that all citizens are treated equally under the law. It should give equal opportunities and settle disputes with fairness.
- e) Protection of civil liberties:** The government is also required to preserve and safeguard the basic rights and liberties guaranteed by the constitution to the individual members of the society. It should ensure that the rights of citizens are protected.
- f) Provision for and regulation of the conducts of elections:** The government is meant to ensure that free and fair elections are held according to the constitution. The elections should be held fairly, honestly and peacefully. Citizens should be allowed to choose their leaders by voting.
- g) Provision for public goods and services:** Government institutions provide public goods and services. The government get taxes from citizens to raise money to spend on goods and services, which will benefit all citizens. Examples of public goods and services are roads, streetlights, schools, hospitals and sanitation. All members of society should benefit from the provision of public goods.
- h) Promotion of economic growth and development:** The government facilitates fast growth and development of its economy. The government facilitates Rwanda's economic transformation through enabling competitive private sector integrated into regional and global markets.
- i) Social welfare:** The government ensures that it has programmes to assist the poor persons. These programmes are designed to alleviate poverty. It should provide education and healthcare to its citizens.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 9.3

1. Identify the organ of government is responsible for managing the country, collecting taxes, and providing services like roads, water, and policing?
2. Which organ of government makes laws and defines the rights and duties of people and other government organs?
3. Which organ interprets the laws and settles disputes between people or between people and the government?
4. Mention two roles of the government that help protect citizens' rights and ensure their safety.
5. How do these roles contribute to economic growth, social welfare, and peaceful living in the country?



## END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and Understanding

1. Define a state and a government and explain one main difference between them.
2. Name the three organs of government and describe the main function of each.
3. List four roles or functions of the state that help protect citizens and promote development.

### Skills

4. Compare and classify the following countries according to their type of state and form of government: Rwanda, USA, North Korea. Explain your reasoning.
5. Draw a simple diagram showing the three organs of government, labelling their roles and one real-life example of each.
6. Analyse why it is important for citizens to understand the difference between the state and government, giving one real-life example.

### Attitudes and Values

7. Explain why citizens should respect the rule of law even if they disagree with some government decisions.
8. Describe how understanding the roles of government organs can encourage responsible participation in the community.
9. Discuss why is it important for citizens to value fairness, equality, and protection of rights in a country?

# UNIT 10:

## CONFLICT AND VIOLENCE

### Key unit competence

**Evaluate** the forms, causes, and consequences of conflict and violence to promote peace, tolerance, and constructive conflict resolution.

### Learning objectives

#### Knowledge and understanding

Explain the meaning and different forms of conflict and violence.

Identify the causes and consequences of conflict at individual, community, and national levels.

#### Skills

Analyse different examples of conflict and explain their impacts on individuals and Interpret case studies of conflict and propose peaceful solutions using communication, negotiation, and problem-solving skills.

#### Attitudes and Values:

Appreciate the importance of peace and non-violence in society.

Develop empathy, tolerance, and respect for differences to promote peaceful coexistence

## Introduction

Conflict and violence occur when people or groups disagree or fight. This unit helps students understand the reasons behind conflicts, their effects on individuals and communities, and how to respond to them in peaceful ways.

The unit covers what conflict and violence are, their causes and impacts, and strategies for preventing and resolving them.

**Key concepts:** conflict, violence, causes, effects, resolution, peace, negotiation, and mediation,

All aimed at developing skills for positive conflict management.



### Introductory activity 10

**Look clearly on the following pictures and answer the following questions**



#### Questions

1. Discuss what do you see happening in this picture?

2. Identify who are involved in the conflict?
3. Explain what you think can cause the disagreement or fight?
4. How do people in the picture feel? What can you tell them?
5. Analyse what could be done to solve the conflict peacefully?
6. How can students act as responsible global citizens by promoting peace, respect, dialogue, and non-violence when resolving conflicts at school and in their community?

## 10.1. Forms, causes, and consequences of conflict and violence



### Learning activity 1.4

Read the following scenario and answer the questions below

#### Scenario: School tension escalates

At Mayange Secondary School, a disagreement starts in the classroom when students are assigned group work. Chris and Brian begin shouting at each other over differing ideas (verbal conflict). During recess, John and Peter get into a physical fight over a soccer game. Meanwhile, Mary keeps teasing Ruth online and in class, making Ruth feel isolated (bullying and cyber conflict). Outside school, two families from the neighbourhood continue arguing over land boundaries, and tensions are rising among neighbours (community dispute).

The combination of these events has created a tense and unsafe atmosphere in both the school and the community.

#### Questions:

1. Identify all the types of conflict and violence in this scenario.
2. How are verbal arguments, physical fights, bullying, and community disputes similar and different?
3. Propose the strategies could students, teachers, and community members use to resolve each type of conflict peacefully?
4. Discuss how unresolved conflict affects relationships, learning, and community harmony?
5. Why is it important to address conflicts early before they escalate?

**Conflict** refers to a fight, struggle or direct opposition. It may also refer to disagreement or the general pattern of groups dealing with disparate ideas.

**Violence** is a behavior or treatment in which physical force is exerted. The force is exerted with the purpose of causing damage, injury or even death to the victim(s). Violence takes many forms, some of them being:

- i) Physical violence
- ii) Sexual violence
- iii) Emotional violence
- iv) Psychological violence
- v) Structural violence

**Conflict and violence** are all together a public disorder that affect our societies both locally and internationally. For example, the 1994 Genocide against Tutsi led to the killing of more than one million people. The killing happened within 100 days. This brought suffering and misery in Rwanda, socially, economically and politically.

### 10.1.1. Forms of conflict and violence.

There are various forms of conflict and violence that people go through. Some people are beaten or hit by objects in order to harm them. Some are left to suffer in the cold or exposed to extreme temperatures. This is called **physical violence**.

In some cases, people go to war to fight against people they perceive as enemies. The 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi saw some people carrying weapons. They used the weapons to attack others. This is an example of *armed conflict*. This form of conflict mainly inflicts physical injury or even death to the victims.

There are people who defile children. Some rape women or touch them in an indecent manner. Others force people to watch pornographic materials. This is known as **sexual violence**.

Sometimes a conflict involves the use of an abusive language. It is normally characterised by behaviour such as name calling, anger and jealousy. This type of conflict affects others emotionally and psychologically. That is why it is called **emotional or psychological conflict/violence**.

### 10.1.2. Causes of conflict and violence

It is clear that there cannot be a conflict without its cause. The following are some of the causes of conflict and violence.

- i) **Inequality:** It is inequality between groups rather than individuals that increase the prospects of violent conflicts. Where the society is divided into two predominant groups, growing inequality between them leads to conflicts.
- ii) **State collapse:** Collapse is rarely sudden. It takes a long process that is characterised by a corrupt government.
- iii) **Economic decline and economic shock:** Continuous economic decline plays a major part in state collapse and conflict. For Violence is a behaviour or treatment in which physical force is exerted. The force is exerted with the purpose of causing damage, injury or even death to the victim(s). Violence takes many forms, some of them being example, hyperinflation may lead to violence and the overthrow of the government.
- iv) **History:** Many conflicts occur where there is a tradition of resolving problems by violent means. Political violence is entrenched and the instruments of the state such as the army, the police and the judiciary sustain the process.
- v) **Scarcity of resources:** There is likely to be conflict where people struggle for the few natural resources. For example, pastoralist communities sometimes engage in conflicts because of grazing areas.
- vi) **Unemployment and illiteracy:** Countries with high level of unemployment among the youth face a higher risk of conflicts. The situation is the same where male or female education levels are different.
- vii) **The abuse of ethnicity:** Negative political remarks based on ethnicity promote "ethnic" hatred. This may lead to conflicts and violence to one group.
- viii) **Availability of arms:** Availability of small arms is a major factor in sustaining and fuelling conflicts. Easy access to firearms will lead to armed conflicts and violence just as the way it is in South Sudan, DRC and Nigeria.
- ix) **The conflict cycle:** The greatest risks occur when a fragile peace is not properly consolidated. A non-resolved conflict keeps on rotating.

**x) Inadequate and inappropriate mediation:** If the conflict is not properly resolved through mediation it can reoccur.

### 10.1.3. Consequences of conflict and violence

The following are consequences of conflict and violence:

- i) Loss of human lives and civilian casualties:** Hundreds and thousands of human lives are lost in conflicts. Some people have become physically handicapped.
- ii) Displacement:** A lot of people have become internally displaced while others have become refugees.
- iii) Degradation of vulnerable groups:** Conflicts leave behind vulnerable groups such as orphans and widows who are denied their rights and cannot support themselves.
- iv) Sexual harassment:** Girl children and vulnerable mothers, especially in war torn areas, always face sexual harassment.
- v) Child soldier:** Children are deliberately indoctrinated into a culture of violence and used as specific instruments of war.
- vi) Target of Civilians:** They end up being the targets of the conflicts to achieve endless goals of perpetrators.
- vii) Famine:** War denies people access to their land at critical growing or planting periods. This always leads to famine.
- viii) Destruction of infrastructure:** War seriously damages infrastructure such as roads, railways, ports, airports, electricity and water supply.
- ix) Effects on services:** Schools and health centres are increasingly the targets of military activity. It leads many young uneducated persons.
- x) Poor governance and investment:** Conflict and violence change the quality of governance. This leads to poor governance resulting into the economic losses.

**xi) Debt burden:** Conflict also contributes to unsustainable debt to the government. The whole burden shifts to the citizens to pay recurring debt for years.

**xii) Regional and economic impact:** The effects of conflict and violence are rarely confined to one country. It extends to the whole region where the neighbouring countries receive refugees causing a lot of economic burden to them in a way of looking after them.



Fig. 10.1 People migrating due to conflict

**xv) Psychological trauma:** This occurs in many people as a result of conflicts and violence. For example, the 1994 Genocide against Tutsi left many people traumatized.



## APPLICATION ACTIVITY 10.1

1. Name any four forms of violence mentioned and briefly describe one of them.
2. Using examples from your community or country, explain how inequality or unemployment can lead to conflict and violence.
3. Given a situation where people use abusive language and threats instead of physical force, identify the form of conflict involved and explain its effects on victims.
4. What values should citizens promote to prevent conflict and violence and build lasting peace in their communities?

## 10.2. Conflict transformation



### Learning activity 10.2

**Read the following scenario and answer the questions below**

#### Scenario

In a village, people hold a community meeting to decide how to use land near a river.

One group wants to use the land for farming so that there can be more food. Another group wants the land to be used for grazing animals and to protect the river and the environment.

As they talk, the discussion turns into an argument. People start shouting, blaming each other, and refusing to listen. The meeting ends without a solution, and the two groups become angry with each other. The community fears that the conflict may become worse and lead to violence.

Later, community leaders understand that stopping the argument is not enough. They decide to change the conflict in a positive way. They bring both groups together to talk calmly, listen to each other, and respect different views. A mediator helps them discuss the problem and find a solution that benefits everyone.

This story shows that conflict transformation is important because it helps people solve problems peacefully, avoid violence, and live together in harmony. It also shows the conflict transformation process, which includes understanding the problem, talking peacefully, getting help from mediators, finding a fair solution, and rebuilding trust.

#### Questions

1. Explain the causes of the conflict between the two groups, and how was it shown during the meeting?
2. How did the way the conflict was handled affect relationships, and what might happen if it is not resolved?

- 
3. How can better communication, listening, and positive attitudes help transform this conflict?
  4. What steps and community support are needed to resolve the conflict peacefully and rebuild trust?
  5. As a responsible learner and community member, how can you apply problem-solving, cooperation, and peaceful communication skills to transform conflicts, respect different views, and promote sustainable use of shared resources?

### 10.2.1. Meaning of conflict transformation

**Conflict transformation** is the process of changing a conflict in a positive way. It does not only aim at stopping arguments or violence, but also at addressing the root causes of the conflict, changing negative attitudes, and rebuilding broken relationships between individuals or groups.

Unlike conflict resolution, which focuses on finding a solution, conflict transformation focuses on long-term peace, cooperation, and mutual understanding.

### 10.2.2. Importance of conflict transformation

Conflict transformation is important for the following reasons:

**i) Prevents violence**

When conflicts are transformed peacefully, they are less likely to turn into violence, destruction of property, or loss of life.

**ii) Promotes peaceful coexistence**

It helps people learn how to live together peacefully despite differences in opinions, interests, culture, or background.

**iii) Addresses root causes of conflict**

Conflict transformation goes beyond solving the surface problem by dealing with underlying causes such as inequality, misunderstanding, poor communication, or injustice.

**iv) Improves communication and understanding**

It encourages dialogue, active listening, and respect for different views, helping people understand each other better.

**v) Rebuilds relationships**

Conflicts often damage trust and relationships. Conflict transformation restores trust and promotes reconciliation and cooperation.

**vi) Encourages fair and inclusive solutions**

It promotes solutions that consider the needs and interests of all parties, not just one side.

### **vii) Builds a culture of peace**

By transforming conflicts peacefully, societies develop values such as tolerance, respect, empathy, and unity.

## **10.2.3. Conflict transformation process**

The conflict transformation process involves several steps that help turn conflict into an opportunity for growth and peace.

### **Step 1: Identifying the conflict**

- Recognising that a conflict exists
- Understanding who is involved and what the conflict is about

### **Step 2: Understanding the causes**

- Identifying the root causes of the conflict
- Examining interests, needs, fears, and misunderstandings of each side

### **Step 3: Encouraging dialogue and communication**

- Bringing conflicting parties together
- Allowing each side to express views peacefully
- Practicing active listening and respect

### **Step 4: Changing attitudes and behaviour**

- Reducing anger, hatred, and blame
- Promoting empathy, tolerance, and respect

### **Step 5: Mediation and negotiation**

- Involving neutral mediators such as community leaders, elders, teachers, or religious leaders
- Helping parties find common ground and agree on fair solutions

### **Step 6: Finding a shared solution**

- Developing solutions that benefit all parties
- Ensuring fairness, justice, and sustainability

### **Step 7: Implementation of the agreement**

- Putting the agreed solution into action
- Ensuring commitment from all sides

### **Step 8: Reconciliation and rebuilding trust**

- Restoring damaged relationships
- Encouraging forgiveness, cooperation, and unity

## Step 9: Follow-up and prevention

- Monitoring the agreement
- Taking steps to prevent similar conflicts in the future

Conflict transformation is essential for building **lasting peace** in families, schools, communities, and nations. By addressing causes, changing attitudes, and strengthening relationships, conflict can become an opportunity for positive change rather than destruction.

### 10.2.4. The following strategies can be employed to transform conflict and violence

**Inclusive government:** Conflict prevention will be effective if it is based on own experience. It should also be based on the capacity to respond to a crisis.

**Restoring the legitimacy of the state:** This is done through great commitment to re-establishing and delivering basic services. This demonstrates the value of national government.

**Dealing with impunity:** all people who cause conflicts and commit violence have to be dealt with according to the laws.

**Peacekeeping and peace enforcement:** This attracts widespread international interest to provide support and training.

**Dealing with small arms proliferation and control of light weapons:** There should be action against illegal transfer and transport of arms. There should be international support for the disposal and destruction of weapons surplus to national security needs.

**Commitment and support to addressing conflict:** There should be a long-term commitment and comprehensive framework to address conflict.

**Amicable settlement:** It is when two conflicting sides decide to solve their conflicts without calling a third party.

#### Other strategies of conflict transformation include the follow:

- i) Regional and economic integration and mutual security
  - ii) Local mediation and peace building activities for the civil societies and religious leadership
  - iii) Making stringent laws against conflicts and violence
  - iv) Encouraging social justice national wide
  - v) Settling conflict outside courts of law between two or agents of conflicting sides. A settlement contract is usually signed to adhere.
- Conflict and violence can also be managed through international criminal courts. For example, the International Criminal Court in the Hague-Netherlands. It tries war crimes, genocide crimes, crimes against humanity and aggression. This can make an impact on the reduction of crimes, conflicts and violence in various parts of the world.



## APPLICATION ACTIVITY 10.2

1. What is conflict transformation, and how is it different from conflict resolution?
2. Identify any four importance of conflict transformation in promoting peace and unity in society.
3. Using a real situation from your school or community, explain how the conflict transformation process can be applied to change a conflict into a peaceful outcome.
4. Why should individuals and communities promote dialogue, tolerance, and empathy when dealing with conflicts?



## END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and Understanding

1. Define conflict and violence and state any three forms of violence.
2. Identify three major causes of conflict and violence and briefly explain one of them.
3. Mention three consequences of conflict and violence on individuals or society.

### Skills

4. Using an example from your school or community, explain how scarcity of resources or unemployment can lead to conflict or violence.
5. Given a situation where people insult and threaten each other without physical fighting, identify the type of violence involved and explain its effects on the victims.
6. Apply the conflict transformation process to the village land dispute scenario and explain how the conflict can be changed into a peaceful outcome.

### Attitudes and Values

7. Why should people reject the use of violence and abusive language when dealing with disagreements?
8. What values should citizens promote to prevent conflict and violence and build lasting peace in their communities?
9. How can tolerance, empathy, and respect help individuals contribute to peaceful coexistence in society?

# UNIT 11:

## GENOCIDE AND ITS FEATURES

### Key unit competence

Evaluate the meaning, features, and stages of genocide and its distinction from other mass crimes to promote prevention and a culture of peace.

### Learning objectives

#### Knowledge and understanding

Define genocide and identify its key features.

Explain the stages of genocide and their role in escalating mass violence.

Differentiate genocide from other mass crimes and provide historical examples, including the 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi in Rwanda.

#### Skills

Analyse historical and contemporary genocides to identify patterns, warning signs, and stages of genocide.

Interpret and use maps, timelines, and statistical data to understand genocides.

Compare genocides and other mass crimes using reliable sources and present research findings effectively.

#### Attitudes and Values:

Show empathy and support for victims and survivors of genocide.

Promote tolerance, peace, and respect for human rights to prevent discrimination and violence.

Demonstrate respect for human life, dignity, and diversity while condemning hatred and discrimination.

## Introduction

Genocide is a serious crime that involves the deliberate and systematic destruction of a group of people because of their identity, such as their ethnicity, nationality, religion, or race. It is carried out with the intention of eliminating the group either entirely or in part. Genocide causes immense loss of life, suffering, and long-lasting damage to societies and humanity. The 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi was a planned and systematic attempt to exterminate the Tutsi in Rwanda during which more than one million Tutsi were killed in just 100 days. The genocide was carried out by extremist leaders and their followers, using propaganda and hatred to mobilize the population against Tutsi. It left deep wounds in Rwandan society and remains one of the darkest chapters in human history.



### Introductory activity 2

**Read the following short scenario and answer the questions below:**

In a town, a group of people was targeted because of their belonging. They were separated from others, their properties were taken, and many were harmed. The community witnessed fear, discrimination, and violence spreading.

#### Questions

1. In the story, a group of people was targeted because of their What do you think it means when people are harmed just because of who they are?
2. Can you give a single word or phrase to describe deliberate acts aimed at destroying a group of people?
3. Identify who was targeted in the story? Why?
4. How did fear and violence spread in the community?
5. Do you think the harm in the story happened randomly, or was it planned? Why?
6. What signs in the story show that the community's response allowed the violence to continue?

## 11.1. Genocide and its features



### Learning activity 11.1

**Read the following scenario and answer the following questions**

#### Scenario:

In the town of Nyange, a community called Tetero was blamed for the town's problems. Over time: They were excluded from schools, markets, and public offices, their homes and properties were destroyed, Some Tetero were attacked and killed, fear and mistrust spread, and more people joined in discriminating against the group.

#### Questions

1. Identify who was targeted in the scenario and why?
2. What does it mean when a group of people is deliberately harmed because of their identity?
3. Can anyone suggest a single word that describes the planned attempt to destroy a group?
4. How did fear and violence spread across the community?
5. Do you think these actions were accidental or planned? Why?

### 11.1.1. Meaning of genocide

Genocide is the killing of innocent people based on their tribe, political position, race or religion with the intention of completely wiping them out. Examples of genocides are:

- Genocide against the Tutsi (Rwanda, 1994)
- Genocide against the Jews, Holocaust (Germany, 1939-1945)

The term 'genocide' is made up of two different words. Those are the Greek word 'Genos' meaning origin or species, and Latin verb 'Caedere' meaning to kill. It was first used by Raphael Lemkin, a Polish born American lawyer who taught law at the University of Yale in the 1940s. He used the term for the first time in his book, Axis Rule in Europe, published in 1944. Article II of the Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide approved by General Assembly of the United Nations in resolution 260 A (III) of 9 December 1948, defines genocide as any of the following acts committed with intent to destroy, in whole or in part a national, ethnic or religious group.

### 11.1.2. Features of genocide

According to the UN convention, the following are the features of any genocide:

- Killing members of the group;
- Causing serious bodily or mental harm to members of the group;

- Deliberately inflicting on the group conditions of life calculated to bring about its physical destruction in whole or in part;
- Imposing measures intended to prevent births with the group;
- Forcibly transferring of the group to another group.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 11.1

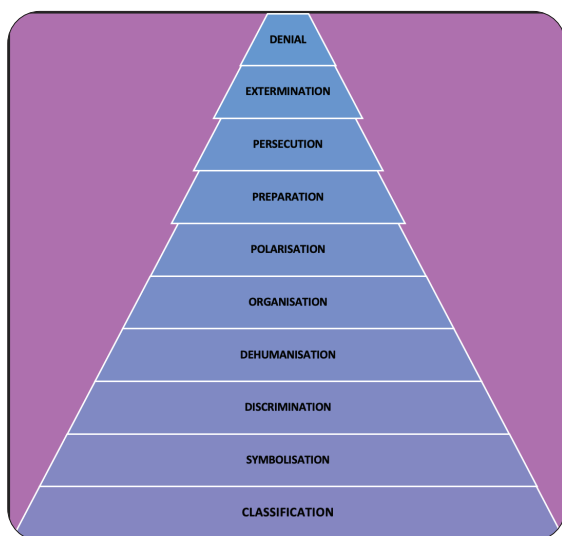
1. Explain the meaning of the term genocide?
2. Who first coined the term "genocide" and in which book was it first used?
3. List at least three features of genocide according to the UN Convention.
4. Analyse a scenario where a group is being discriminated against and identify which acts could be considered features of genocide.
5. Using the definitions and features of genocide, classify the following actions as genocide or not: forced displacement, hate speech, property confiscation, physical killing.
6. What values can help prevent acts of genocide in our communities, schools, and countries?

## 11.2. Stages of genocide



### Learning activity 11.2

Observe the following flow chart and answer the questions below



1. Briefly explain each stage in simple language as you point to the diagram.
2. Analyze the stages of genocide and determine the stage that signals the imminent outbreak of violence.

Genocide is a process that develops in stages and are expectable, prepared simultaneously and operated by the state. For Genocide to happen, government must play a significant role in its preparation, initiation, coordination and full implementation of its plan and strategies in line with the genocide ideology propaganda to be used by different people including soldiers, local administration, public media, public services and academicians. The government practice genocide by using different stages as described below:

### Contributory stages of the Genocide where it happened.

1. **Classification:** Distinction between "us" and "them," between members of our group and others (e.g in Rwanda- Hutu and Tutsi). Bipolar societies are most likely to have a genocide. With reference to the genocide against the Tutsi, Hutu / Tutsi in ID, teaching that they are not of the same "ethnic" group, etc. ...); Throughout many reforms, it is important to note that there was a significant segregation which was highly institutionalised by the second Republic right from 1981, in the name of "ethnic" and regional balance or in the quota system». The system saw the Tutsi children excluded from Secondary and Tertiary education and services.



Fig.11.2: Identity card during the second republic

2. **Symbolisation:** After dividing the population into sections, each group is given a unique name, followed by differentiating them from other non-group members, and marking each other as different from each other. In 1994 genocide against the Tutsi; Tutsi as savages, cruel, hypocritical etc. For example, Kayibanda's speech to the leaders of MDR PARMEHUTU, October 24, 1966: (...) PARMEHUTU must fight against the hypocrisy (stereotype) of the Tutsi moths. ... » Other examples the Jews who were ordered to put on a yellow star sign wherever they went to be easily identified by Nazis.
3. **Discrimination.** The dominant group uses all kinds of power to deny rights to the powerless groups. By this ideology it legitimises the victimisation of the weaker ones by attracting the support of the masses.

In addition, in Rwanda, in schools there was no success, there was exclusion of Tutsi and regional recognition, there was a ban on Tutsi at work. The reluctance of Tutsi who fled in 1959 to return to Rwanda is based on unfounded reasons: the country is full, a glass full of water when you add more and more is broken. While in Germany, Jews were prohibited from securing employment in government and universities by the Nuremberg law in 1935; their citizenship as Germans was also cancelled.

4. **Dehumanisation.** Treating the discriminated group as lesser human beings. In incitements to genocide the targeted groups are called disgusting animal names. Again, one part creates another name and devalues it, depriving it of humanity. This is where in Rwanda the Tutsi began to be called beetles, snakes, tails, granting the right to kill, revenge for the killers and were referred to as 'cockroaches etc ... a policy of prevention. In Germany, Jewish business was delayed by the Nazis not at all. Calling the members names like bacteria, it is easy to kill them because they are made of worms, which makes it difficult for the killers.
5. **Organisation:** Each Genocide is planned and carried out by the state and uses military units to prevent its involvement. An example is a group called S.S. in Germany, the Interahamwe and the conspiracy in Rwanda. These units are given military training by the state and provided with weapons. They were trained to exterminate the Tutsi.
6. **Polarisation:** The systematic elimination of moderates who would slow the cycle. Separating those who should be killed by those who will kill them (Polarisation). In Rwanda, moderates from the killing group who opposed the extremists were killed. In addition, during the genocide against the Tutsi, Tutsi were considered as one of the government and Hutu in general. These hate speeches by the bad leadership waked up the Hutu extremists and started torturing and killing the Tutsi.
7. **Persecution:** The victims are taken to unsafe places such as concentration camps and deprived of water and food to weaken them. Thereafter, genocidal massacres begin. Example, in Rwanda, detention of Tutsi accused of being accomplices of the Inkotanyi began on 03/10/1990.

A list compiled by the Ministry of Justice (04/02/1991) shows that the number of detainees called accomplices of the Inkotanyi was 8,402.

8. **Preparations:** It includes identification. Lists of victims are drawn up. Houses are marked. Maps are made. Individuals are forced to carry identification cards showing their or religious group.

In Rwanda, identity cards showed each person's group the Tutsi could easily be identified and killed. It also includes expropriation of the property of the victims and herding them in ghettos, stadiums or churches. Finally, transportation of the victims to the killing centres is then organised and institutionalised. For instance, Interahamwe coalition and other factions have been formed to prepare for the Genocide against the Tutsi in Rwanda.

**The picture below shows Interahamwe militia in training in 1991.**



*Fig.11.2. Training of Interahamwe militias*

**Source:** <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AWw8lvjLL>

**9. Extermination:** Targeted members of a group are killed, often including children. Their bodies are mutilated and buried in mass graves or burnt. Murder without explanation. Statement by President Sindikubwabo, Butare, 16.4.1994?: "You know that you may not have heard our instructions, or you may not have heard of our demands, or you may have refused to implement them ... way. The rescue squad wasn't called for him, "she told the Associated Press. Times are tough. Get rid of jokes and games and start working." and Nyakizu, on 18/04/1994: "The people of Nyakizu, this is the first time you have seen the visit of the President of Rwanda. I came to support and appreciated your work in these difficult times. Next time I send people to help them get this job done and I will see if I can reward them. Do the same as in 1959"

Source: <https://www.hrw.org/legacy/reports/1999/rwanda/Geno8-10-03.htm>

Denial or minimising of genocide. Every genocide goes simultaneously with denial.

The mass graves are dug up and hidden. The historical records are burned or closed to historians. Genocide denial means renaming genocide as "racial repression" to distort the truth about genocide and mislead the public. In Rwanda for example, genocide denial refers to such statements like "there was a double genocide, it was a civil war" etc. Such statements simply mean that the 1994 genocide against the Tutsi was not planned and therefore may not have happened.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 11.2

1. Suppose a government introduces identity cards showing people's "ethnic" groups and uses them to limit access to education and jobs. Which stages of genocide does this situation illustrate, and why?
2. In a community where public media repeatedly describe a certain group as animals and enemies of the nation. which stage of genocide is being applied, and what danger does it pose to society?
3. Imagine that local leaders compile lists of people to be arrested and move them to camps "for security reasons." Which stages of genocide are reflected in this action, and how do they prepare the way for extermination?
4. How does recognising and rejecting genocide denial contribute to peace, unity, and justice in society?

## Genocide and other mass crimes



### Learning activity 11.3

#### Read the following real-life scenario and answer the following questions

A group of people is denied education and jobs because they belong to a certain group. Media calls them enemies of the country.

#### Questions

1. Explain what is happening to the group in this story.
2. Which rights are being denied?
3. What warning signs of mass crimes can you identify?
4. Evaluate what might happen if this situation continues without intervention?

Genocide is distinguished from other mass crimes such as crimes against humanity and war crimes.

- **Mass crime:** is an act or crime committed against many people within a short or long period of time during war or any other kind of conflicts by individuals, terrorists, groups of people, armed men and states. Mass crimes include genocide, war crimes and crimes against humanity.
- **War crimes:** According to the statute that established the International Criminal Court, war crimes are defined as armed hostility (conflict) and military operations between societies, nations or states. An example of war is the Second World War of 1939 -1945. Then, War crimes refer to criminal acts (violation of laws) during the war. The people who do that are referred to as criminals of war. Examples of war crimes include:

- |                                    |                                                 |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| • Killing civilians                | • Killing surrendered military                  |
| • Killing hostages                 | • Torture                                       |
| • Killing spies and prisoners      | • Rape                                          |
| • Deliberately destroying property | • Involving children in the war (child soldier) |

**Crimes against humanity:** According to the Rome Statute definition offers the most expansive list of specific criminal acts that may constitute crimes against humanity to date. In Article 7 of the treaty stated that: For the purpose of this Statute, "crime against humanity" means any of the following acts when committed as part of a widespread or systematic attack directed against any civilian population, violation of common human rights and values with knowledge of the attack. Example of crimes against humanity:

- |                                    |                              |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| • Murder                           | • Forced migration of people |
| • Expulsion (to force someone out) | • Confiscation of property   |
| • Slavery                          | • Forced disappearance       |

- Apartheid (racial segregation)
- Sexual slavery
- Forced labour
- Forced prostitution
- Torture
- Forced pregnancy
- Forced sterilisation.

### Difference between genocide and other mass crimes.

- Genocide has the intention to completely or partly destroy a certain group of people while other crimes against humanity do not require this specific intent to destroy one group
- Crimes against humanity are essentially about the violation of common human rights and values while genocide involves violation and killings.
- War crimes and crimes against humanity focus on killing many individuals while genocide focus on eliminating a group
- Other mass crime does not consider dehumanization while genocide consider it
- Other mass crimes may not be planned by the government while genocide is planned by the government
- Some crimes against humanity prepare the genocide
- Genocide occurs in various stages while other mass crimes do not involve different stages



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 11.3

Use this sign V to show if this characteristic is either war crime, mass crime or genocide

| Characteristics                                                           | War crime | Crime against humanity | Genocide |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------------------|----------|
| Deliberate destruction of property during war                             |           |                        |          |
| Many people are killed.                                                   |           |                        |          |
| Killing of hostages.                                                      |           |                        |          |
| Killing of many people by one person or a very small group of people.     |           |                        |          |
| Deliberate destruction of property during war.                            |           |                        |          |
| Dehumanisation of others and seeing them as animals or pests.             |           |                        |          |
| Mass killings targeted at the public level.                               |           |                        |          |
| Killing with the intention to finish members of a tribe, race or religion |           |                        |          |
| Depriving a prisoner of war, a fair trial.                                |           |                        |          |



## END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and understanding

1. What is the meaning of the term genocide according to the UN Convention?
2. Who coined the term “genocide”, and from which two languages are the word derived?
3. List three stages of genocide and briefly state what happens in each stage.

### Skills

4. Using the stages of genocide, explain how classification and symbolisation can lead to discrimination in a society.
5. Analyse the following situation:  
A group is denied education and employment, and public media describe them as enemies.  
Identify two stages of genocide and justify your answer.
6. Compare genocide with other mass crimes by explaining two differences between genocide and crimes against humanity or war crimes.

### Attitudes and Values

7. Why should individuals and communities reject hate speech, discrimination, and dehumanisation?
8. How can promoting unity, respect for Human Rights, and equality help prevent genocide and other mass crimes?
9. Why is it important to recognise, remember, and reject genocide denial in order to promote peace, justice, and reconciliation?

# UNIT 12:

## DIGNITY AND SELF-RELIANCE IN RWANDAN SOCIETY

### Key unit competence

Evaluate the importance of dignity and self-reliance, the government measures to promote them, and their implications on Rwandan society.

### Learning objectives

#### Knowledge and understanding

Explain the concepts of dignity and self-reliance in the Rwandan context.

Identify government policies and programs that promote self-reliance in Rwanda.

Describe the importance and effects of dignity and self-reliance on individual and community development.

#### Skills

Analyse dignity and self-reliance in the Rwandan context.

Assess personal and community practices that promote or undermine dignity and self-reliance.

Apply problem-solving and communication skills to propose and present strategies for promoting dignity and self-reliance in local communities.

#### Attitudes and Values:

Value and respect the dignity of oneself and others in society.

Appreciate the importance of self-reliance for personal growth and national development.

## Introduction

Dignity and self-reliance are important values in Rwandan society that guide how individuals and communities live and work together. Dignity emphasizes respect for oneself and others, fairness, and responsible behaviour, while self-reliance encourages people to depend on their own efforts rather than relying on others. Traditionally, Rwandans valued hard work, cooperation, and mutual support as ways of maintaining dignity and improving community well-being. In modern Rwanda, these values continue to shape national development through initiatives that promote unity, entrepreneurship, and social responsibility. By upholding dignity and self-reliance, Rwandans strengthen personal character, reduce dependency, and contribute to sustainable development and national pride.



### Introductory activity 12

**Observe the following pictures and answer questions below:**

**“What do these pictures tell us about our lives?”**



### Questions

1. What activities are people doing in the pictures?
2. Distinguish pictures show people working together and which show people working for themselves?
3. Discuss how these activities help people live with dignity?
4. Have you seen or participated in similar activities (e.g. Umuganda, farming, small businesses)?
5. How do these activities help families and communities survive without depending on others?
6. What might happen if people did not work or cooperate like those in the pictures?
7. Explain how do these actions show dignity and self-reliance?

## 12.1. Concepts of dignity and self-reliance and measures put in place by the government of Rwanda to achieve self-reliance



### Learning activity 2.2

**Read the following scenario and answer the following questions**

#### **Short Scenario: Learning to be self-reliant**

In the village of Nyamiyaga in Rwanda, many families used to depend on aid during difficult seasons. One year, the community joined a government-supported cooperative that encouraged members to work together in farming. Through Umuganda, villagers prepared land and built terraces to prevent soil erosion.

Marie, a young mother, received training and small farming tools through a local development program. By working hard on her small plot and saving money with other cooperative members, she was able to grow enough crops to feed her family and sell the surplus at the local market. Over time, her family stopped depending on aid and began contributing to community projects.

Marie now feels proud and respected because she can support her family through her own efforts, showing how self-reliance promotes dignity and community development in Rwanda.

#### **Questions**

1. Discuss what is happening in the scenario?
2. Explain how does this activity help people meet their needs?
3. Identify which value is shown here: dignity, self-reliance, or both?
4. Who benefits from this activity: individuals, families, or the whole community?
5. Why does the government encourage people to work together?
6. Explain how these programs reduce poverty?
7. How do they promote dignity among citizens?
8. How does working together in cooperatives and community activities help people become self-reliant, reduce poverty, and act as responsible Global citizens in their community and country.

### 12.1. 1. Concept of dignity and self -reliance in Rwandan society

**Dignity:** It is a condition of being worth of respect, esteem or honour.

**Self-reliance:** This is a state of being independent in all aspects. The independence could be social, political or economic.

The Government of Rwanda has put some measures to enable us achieve self-reliance and dignity.

### 12.1.2. Measures put in place by the government of Rwanda to achieve self-reliance.

In the past years, Rwanda has worked hard towards the achievement of dignity and self-reliance. Several measures were put in place to achieve both.

#### i) Abunzi

These are mediation committees that were created in 2006 to resolve conflicts through community participation. In other words, they were to decentralise justice. There are local officers at village level (umudugudu) whose major role is intervention. They intervene in small wrangles among citizens and harmonise the situation before it involves the courts.

#### ii) Girinka programme (one cow per poor family)

This programme was launched on 12<sup>th</sup> April 2006 with mainly four prime objectives:

- Fighting malnutrition
- Reducing poverty through dairy farming
- Improving agricultural productivity through use of manure
- Improving soil quality and reducing effects of erosion through planting trees and grass

One member of the community is given a pregnant dairy cow. He or she is supposed to give a first-born female calf to another beneficiary.

The chain is continuous. By September 2014, close to 200 000 beneficiaries had received cows.

**The criterion used for one to benefit from the one cow per poor family project is as follows:**

The beneficiary must not have already owned a cow.

- One must be considered poor by the community through the *ubudehe* principle.
- One must have constructed a cow shed.
- One must have at least 0.25 to 0.75 hectares of land part of which must be covered with fodder.
- One must be a person of integrity (Inyangamugayo).

Before one is given the cow, they first undergo training from Rwanda Agricultural Board (RAB). This is to prepare them on how to manage the cows.



Fig. 12.1: Girinka programme in Rwanda

### iii) Agaciro Development Fund

This is solidarity fund that has been initiated by Rwandans. The fund seeks to improve the level of financial autonomy of Rwanda. It is a government programme. It was started by his Excellency the President of the Republic of Rwanda in August 2012. It was started as a way of reducing foreign aid.

### iv) Itorero

It is a civic education training that was established in 2007 to train different leaders. It trains teachers, students, politicians, church leaders, ex-soldiers, bankers and civil servants. They study Government Programme, Rwandan history, unity and reconciliation and Rwanda values for a better future in which negative ideologies of the past will not influence them. It also produces leaders who strive for community development.



*Fig. 12.2: Youths undergoing Itorero training*

### v) Ubudehe

This is a poverty eradication programme under the ministry of finance. **A pilot programme was launched** in 2001. The official launch was in 2004. It is a culture of collective action and solidarity to solve problems of poverty by people themselves.

This is done by categorising Rwandans into different income groups according to self-sustenance. The poor are given priority in terms of health insurance, education, electricity, water supply and even **accommodation**.

### vi) Kuremera

It is an initiative created by the Government of Rwanda.

It aims to assist people in need, especially those living in conditions of poverty.

- Members of a given community can join hands to help the needy in their community. For example, they construct houses, avail water for the aged, giving a cow etc.

### **vii) One-dollar campaign**

It was an initiative by Rwandans living in the diaspora and internal, the aims were to raise some money. It was about contributing at least one dollar per head. The money contributed was for supporting the society through building houses for students who survived the genocide.

### **viii) Umuganda (National community service)**

This is a national communal activity that is done every last Saturday of the month. It starts at 7:00 am and ends at 12 noon. All people dedicate that time to cleaning and rehabilitation of the environment. After that, a meeting is held to discuss the progress of the nation. Government programmes such as immunisation days are also announced.



*Fig 12.3. His Excellency the President of the Members of a community doing Umuganda Republic doing community service (Umuganda)*

### **ix) Ishema ryacu**

This started in July 2015 after the arrest of General Karenzi Karake Emmanuel. General Karenzi was arrested in Britain under the order of Spain. Rwandans started Ishema campaign to collect money and pay for his bail which was 1 million pounds. Ishema fund was to bring back the pride of Rwanda and Rwandans.

### **x) Gacaca**

Gacaca means "judgment on the grass". Gacaca system has been used in Rwanda for a long time as a method of disputes resolutions in areas like land and cattle disputes, dowry disagreements and crimes committed in the community. It is based on truth telling and confessions as well as rendering punishment to violators while still emphasising the need for harmony and social order.

The main objective for the establishment of "Gacaca" is reconciliation through restoration of harmony, social order by punishing, shaming and requiring reparations from the offenders as well as giving everyone in the community an opportunity to participate in the deliberation of justice. The "Gacaca" system is elaborated on how to punish the violators and perpetrators even as it allows them a chance to be reintegrated back into the community.

This traditional, communal justice was adapted in 2001 to fit the needs of Rwanda in the wake of the 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi where over one million Tutsi were killed, tortured and raped in the period of 100 days. This was after realisation that the formal court systems could have taken a long time to resolve the 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi cases. They were started to bring to a consensus between the perpetrators and the victims of the Genocide. The courts worked at the village level. By the time of their official closure on 4th May 2015, they had successfully resolved many cases. They had also created a united Rwandan society.



*Fig. 12.4: Gacaca court in session*

#### **xi) Ndi Umunyarwanda**

Ndi Umunyarwanda Programme was put forward by the National Unity and Reconciliation Commission (NURC). It was started to bring a lasting peace, unity and reconciliation after the 1994 genocide against the Tutsi. It was launched on the 15<sup>th</sup> November 2013 at Integrated Polytechnic Regional Centre (IPRC), Kigali. It was launched by the Permanent Secretary of the Ministry of Youth and Information and Communication Technology (MYICT).



*Fig. 12.5: Citizens attending Ndi Umunyarwanda programme*



## APPLICATION ACTIVITY 12.1

1. In your community, a family depends on aid despite having land and being healthy. Which two government programs discussed in this unit could help this family become self-reliant, and how would each program improve their dignity?
2. Imagine you are a youth leader in your village and many young people are unemployed. How would you use Kuremera, Itorero, or Ubudehe to help them start income-generating activities and reduce dependency?
3. Conflicts between neighbours over land are common in your area and often affect peace and cooperation. Explain how Abunzi or Gacaca could be applied to resolve such conflicts and promote dignity and unity in the community.
4. Your school wants to promote dignity and self-reliance among learners. Design one practical activity inspired by Umuganda, Girinka, or Agaciro Development Fund that students could carry out, and explain how it would build responsibility and self-reliance.

## 12.2. Implication of dignity and self-reliance on Rwandan society



### Learning activity 12.2

**Read the following story and answer the following questions**

#### **Story: Marie's Dairy Farm**

Marie, a young mother in Gatsibo district, received a cow through the Girinka program. She had never owned a cow before, but she built a small cow shed and planted fodder on her land. Marie carefully took care of the cow and sold the milk in the local market. With the income, she bought school supplies for her children and improved her family's home. Marie also gave the first-born female calf to another neighbour, continuing the Girinka chain. Her hard work shows how self-reliance brings dignity and supports community development.

#### **Questions**

1. Discuss what are the people in the story doing?
2. How does their action show self-reliance?
3. How does it reflect dignity?
4. What positive effects can these actions have on the individual, family, and community?
5. Explain how self-reliance contributes to reducing poverty or improving living standards?
6. Can these actions inspire others in the community? How?

Government of Rwanda had put on different measures to promote dignity and self-reliance. What benefits did Rwandans will get from it?

Dignity and self-reliance have positive implications on the Rwandan society. Some of them are:

- They have brought, among Rwandans, a sense of togetherness and love for one another. The love is not based on any other string but Rwandans, hence the slogan 'Ndi Umunyarwanda'.
- Dignity and self-reliance have played a big role in the economic development of Rwanda. Every Rwandan feels that it is their duty to develop their own country.
- Dignity and self-reliance have led to promotion of peace and stability among Rwandans. People learn to respect and live in harmony with each other.
- Rwanda has been able to fight the bad history of tribalism of 1950s and early 1990s. Rwandans now work together towards the development of their nation.
- They have also helped to reduce income inequalities among Rwandans. Rwandan society looks forward to dignifying every member, that is, the rich help the poor.
- Dignity and self-reliance reduce the dependency ratio on the government. Some issues are addressed by the citizens through various campaigns such as 'bye-bye nyakatsi.' Campaigns such as kuremera and Agaciro Development Fund have enabled the government to finance up to 66% of its budget.
- *Umuganda* is one of the activities through which Rwanda has managed to conserve the environment. Through Umuganda, trees have been planted and cleaning has been done. No doubt, Rwanda is the cleanest country in Africa. We must keep up the record.
- Dignity and self-reliance are very important in Rwanda. They promote growth and development of Rwanda. They bridge the gap between the poor and the rich. They enable provision of basic services, and helping the needy and disaster-stricken people. They also help in poverty eradication.



### APPLICATION ACTIVITY 12.2

1. Imagine you are a member of your local community. How could you personally participate in programs like Umuganda, Kuremera, or Agaciro Development Fund to contribute to dignity and self-reliance in your area? Explain the benefits for yourself and your community.
2. Rwanda has reduced income inequalities and dependency on government support through dignity and self-reliance programs. Identify two specific measures that help achieve this and explain how each measure improves economic development and social harmony.
3. Think about a family, school, or community project you know that practices self-reliance. How does this practice promote peace, unity, and development in Rwanda? Suggest one new initiative that could further strengthen dignity and self-reliance in your community.



## END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

### Knowledge and understanding

1. Define dignity and self-reliance in the context of Rwandan society.
2. Name three government programs that promote self-reliance in Rwanda and briefly explain their purpose.

### Skills

3. Given a scenario of unemployment in your community, propose a practical plan using programs like Kuremera or Itorero to help young people start income-generating activities.

### Attitudes and Values

4. How does practicing dignity and self-reliance promote peace, unity, and social harmony among Rwandans?
5. Explain why it is important for every Rwandan to contribute to national development and support community programs like Umuganda, Girinka, or Agaciro Development Fund

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